IELTS Writing

Task 2 Model Answers

All 203 IELTS Liz questions · 10 topics

Education

1 · EDU-01

> *Some educationalists think that international exchange visits will benefit teenagers at the school. To what extent do the advantages outweigh the disadvantages?*

Many schools now organise exchange visits in which teenagers live with a host family and study abroad for a few weeks. Although these visits can be costly and stressful for some pupils, they also broaden teenagers' horizons and build independence. In my opinion, their advantages clearly outweigh the disadvantages.

There is little doubt that international exchange visits offer considerable

advantages to teenagers. To begin with, the greatest benefit is that such a visit helps young people broaden their horizons. This is because living in another country exposes students to different customs, foods, values and ways of thinking, which builds tolerance. For example, a Bangladeshi teenager who spends a month in Japan learns to value punctuality, and this lesson often lasts a lifetime. In addition, an exchange visit not only builds independence but also improves pupils' foreign language skills. As a result of solving problems alone, these students develop confidence and maturity, which help them later at university and work. Overall, a short stay abroad prepares teenagers for both adult life and a connected, multicultural world.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that exchange visits also have some

drawbacks. Firstly, many families find these trips expensive, because flights, insurance and daily costs add up quickly. Without financial support, pupils from low-income homes often cannot take part; as a result, the benefits may go mainly to wealthier students. For instance, a talented pupil whose parents earn a small salary may have to stay at home while richer classmates travel abroad, which feels unfair. Secondly, homesickness and culture shock can be a serious obstacle, as teenagers on short exchanges may feel anxious living with strangers. If they cannot settle in quickly, they may stop enjoying the experience and, consequently, learn very little from it. Although these financial and emotional challenges are real, schools can reduce them through scholarships and careful preparation.

In conclusion, studying with a host family overseas has become a popular part of school life. While such trips may be costly and emotionally demanding, they make teenagers more open-minded, independent and confident. Therefore, I firmly believe that the benefits far outweigh the drawbacks.

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2 · EDU-02

> *For centuries, important parts of education have remained the same, such as reading, writing and maths. With the advent of computers, some people think that computer skills should be added to the list as a fourth basic skill. To what extent do you agree?*

For hundreds of years, schools have treated reading, writing and

mathematics as the basics of education, but many people now believe that computer skills deserve the same status. I completely agree with this view because these skills are needed for almost every job and for daily life.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that almost every job requires digital skills. This is because office workers use spreadsheets and email, farmers check market prices on their phones, and even small shop owners now sell their products online. Technology also changes very quickly; as a result, people who do not learn these skills at school risk being left behind in the job market. For example, a graduate who cannot use a computer will struggle to find work, because most jobs are now advertised online, and this problem can limit their income for many years.

Therefore, teaching computer skills from an early age equips students with the tools that they need for future employment.

Another important reason for my agreement is that computer literacy has become necessary for everyday life. When citizens pay bills, book tickets or use government services, they increasingly have to do it online, so people without basic training can easily feel excluded. For instance, a person who never learned computer skills may have to travel to an office and queue to pay an electricity bill, while a neighbour does it on a phone in two minutes. Although some people argue that computers will weaken traditional skills, children actually use reading, writing and mathematics every time they work on a computer. Consequently, computer skills

should stand beside the traditional basics so that no child grows up unable to manage these tasks.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that computer ability should join reading, writing and mathematics as a fourth basic skill. Young people need it to find work, and they also need it to manage ordinary tasks easily and confidently.

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3 · EDU-03

> *The government should allocate more funding to teaching sciences rather than other subjects in order for a country to develop and progress. To what extent do you agree?*

It is often argued that governments should spend more money on science teaching than on other subjects because

this helps a country to progress. I completely disagree with this view because a growing country needs many kinds of skills and other subjects also build better citizens.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that a country cannot develop with scientists alone. This is because a modern economy also needs managers, designers, writers, lawyers and teachers, and these people depend on subjects other than science. Languages, history, economics and the arts develop communication, creativity and critical thinking; as a result, they prepare students for many well-paid careers. For example, a successful technology company employs engineers to build a product, but it also needs designers to make it attractive and marketing experts to sell it. Therefore, giving most of the

money to science would leave the economy short of other skilled workers.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that other subjects help young people to become responsible citizens. When students attend well-funded humanities classes, history and literature help them understand society, human behaviour and different points of view, which every citizen needs. For instance, a brilliant scientist who has never studied society may develop a powerful new technology without thinking about how it could harm ordinary people, which creates new problems. Although some people argue that a country's development depends on science and technology, technology only brings real progress when educated citizens use it wisely. Consequently, governments should fund all subjects

fairly and support a well-rounded education for every student.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that science should not receive more public money than other school subjects. National progress requires a wide range of abilities, and the arts and humanities also produce thoughtful people who use knowledge responsibly.

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4 · EDU-04

> *Discipline is an ever-increasing problem in modern schools. Some people think that discipline should be the responsibility of teachers, while others think that this is the role of parents. Discuss both sides and give your opinion.*

Poor behaviour has become a growing concern in many schools. While some

people argue that teachers should control it, others believe that this is the duty of parents. I completely support the latter view because discipline begins at home.

On the one hand, people who support the role of teachers argue that discipline at school is part of their professional duty. Spending many hours with pupils every day, teachers can set classroom rules and deal with problems immediately. Clear rules that are applied fairly and consistently are more effective than harsh punishments; as a result, pupils learn to respect them. For example, a teacher who treats every pupil in the same way can turn a noisy class into a calm one, and this helps everyone to concentrate. For this reason, many people believe that teachers should be responsible for discipline.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that parents should take this responsibility because long before children enter a classroom, they learn language, habits and values at home. When parents teach moral values, such as honesty and respect, early, children bring these habits to school, and teachers can concentrate on teaching. For instance, a child who is never taught respect at home may refuse to follow a teacher's instructions, which disturbs the whole class. Although some people argue that fair rules at school can control behaviour, these rules have little effect on a child who has not learned respect at home. Consequently, parents are the right people to take responsibility for their children's behaviour.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether teachers or parents should be responsible for discipline in

schools. While fair classroom rules can keep lessons calm, I firmly believe that parents should take this duty because respect is first learned at home.

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5 · EDU-05

> *Some people believe that children should not be given homework every day, while others believe that they must get homework every day in order to be successful at school. Discuss both sides and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that daily homework is necessary for success at school, others believe that children should not receive it every day. I completely support the latter view because young people also need time to rest and play.

On the one hand, people who support daily homework argue that it helps children practise what they have learned in class. Regular practice strengthens memory, and it also allows parents to see what their children are studying. Difficult skills such as spelling and mathematics are mastered through repetition; as a result, students become more confident. For example, a student who solves a few maths problems every evening is likely to remember the method better than one who practises only in class, and this can lead to higher marks. For this reason, many people believe that homework should be given every day.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that homework should not be given daily because too much homework leaves children tired and stressed. When

children finish a long school day and then start more work, they lose time for play, sport, family and sleep, and their interest in learning falls. For instance, a student in Bangladesh who attends school and private tuition may still be doing homework at night, which leaves almost no time for rest. Although some people argue that daily practice improves memory, a tired child cannot concentrate or remember lessons well. Consequently, setting homework only a few times a week is better for children's learning and health.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether children should be given homework every day. While daily practice can strengthen memory, I firmly believe that it should not be a daily burden because children need time to rest and play.

6 · EDU-06

> *Some children receive almost no encouragement from their parents regarding their performance at school, while other children receive too much pressure from their over-enthusiastic parents, which can have a negative impact on the child. Why do you think some parents put too much pressure on their children to perform well at school? What do you think the role of a parent should be in their child's education?*

Some children get little encouragement from home, while others are pushed very hard by their parents. This is mainly because competition is intense and parents compare children, and parents should support learning rather than control it.

One of the main reasons for excessive parental pressure is intense competition. Some parents push their children very hard to achieve top grades, because they want them to enter a good university or a well-paid profession, so they demand constant study. For example, a mother who fears that her son will not get into a medical college may send him to private tuition every evening, and this leaves him no time to rest. Another important reason is social comparison with relatives and neighbours. Parents often feel embarrassed when another child gets better results; as a result, they push their own child even harder. Consequently, excessive pressure can cause anxiety, loss of confidence and even a dislike of learning.

One important role of a parent is to support rather than control a child's

learning. When parents provide a quiet place to study, show interest in schoolwork and praise effort as well as results, children become more motivated and confident. For instance, a girl whose father encourages her after a poor test result is more likely to keep trying, which can gradually improve her marks. Another important role is to work closely with teachers. Parents who stay in contact with the school can notice problems early, which means that children get help before they fall behind. Consequently, children whose parents guide them patiently are more likely to reach their full potential.

In conclusion, some parents put heavy pressure on their children because the competition for success is fierce and they compare their children with others.

Instead, parents should encourage effort and cooperate with teachers.

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7 · EDU-07

> *The role of education is to prepare children for the modern world. Schools should cut art and music out of the curriculum so that children can focus on useful subjects such as information technology. To what extent do you agree?*

It is often argued that schools should remove art and music from their timetables so that pupils can concentrate on practical subjects such as computing. I completely disagree with this view because these subjects develop children's creativity and help them to manage stress.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that art and music encourage creativity and self-expression, which are increasingly valued by employers. This is because a modern workplace needs people who can produce new ideas, not only people who can operate a computer. Machines can now perform routine tasks quickly; as a result, original thinking has become one of the most useful skills that a worker can offer. For example, a student who learns to draw at school may later design attractive websites for a company, and this job requires artistic ability as well as technical knowledge. Therefore, removing these lessons would leave children less prepared for the modern world, not more prepared.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that creative lessons protect children's mental well-being.

When pupils spend long hours preparing for exams, they often feel tired and anxious, and art and music give them a healthy way to express emotions and reduce stress. For instance, a pupil who feels anxious before exams may relax by playing in the school music group, which helps them to return to their studies with a calmer mind. Although some people argue that limited school hours should be spent only on job-related skills, a tired and unhappy child cannot learn any subject effectively. Consequently, these lessons support academic learning and deserve their place in a well-rounded education.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that art and music should keep their place in the school curriculum instead of being replaced by technical subjects. These lessons build the imaginative skills that

employers want, and they also keep young learners emotionally healthy.

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8 · EDU-08

> *Some people think that students in high school should not waste their time studying literature, such as poems and novels. Do you agree?*

It is sometimes claimed that teenagers at secondary school gain nothing from reading novels and poems, so these lessons are a waste of time. I completely disagree with this view because literature improves students' language skills and helps them to think critically.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that studying literature greatly improves students' language skills. This is because students who read novels and poems meet a wide range of vocabulary,

sentence structures and styles of writing that textbooks rarely contain. They also learn how good authors express ideas clearly and powerfully; as a result, their own reading and writing become stronger in every subject. For example, a student who reads short stories regularly usually writes better essays than one who reads only textbooks, and this ability remains useful at university. Therefore, literature lessons are practical preparation for further study and for any job that requires clear writing.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that literature helps young people to think critically and understand others. When students discuss a poem or the actions of a character, they learn to question ideas and form their own opinions, and they also begin to see life through other

people's eyes. For instance, a student who reads a novel about poverty may become more aware of social problems in their own country, which can make them a kinder citizen. Although some people argue that literature does not lead directly to a job, these abilities are essential in many professions and in responsible citizenship. Consequently, time spent on novels and poems is a valuable investment in a young person's mind and character.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that high schools should continue to teach poems and novels instead of treating them as wasted time. Such lessons make teenagers stronger readers and writers, and they also develop independent thinking and empathy.

9 · EDU-09

> *Some parents believe that their children should do educational activities during their free time. Others say that in this way children are under pressure. Discuss both views and give your opinion.*

While some parents argue that children should spend their free time on educational activities, others believe that this places young people under pressure. I completely support the latter view because children need real rest after school.

On the one hand, parents who support these activities argue that they help children to succeed in a competitive world. Reading, language courses and science clubs develop knowledge and skills that school alone may not provide.

New interests can also be discovered outside the classroom; as a result, children may have a clearer idea of their future. For example, a child who attends a weekend computer class may become interested in technology, and this interest can later lead to a successful career. For this reason, many parents believe that free time should be used for learning.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that these activities put children under pressure because young people already work hard at school. When every free hour is filled with classes, children have no time to relax, and excessive pressure can cause anxiety, loss of confidence and even a dislike of learning. For instance, a child who goes from school to tuition and then to a language course may feel exhausted by the weekend, which can

destroy their interest in studying. Although some people argue that extra classes build useful skills, a tired and anxious child is unlikely to learn them well. Consequently, children should be allowed to enjoy their free time without extra lessons.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether children's free time should be spent on educational activities. While extra classes can develop useful skills, I firmly believe that they create too much pressure because children need time to relax.

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10 · EDU-10

> *Some people think that teachers should be able to ask disruptive children to leave the class. Do you think it is the best way to deal with a*

> *disruptive child in the classroom? What other solutions are there?*

Some people believe that teachers should be allowed to send disruptive pupils out of the classroom. I firmly believe that this is not the best way, and finding the cause and working with parents would work better.

I firmly believe that sending a disruptive child out of class is not the best way because it does not address the root causes of the behaviour. When a pupil is removed, they miss the lesson and fall further behind, so they may become even more frustrated. For example, a child who misbehaves because they cannot understand mathematics will understand even less if they are regularly sent outside, which makes the problem worse. Although some people argue that a single disruptive pupil can waste a

large part of a lesson, removing the child only moves the problem out of the room for a short time. Therefore, exclusion should only be used as a last resort.

The most effective alternative is for teachers to find out why a child misbehaves and provide the right support. If boredom or a learning difficulty is the cause, extra help, counselling or more engaging tasks can remove the reason for the bad behaviour. For instance, a pupil who receives praise and a reward chart for good behaviour may gradually become calmer, which helps the whole class. In addition, schools could work closely with parents. When teachers and parents agree on the same rules at home and at school, the child receives a consistent message, so good habits develop faster. Together, these measures would change behaviour

far more effectively than sending the child away.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that removing disruptive pupils from lessons is not ideal because it ignores the cause of the problem. Individual support and close cooperation with parents would improve behaviour more effectively.

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11 · EDU-11

> *Education should be accessible to people of all economic backgrounds. All levels of education, from primary school to tertiary education, should be free. To what extent do you agree with this opinion?*

It is often argued that learning should be open to everyone, whatever their income, and that students should pay nothing from primary school to

university. I completely agree with this view because free education gives every child a fair chance and benefits society as a whole.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that free education provides equal opportunities for all children. This is because talent is found in every social class, but money is not, so family income should never decide who can study. When universities charge high tuition fees, many intelligent young people from low-income families never apply; as a result, their abilities are wasted and they stay poor. For example, if the bright child of a poor farmer can study medicine for free, they may become a doctor, and this single graduate can lift a whole family into a better life. Therefore, free education at every level can help to

break the cycle of poverty in many families.

Another important reason for my agreement is that free education benefits the economy and society. When young people can study without fees, the nation gains a highly educated workforce, which makes it more productive, more innovative and more attractive to foreign investors. For instance, a young engineer who graduates without debt can stay in Bangladesh and start a small company, which creates jobs and brings more tax income to the state. Although some people argue that free higher education is extremely expensive, the money spent on education is not a cost but a long-term investment. Consequently, free learning at every level repays the government through higher taxes and lower spending on welfare and crime.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that every stage of learning, from the first year of school to the last year of university, should cost nothing. This gives children from poor homes a fair chance, and it also builds a stronger and more productive nation.

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12 · EDU-12

> *The current trend in education is to move away from traditional exams and instead have continuous assessment over the school year. What do you think of this trend?*

Many schools are now replacing traditional final exams with continuous assessment throughout the year, and many people see this as a positive change. I completely agree with this view

because it measures real understanding and reduces harmful exam pressure.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that continuous assessment offers a more complete picture of a student's ability. This is because traditional exams often test memory rather than understanding, so students may memorise answers the night before and forget everything a week later. Projects, presentations and class work also give students regular feedback; as a result, they can correct their weaknesses before it is too late. For example, a student who writes a weak science report in the first term can learn from the teacher's comments and produce a much better one in the second term. Therefore, continuous assessment rewards genuine learning rather than a good memory on one day.

Another important reason for my agreement is that continuous assessment reduces the harmful pressure of a single final exam. When a whole year's result depends on a few hours, one bad day caused by illness or anxiety can ruin months of hard work. For instance, a pupil who works hard all year but falls ill on exam day will not be unfairly punished, because most of their marks have already been earned. Although some people argue that coursework is easier to copy, teachers can prevent this by setting tasks in class and asking students to present their own work. Consequently, students are encouraged to work consistently instead of memorising everything the night before.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that moving from final exams to continuous assessment is a positive development for

schools. It measures what students truly understand, and it protects them from the stress of one decisive exam.

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13 · EDU-13

> *Some people think that educated people are more valuable than people who have learned skills through experience. Do you think that educated people are the most valuable for society? What kinds of skills can people learn through experience that can benefit society?*

Some people argue that educated people are worth more to society than those who have learned through experience. I firmly believe that they are not the most valuable, and practical skills and people skills learned at work also benefit society.

I firmly believe that educated people are not the most valuable members of society because a community depends equally on workers who learned through practice. Doctors and engineers are clearly valuable, but a city could not function without electricians, plumbers, mechanics, farmers and drivers. For example, a hospital full of highly trained doctors cannot treat patients if no electrician can repair its power supply, which shows that both groups are needed. Although some people argue that educated professionals earn more and pay more tax, a high salary does not prove that someone is more useful. Therefore, people with practical experience deserve the same respect as university graduates.

One important skill that people learn through experience is practical, technical

ability. Someone who starts as an apprentice electrician or builder gains hands-on experience and may become a skilled professional without ever going to university. For instance, a young mechanic who trains in a small garage for several years can fix engines that many engineering graduates have only studied in theory. Another important skill is the ability to deal with people. Experience develops soft skills such as communication, teamwork and problem-solving; as a result, workers learn to calm customers, negotiate prices and settle disagreements. Consequently, these skills create jobs, serve communities and keep the economy running.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that formal education does not make people the most valuable because society relies

on practical workers too. Hands-on technical skills and the ability to work with people also bring great benefits.

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14 · EDU-14

> *Being able to speak a foreign language is an advantage these days. Some people think that children should start learning a foreign language at primary school, while others think children should begin in secondary school. Discuss both sides and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that children should begin learning a foreign language at secondary school, others believe that primary school is the right time. I completely support the latter view because young children learn languages more easily.

On the one hand, people who support a later start argue that primary school children should first master their own language. Learning two languages at the same time may confuse young children, and older children learn grammar more effectively. Difficult rules can be explained more clearly to teenagers; as a result, they may make faster progress. For example, a twelve-year-old can follow a grammar explanation that a six-year-old would find difficult, and this saves time in the classroom. For this reason, many people believe that language lessons should wait until secondary school.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that children should start at primary school because they can copy pronunciation naturally and are less afraid of making mistakes. When children start early, they

speak without fear, and they also have more years of practice before they finish school. For instance, a Bangladeshi child who learns English songs and rhymes at primary school may later speak with more confidence than one who starts at thirteen. Although some people argue that teenagers understand grammar better, this advantage cannot replace the extra years of practice that young learners enjoy. Consequently, an early start gives children the best chance to become confident speakers.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether foreign language lessons should begin at primary or secondary school. While older students may understand grammar more easily, I firmly believe that primary school is better because young learners gain confidence and more practice.

15 · EDU-15

> *The gap between education in richer countries and education in poorer countries is a growing concern. What solutions can you suggest to deal with this situation?*

The difference in the quality of education between rich and poor countries is becoming a serious concern. Poorer governments can tackle this by investing more in schools and teachers, and richer nations can help by funding resources and online lessons.

The most effective solution is for governments in poorer countries to give education a higher priority in their national budgets. Many schools in these countries lack basic resources such as books, laboratories and qualified teachers, so more funding is needed

before quality can improve. Governments can offer incentives to teachers who work in remote areas, such as higher salaries, free housing and faster promotion. For example, a village school that receives a new science teacher and a small laboratory can finally offer the same subjects as a school in the capital. Consequently, investment at home would tackle the main causes of low-quality education.

In addition, richer countries and international organisations could provide well-planned support. They can fund school buildings, train teachers and supply textbooks and computers, which poorer governments often cannot afford on their own. Technology can also help: online lessons and recorded lectures by excellent teachers can reach village classrooms, provided that schools have

electricity and internet access. For instance, a school with no physics teacher could use video lessons from an international platform, which would allow its students to learn the same topics as pupils abroad. Together, these measures would help children in poorer nations receive a much better education.

In conclusion, the education gap between wealthy and poor nations can be narrowed if poorer governments make schools a priority. Practical support from richer countries, including teacher training and online lessons, would speed up this progress.

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16 · EDU-16

> *Some schools are very strict about their school uniforms and the appearance of their pupils, while*

> *other schools have a very relaxed dress code. What are the advantages and disadvantages for children of having a school uniform?*

Some schools have strict rules about uniforms and appearance, while others allow pupils to dress more freely. Although uniforms can limit self-expression and be costly for some families, they also create equality and a sense of belonging.

There is little doubt that school uniforms offer considerable advantages to children. To begin with, the most significant benefit is that uniforms create a sense of equality among pupils. This is because children from rich and poor families look the same, which can reduce bullying about clothes. For example, a girl whose parents cannot afford fashionable clothes can join her

classmates without feeling ashamed, and she can focus on her lessons instead. In addition, a uniform not only gives pupils pride in their school but also prepares them for workplaces with dress codes. As a result of wearing the same colours every day, children develop a sense of belonging, which encourages them to respect school rules. Overall, uniforms help to build a fair, united and well-organised school community for every child.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that school uniforms also have some drawbacks. Firstly, many teenagers feel frustrated when a strict uniform stops them from expressing their personality. Without any choice in how they look, they may feel that their identity is ignored; as a result, some begin to resist other school rules. For instance, a

creative student who is punished for wearing coloured shoes may lose interest in school, which can harm their learning. Secondly, the cost of uniforms can be a serious obstacle, as some schools require specific shops and several sets. If a family has three growing children, it may need new uniforms every year and, consequently, face heavy pressure on its budget. Overall, these personal and financial problems can make uniforms a burden for some pupils and their parents.

In conclusion, many schools still expect pupils to dress identically. While uniforms may restrict children's individuality and strain family budgets, they reduce differences between pupils and make children feel part of their school.

17 · EDU-17

> *In some high schools, part of the curriculum requires students to participate in community work such as helping the elderly or disabled. In what way do children benefit from this? Do you think it should be part of the curriculum?*

Some high schools require students to do community work, such as helping elderly or disabled people. Community work teaches empathy and builds confidence, and I firmly believe that it should be part of the curriculum.

One of the main benefits of community work is that it teaches empathy, responsibility and teamwork. When teenagers help elderly or disabled people, they begin to understand the needs and difficulties of others, so they

become more caring and patient. For example, a teenager who visits a care home every week may learn to listen calmly to lonely residents, and this experience can even inspire a career in nursing. Another important benefit is greater confidence and better communication skills. Students must talk to people of different ages and backgrounds; as a result, they become more comfortable expressing themselves outside the classroom. Consequently, community work develops qualities that cannot easily be learned from textbooks.

As for whether it should be part of the curriculum, I firmly believe that it should because only a compulsory programme reaches every student. When community work is optional, only a few motivated students take part, while many others miss its benefits completely.

For instance, a shy pupil who would never volunteer alone may discover a talent for helping others once the school arranges a weekly visit, which can change their attitude to people. Although some people argue that it takes time away from academic subjects, a few hours each month would not harm students' results. Therefore, community work deserves a regular place in the school timetable.

In conclusion, helping people in need makes young people more caring, responsible and confident. I firmly believe that schools should include it in the curriculum because this ensures that every pupil benefits.

> *The best way to help underachieving pupils is to have compulsory after school activities which they must attend. This way they will become more involved in school and their grades will improve. To what extent do you agree?*

It is sometimes claimed that making weak pupils attend after-school activities is the most effective way to increase their interest in school and raise their marks. I completely disagree with this view because forced activities can reduce motivation and they do not solve the real causes of poor results.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that compulsory activities can make struggling pupils even less interested in school. This is because

pupils who are forced to stay longer may feel that they are being punished for their low marks. Many of them are already tired after a full day of lessons or have family duties, such as caring for younger siblings; as a result, extra hours at school can feel like a heavy burden. For example, a pupil who cares for younger siblings but must also join an evening chess club may dislike school, and this can lead to poorer results. Therefore, compulsion is likely to damage the interest that these activities are supposed to create.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that underachievement usually has specific causes that activities cannot solve. When marks fall, the cause is often personal, as a child may have learning difficulties that have not been identified, or may be facing problems at

home. For instance, a child who cannot read well needs individual support from a trained teacher, which more time on a sports field cannot provide. Although some people argue that sports teams, clubs and community projects also give pupils a sense of belonging, this benefit does not help a pupil who simply cannot follow the lessons. Consequently, schools should address the root causes of each pupil's difficulties instead of adding extra hours.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that compulsory after-school programmes are not the best help for underachieving children. They can make pupils feel punished and less motivated, and they also ignore the individual problems that lie behind low marks.

19 · EDU-19

> *Some people think that schools should invest more money in technology, such as more computers, while others think more money should be spent on teachers. Discuss both views and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that schools should spend more of their budgets on computers and other technology, others believe that this money should go to teachers. I completely support the latter view because technology cannot replace a good teacher.

On the one hand, people who support investment in technology argue that it makes lessons more interactive and engaging. Using videos, animations and simulations, teachers can bring difficult topics to life, which a textbook alone

cannot do. Difficult processes can be shown on a screen; as a result, students understand them more quickly. For example, a science class that cannot safely perform a chemical reaction can watch it on a smart board, and this experience often stays longer in students' memories. For this reason, many people believe that computers are a sensible use of a school's limited money.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that schools should fund teachers first because technology cannot replace their human qualities. When students lose confidence, a teacher can notice the problem and adapt the lesson, and no computer program can offer the same support. For instance, a village pupil who has lost confidence in mathematics may give up on recorded lessons, whereas a patient teacher can notice the

difficulty and explain it differently. Although some people argue that technology makes lessons more engaging, even the best equipment is wasted if teachers have never been trained to use it. Consequently, funding well-trained teachers is the most effective way to improve students' learning.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether schools should fund digital equipment or teaching staff. While technology can make lessons more interesting, I firmly believe that teachers deserve the investment first because no device can offer the same guidance and encouragement.

20 · EDU-20

> *Some people think that parents have the greatest influence on their child's academic development, while others think that a child's teacher has more influence. Discuss both sides and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that teachers have the greatest effect on a child's academic progress, others believe that parents have more influence. I completely support the latter view because parents are a child's first and most important teachers.

On the one hand, people who support the role of teachers argue that they have professional training and subject knowledge that most parents do not have. They know how to explain difficult concepts, how to organise learning step

by step and how to assess progress. Difficult subjects can be made simple by a skilled teacher; as a result, students make steady progress. For example, a student who is weak at mathematics may learn to enjoy the subject with the help of a patient teacher, and this can improve their results. For this reason, many people believe that teachers have the greatest influence on academic development.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that parents have more influence because study habits and attitudes begin at home. When parents read with their children and answer their questions, they develop curiosity long before school starts, and this love of learning can last for years. For instance, a child whose parents read stories every night may arrive at school already curious about

books, which makes learning to read much easier. Although some people argue that teachers have better subject knowledge, even the best teacher struggles to help a student whose family does not value education. Consequently, parents have the stronger effect on a child's academic development.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether parents or teachers have more influence on academic development. While teachers bring valuable knowledge and skills, I firmly believe that parents matter more because good study habits begin at home.

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21 · EDU-21

> *In some countries, girls and boys are educated in different schools rather than in the same school. What are the*

> *advantages and disadvantages of this?*

In some countries, boys and girls study in separate schools. Although single-sex schools may limit social skills and weaken respect between boys and girls, they can also improve concentration and confidence.

There is little doubt that single-sex schools offer considerable advantages to some students. To begin with, the most significant benefit is that pupils may be less distracted and more confident to participate. This is because teenagers who study only with their own sex often feel less pressure about appearance, which leaves more energy for learning. For example, a shy girl who worried about her looks in a mixed class may focus better at a girls' school, and her confidence may grow. In addition, many

parents in conservative communities feel more comfortable when their daughters attend girls-only schools. As a result of this trust, more girls stay in education and may be more likely to choose subjects like physics and engineering. Overall, separate schools can give many students a calmer and more focused place to learn.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that single-sex schools also have some drawbacks. Firstly, many students miss the chance to develop social skills with the opposite sex. Without daily contact with the opposite sex, they often feel nervous in mixed groups; as a result, teamwork at university or work can be difficult. For instance, a young engineer who has never worked with women may feel uncomfortable in a mixed office, which can slow his progress. Secondly,

separation can be a serious obstacle to equality, as it may keep old gender stereotypes alive. If boys and girls rarely share classrooms, they may not learn to respect the opposite sex and, consequently, carry unfair attitudes into adult life. Overall, these social and attitude problems can make the move into adult society harder for some students.

In conclusion, educating boys and girls apart remains common in many countries. While separate schools may weaken social skills and respect between the sexes, they can help pupils focus and feel more confident.

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22 · EDU-22

> *In nearly all science courses at university, there are significantly*

> *more male students than female students. What is the reason for this? What could be done to balance out the numbers?*

In most university science courses, male students greatly outnumber female students. This is mainly because of gender stereotypes and a lack of female role models, but better support at school and visible women scientists can balance the numbers.

One of the main causes of this imbalance is gender stereotypes, which shape girls' choices from an early age. Many girls are told, directly or indirectly, that science and engineering are "men's subjects", so they lose confidence in physics and mathematics even when they perform well. For example, a talented girl who is advised by relatives to become a teacher rather than an engineer may never apply

for a science course, and this choice can shape her whole career. Another important cause is the lack of female role models in science. When young women rarely see women working as scientists or engineers, these careers seem less possible and attractive. Consequently, many capable women choose other subjects before they reach university.

The most effective solution is for schools to challenge these stereotypes from an early age. If teachers give boys and girls equal attention in science lessons and encourage girls to join science clubs, girls can build confidence in these subjects. For instance, a talented girl who wins a school science competition may feel able to choose engineering, which makes family pressure easier to resist. In addition, universities and companies could make women scientists

more visible. When successful female scientists speak to students and offer mentoring, schoolgirls can see that such careers are realistic. Together, these measures would change attitudes and increase the number of women in university science courses.

In conclusion, women are underrepresented in science because of social expectations and too few female examples to follow. Early encouragement and greater contact with women scientists would gradually correct this imbalance.

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23 · EDU-23

> *Some people think that it is beneficial for old people to learn something new while others believe that once a*

> *person is past 65 years of age it is too late to learn. What is your opinion?*

While some people argue that it is too late to learn anything new after the age of 65, others believe that older people benefit from new knowledge. I completely support the latter view because learning keeps the mind active.

On the one hand, people who think it is too late argue that learning becomes much harder in old age. Elderly people may also have health problems, such as poor eyesight or hearing, which make learning more difficult. Slow progress can also be discouraging; as a result, they feel they are too old to learn. For example, a 70-year-old with poor eyesight who struggles in a computer class may give up after a few lessons, and this can confirm the belief that learning is impossible. For this reason, many

people believe that learning new skills is only for the young.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that learning is beneficial at any age because learning keeps the mind active, which may help to slow down memory loss. When older people learn to use new technology, they also stay connected and independent, and this gives them a sense of purpose after retirement. For instance, a 67-year-old who learns to use a smartphone can video-call grandchildren abroad, which makes life much less lonely. Although some people argue that older learners make slow progress, this problem can be solved by classes with patient teachers and a relaxed pace. Consequently, age should never stop people from learning something new.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether learning new things after 65 is useful or too late. While health problems can make study harder, I firmly believe that older people benefit greatly because learning keeps them active and connected.

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24 · EDU-24

> *It is thought by some that a school teacher's role is to motivate and inspire students. However, other people believe that a teacher's primary role is to pass on knowledge. What do you think is the role of a teacher?*

While some people argue that a teacher's main duty is to pass on knowledge, others believe that teachers should motivate and inspire students. I

completely support the latter view because information is now easy to find online.

On the one hand, people who support knowledge-based teaching argue that teachers have professional training and subject knowledge that most parents do not have. They know how to explain difficult concepts, how to organise learning step by step and how to assess progress. Key facts must be understood before students can move forward; as a result, clear explanations are essential. For example, a mathematics teacher must explain a formula accurately before students can solve problems, and this basic knowledge is needed in every exam. For this reason, many people believe that passing on knowledge is a teacher's primary role.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that inspiring students matters more because information is now available online within seconds. When facts are so easy to find, students need a teacher who can motivate a student who has lost confidence and show why a subject matters. For instance, a bored pupil whose teacher connects science to real life may become an enthusiastic learner, which can change their attitude to school for years. Although some people argue that students need accurate facts first, those facts are quickly forgotten if pupils have no interest in learning them. Consequently, motivating students is the most important part of a teacher's job.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether teachers should mainly pass on knowledge or inspire their students. While clear explanations are

useful, I firmly believe that teachers should motivate and inspire because information can now be found online.

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25 · EDU-25

> *Fewer schools are requiring children to learn and improve their handwriting skills. Do the advantages outweigh the disadvantages of this trend?*

In recent years, many schools have stopped making handwriting a compulsory part of the curriculum. Although this change can save time for digital skills and suit a computer-based world, it often weakens children's memory and exam performance. In my opinion, the disadvantages of this trend outweigh the advantages.

There is little doubt that less handwriting practice offers considerable advantages to pupils. To begin with, the most significant benefit is the extra time that schools can spend on computer lessons. This is because most writing in workplaces is done on computers, which makes fast typing an essential skill. For example, a pupil who learns to type quickly at primary school can later complete assignments far more efficiently, which saves hours every week. In addition, typed work is not only easier to edit and share but also kinder to children with poor handwriting. As a result of these tools, pupils who once felt embarrassed by messy writing can present their ideas clearly, which builds their confidence. Overall, the shift towards typing prepares children well for a digital world of study and work.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that this trend also has some drawbacks. Firstly, many children lose an important learning tool when they stop writing by hand. Writing by hand makes them think carefully about each word; as a result, they remember information better than when they type. For instance, a student who copies key notes by hand before an exam may recall them more easily, which can improve their grade. Secondly, poor handwriting can be a serious obstacle, as most public exams in Bangladesh are still written on paper. If examiners cannot read a pupil's answers, they may award fewer marks and, consequently, the pupil may lose places at good colleges. Although some pupils still practise writing at home, these learning and exam problems often harm their grades and future chances.

In conclusion, handwriting now receives less attention in many classrooms. While this trend can give pupils more time for typing and computer skills, it often weakens their memory and puts them at a disadvantage in exams. Therefore, I believe that the drawbacks outweigh the benefits.

Technology & Internet

26 · TEC-01

> *Many things that used to be done in the home by hand are now being done by machines. Does this development bring more advantages or disadvantages?*

In many homes today, tasks once done by hand, such as washing and cooking, are performed by machines. Although this change can encourage inactivity and create electronic waste, it also saves time and gives women more opportunities to work. In my view, this development brings more benefits than drawbacks.

There is little doubt that household machines offer considerable advantages to modern families. To begin with,

household machines have saved a great deal of time that was once spent washing clothes by hand, cleaning and cooking. This is because a washing machine can do in minutes what once took hours of hard work. For example, a mother who once spent her whole morning on laundry can now finish it in an hour, which leaves time for her children. In addition, this has been particularly important for women in many societies, who traditionally did most of the housework. As a result of this free time, women can study, work outside the home and pursue a career, which raises family income. Overall, household technology makes daily life easier and gives families more control over their time.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that household machines also have some

drawbacks. Firstly, because so many tasks no longer require physical effort, many people now lead a sedentary lifestyle. Without hard housework, they burn fewer calories; as a result, the risk of obesity, back pain and heart disease increases. For instance, a family that relies on machines for every task may hardly move all day, which can lead to weight gain. Secondly, electronic waste can be a serious problem, as old devices are often thrown away rather than repaired or recycled. If old fridges and washing machines end up in landfill, harmful chemicals can contaminate soil and water and, consequently, harm people's health. Although these health and environmental problems are real, exercise and proper recycling can reduce them.

In conclusion, machines now do much of the housework once done by hand. While they may encourage inactivity and add to electronic waste, they save precious time and allow women to build careers. Overall, I believe this is a positive development.

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27 · TEC-02

> *Some people argue that technological inventions, such as mobile phones, are making people socially less interactive. Do you agree or disagree?*

It is often argued that modern inventions, such as mobile phones, are reducing the amount of real contact that people have with each other. I completely agree with this view because

these devices replace real conversation and weaken young people's social skills.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that mobile phones reduce face-to-face interaction at home and among friends. This is because many people now prefer sending a message to having a conversation, and it is common to see friends sitting together while each person looks at their own phone. Parents may be answering work emails while children watch videos; as a result, meaningful conversation becomes rare. For example, a family may eat dinner in the same room while each person reads a separate screen, and parents may not even notice when their children are facing problems. Therefore, over time, this can weaken family bonds and friendships.

Another important reason for my agreement is that phones weaken young people's social skills. When teenagers communicate mainly by message, their conversations are often short and shallow, and young people in particular may not develop the confidence to speak, listen and read body language in real situations. For instance, a teenager who chats online for hours may feel nervous during a job interview, which can harm their future career. Although some people argue that a worker who has moved abroad can see and talk to their children every evening through a video call, this does not help people who ignore those beside them. Consequently, phones are making people less interactive in the daily situations that matter most.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that inventions such as smartphones are making human beings less socially active. Screens are taking the place of real talk between friends and relatives, and they also leave the younger generation less confident in person.

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28 · TEC-03

> *Modern technology is now very common in most workplaces. How do you think this has changed the way we work? Do you think there are disadvantages to relying too much on technology?*

Modern technology has become a normal part of almost every workplace. It has made work faster and more flexible, and I firmly believe that relying on it too heavily brings serious disadvantages.

One of the main ways in which technology has changed work is that tasks are now completed much faster. Machines and software can complete repetitive tasks faster and more accurately than people. For example, accounting software can process thousands of payments in a few minutes, a task that once took several workers many days. Another important change is that work is no longer limited by place. Business meetings increasingly take place online, which saves time and travel costs and allows companies to work with partners in other countries. Consequently, work has become faster, cheaper and far more flexible than before.

As for whether relying too much on technology has disadvantages, I firmly believe that it does because a single

system failure can stop an entire organisation. When computer systems crash or are hacked, staff cannot open their files, serve customers or even communicate with each other. For instance, a hospital whose computers are locked by hackers may have to delay operations, which puts patients' lives at risk. Although some people argue that technology makes every task easier, workers who depend completely on software may not know how to cope when it fails. Therefore, companies should never depend on technology without backup systems and well-trained staff.

In conclusion, technology has made modern work quicker and less tied to one location. I firmly believe that over-reliance on it is risky because system failures can bring work to a sudden stop.

29 · TEC-04

> *Some people think that the range of technology currently available is increasing the gap between rich people and poor people. Others think that it is causing the opposite effect. Discuss both views and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that modern technology is widening the gap between rich and poor, others believe that it is narrowing this gap. I completely support the latter view because cheap devices give low-income people new opportunities.

On the one hand, people who believe that the gap is growing argue that people and countries that own advanced technology, skills and capital tend to benefit the most. Workers in routine jobs

may lose their income, while the profits go mainly to company owners and highly skilled employees. Routine tasks are increasingly performed by machines; as a result, poorer workers fall further behind. For example, a factory owner who installs robots may become richer, while replaced workers struggle to find new jobs, and this makes inequality worse. For this reason, many people believe that technology mainly helps the wealthy.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that technology is narrowing the gap because cheap smartphones and mobile banking have helped many low-income people in developing countries to earn and save. When a person can reach customers through a phone, they no longer need a shop or large savings, and their income can grow quickly. For instance, a small

entrepreneur can open an online store or a social media page and sell products across the country, which was once possible only for large companies. Although some people argue that machines take jobs from poor workers, a mobile phone now gives many people a new chance to earn money. Consequently, modern technology is helping ordinary people to improve their lives.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether modern technology widens or reduces the gap between rich and poor. While machines can replace some workers, I firmly believe that the gap is narrowing because low-cost devices create new ways to earn money.

> *New household appliances have resulted in more free time for women and have enabled them to both work and run a home with dependent children. What are the advantages for a family when the mother works? Do you think the disadvantages outweigh the advantages?*

Modern household appliances have given many mothers the time to work while raising children. Although working mothers may have less time at home and a heavier workload, they bring extra income and a positive role model. In my opinion, the advantages clearly outweigh the disadvantages.

There is little doubt that a working mother offers considerable advantages to her family. To begin with, the most

obvious benefit is a second income, which raises the family's standard of living. This is because two salaries can pay for better food, housing, education and healthcare, which one salary often cannot cover. For example, a mother who works as a teacher can help to pay her children's university fees, so they do not have to leave their studies early. In addition, a working mother is not only a financial support but also a positive role model for her children. As a result of seeing her succeed, daughters learn that women can build careers, while sons learn to respect women's work. Overall, a mother's job strengthens both the family's finances and its values.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that a mother's job also has some drawbacks. Firstly, she may have less time to spend with her children during

the day. Young children may spend long hours with relatives or carers; as a result, they may miss their mother's attention at important moments. For instance, a mother who works until the evening may miss her child's school prize-giving, which can leave the child feeling disappointed. Secondly, many women face a double burden, as they do paid work during the day and most of the housework at night. If nobody shares these tasks, the mother may become exhausted and, consequently, her health and patience may suffer. Although these problems are real, they become much smaller when fathers share housework and childcare equally.

In conclusion, many mothers now combine paid work with family life. While this can reduce family time and double their workload, it raises the

family's income and gives children an inspiring example. Therefore, I believe the benefits outweigh the drawbacks.

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31 · TEC-06

> *With the development of technology children are now living in a world that is completely different to what it was 50 years ago. What problems does this cause for society and the family?*

Children today are growing up in a world that is very different from the one their parents knew. This can lead to weaker family relationships and new dangers to children's safety online.

The most serious problem for families is that technology can weaken the relationship between parents and children. It is now common to see a

family sitting in the same room, with each person absorbed in a separate screen. Parents may also struggle to understand the games, apps and websites that fill their children's online world, which creates a generation gap. For example, a father who never uses social media may not realise that his daughter is being bullied online, so she may feel that she has nobody to turn to. Consequently, over time, this can weaken family bonds.

Another problem is that society faces new dangers to children's safety online. Many children use the internet without adult supervision, and they may come across violent or adult content, or be contacted by strangers who pretend to be friends. Parents often find it difficult to control their children's internet use, because children may be more skilled

with technology than they are, and devices are easy to hide. For instance, a ten-year-old who secretly plays online games at midnight may be contacted by a stranger who pretends to be another child. Consequently, schools, the police and governments face new challenges in protecting young people.

In conclusion, growing up surrounded by technology often weakens the bond between parents and children. It also exposes young people to online risks that families, schools and governments must now manage.

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32 · TEC-07

> *An increasing number of people are now using the internet to meet new people and socialise. Some people think this has brought people closer*

> *together while others think people are becoming more isolated. Discuss both sides and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that using the internet to socialise makes people more isolated, others believe that it brings them closer together. I completely support the latter view because online contact often leads to real friendships.

On the one hand, people who see the internet as isolating argue that online relationships are often superficial. Many people spend several hours a day online without noticing, time that could be used for study, exercise, sleep or face-to-face relationships. Real conversations are slowly replaced by messages; as a result, users may feel lonely even with many online friends. For example, a teenager who chats with strangers late at night may rarely talk to their own family, and

this can lead to loneliness. For this reason, many people believe that the internet is making people more isolated.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that the internet brings people closer because someone who feels isolated in their town can find others who share the same hobby, illness or life experience. When people find such groups, they receive advice and emotional support, and friendships are no longer limited by geography. For instance, a young mother who has moved to a new city can join an online parents' group and later meet other mothers in real life, which makes a new home less lonely. Although some people argue that online contact is superficial, it is often the first step towards a real friendship. Consequently, the internet has become a powerful tool against loneliness.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether socialising online makes us closer or more isolated. While too much screen time can harm relationships, I firmly believe that the internet brings people together because online contact helps them to form real friendships.

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33 · TEC-08

> *More and more children are accessing the internet unsupervised and at a younger age. This can sometimes put children at risk. What problems do you think parents face when dealing with their children using the internet? How can this problem be solved?*

These days, children are going online alone at an increasingly young age,

which can put them at risk. Parents often cannot control this use or see the dangers, but clear rules and open communication can reduce these difficulties.

The most serious problem is that parents often find it difficult to control their children's internet use. This is because children may be more skilled with technology than they are, and devices are easy to hide. For example, a child who is better with technology can hide a tablet under the bed and stay online all night, and the parents may never find out. Another problem is that parents may not see the dangers online. Many children use the internet without adult supervision, and they may come across violent or adult content, or be contacted by strangers who pretend to be friends.

Consequently, children may face serious risks without anyone noticing.

The most effective solution is for parents to set clear limits on how and where their children go online. Keeping devices in shared family spaces rather than bedrooms makes them harder to hide, and parental control software can limit screen time. For instance, a child who must charge a tablet in the living room at night cannot stay online in secret, which gives the parents real control. In addition, parents and schools could teach children about online dangers. When parents talk openly with their children and schools teach online safety, children are more likely to recognise strangers and report anything worrying. Together, these measures would help parents to protect children online.

In conclusion, parents struggle because children can hide their online activity and may meet dangers that adults cannot see. Firm household rules and honest discussion about internet safety would help families to keep young users safe.

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34 · TEC-09

> *Nowadays children watch a lot of TV and play video games. However, some people think that these activities are not good for a child's mental health. To what extent do you agree or disagree?*

These days, children spend many hours in front of television and video games, and many believe that this harms their mental health. I completely agree with this view because these activities

increase aggression and anxiety and they also disturb children's sleep.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that too much screen entertainment can increase aggression and anxiety in young minds. This is because violent games may make some children more aggressive, and frightening programmes can leave them feeling worried long after they have finished watching. Fast-moving videos and games give constant excitement; as a result, some children become restless and easily upset when they have to do something slower. For example, a child who plays a violent game for hours may start to shout at their family when they are told to stop, and this behaviour can damage relationships at home. Therefore, heavy use of these activities

can seriously harm a child's emotional health.

Another important reason for my agreement is that screen time often disturbs children's sleep. When children stay up to watch a programme or finish a game, they lose the rest that a growing mind needs, because using screens late at night can also disturb sleep patterns. For instance, a child who plays games until midnight may become irritable and anxious the next day, which makes school feel stressful and lowers their confidence. Although some people argue that educational apps, videos and online games can make learning enjoyable, many children choose entertainment instead of learning when nobody is watching them. Consequently, long hours of television and games can slowly damage a child's mental well-being.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that television and video games are bad for the mental health of young people. They encourage aggressive and anxious behaviour, and they also rob children of the deep rest that they need.

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35 · TEC-10

> *It is common nowadays for each member of the family to have their own piece of modern technology. Some people think this will lead to a breakdown in family relationships and communication. To what extent do you agree?*

Nowadays, it has become normal for every person in a household to own a smartphone, tablet or laptop, and many believe that this damages family ties. I completely agree with this view because

these devices reduce conversation at home and take away shared family time.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that personal devices reduce the amount of real conversation between family members. This is because people who are absorbed in a separate screen pay little attention to those around them, even when they are sitting in the same room. Parents may be answering work emails while children watch videos; as a result, meaningful conversation becomes rare. For example, a teenager who spends every evening on a phone may never mention a problem at school, and the parents may only discover it when it has become serious. Therefore, the daily talks that keep families close are slowly disappearing from many homes.

Another important reason for my agreement is that individual devices

leave family members with less time together. When everyone can watch their own films and play their own games, people no longer need to share an activity, so family bonds weaken over time. For instance, a family in Dhaka that once watched television together after dinner may now scatter to different rooms as soon as the meal ends, which leaves children feeling distant from their parents. Although some people argue that technology helps relatives in different cities stay in contact, this benefit does little for family members who live under the same roof. Consequently, the home becomes a place where relatives live side by side but rarely connect.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that giving each family member a personal device harms relationships and communication

within the home. Smartphones and tablets limit everyday talking between parents and children, and they also replace the activities that relatives once enjoyed together.

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36 · COM-10

> *With an increasing population communicating via the internet and text messaging, face-to-face communication will become a thing of the past. To what extent do you agree?*

It is sometimes claimed that, because more people now use the internet and text messages, talking to each other in person will soon disappear. I completely disagree with this view because online messages are often shallow and many

important events still require people to meet.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that online messages cannot provide the depth of a real meeting. This is because, although people may communicate more often, their conversations are often short and shallow, and they cannot replace the trust and warmth of real contact. Humans also need to read body language and hear a friend's voice; as a result, strong relationships are still built mainly in person. For example, after long periods of online classes, most students were eager to return to school to see their friends, and this showed how much they had missed real contact. Therefore, people will continue to choose personal contact whenever a relationship truly matters to them.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that many important events still require people to meet in person. When people attend a wedding, a job interview or a medical consultation, they need to be physically present, because trust and care are difficult to show through a screen. For instance, a doctor who examines a patient in a clinic can notice signs of illness that a text message could never show, which can lead to safer treatment. Although some people argue that many people now prefer sending a message to having a conversation, this habit is used mainly for quick and everyday matters. Consequently, digital tools will support face-to-face communication in the future instead of replacing it.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that talking in person will remain a normal

part of life, however popular messaging becomes. Digital contact lacks the warmth of real meetings, and major life events will always bring people together physically.

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37 · COM-11

> *More and more businesses as well as individuals are choosing to communicate either professionally or socially using technology rather than face to face. Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of using technology for communicating.*

Today, many companies and individuals communicate through technology rather than meeting in person. Although this can cause misunderstandings and weaken face-to-face skills, it also saves

time and money and keeps people connected across long distances.

There is little doubt that digital communication offers considerable advantages to businesses and individuals. To begin with, business meetings increasingly take place online, which saves time and travel costs. This is because managers no longer need to fly between cities, so decisions can be made in hours, not weeks. For example, a garment exporter in Dhaka can now meet European buyers by video call instead of flying abroad, which greatly reduces costs. In addition, for individuals, smartphones, messaging apps, social media and video calls allow people to stay in touch instantly and almost free of charge. As a result, families stay close across borders, which can reduce loneliness and homesickness,

especially for migrants and elderly people who live alone. Overall, technology makes working life and personal relationships faster, cheaper and less limited by distance.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that digital communication also has some drawbacks. Firstly, many people experience misunderstandings when they communicate only through short messages. Without facial expressions and tone of voice, a message can easily sound rude; as a result, conflicts may arise at work or between friends. For instance, a manager who sends a short email to a colleague may seem angry, which can damage their working relationship. Secondly, the decline of face-to-face interaction can be a serious problem, as many people now prefer sending a message to having a

conversation. If young people rarely talk in person, they may not develop the confidence to speak, listen and read body language and, consequently, struggle in interviews. Overall, these communication problems can weaken relationships both at work and in private life.

In conclusion, communicating through screens has become normal in business and private life. While it may cause misunderstandings and weaken people's social skills, it saves time and money and keeps families close across distances.

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38 · COM-13

> *Some people think that being able to communicate with others online is breaking down geographical barriers and enabling people who*

> *would normally never have the chance to meet to communicate. What are the advantages of international communication online? Are there any disadvantages to this?*

Online communication now allows people from different countries, who would otherwise never meet, to talk freely. Although this can lead to cultural misunderstandings and online fraud, it also builds international friendships and creates new learning opportunities.

There is little doubt that international online communication offers considerable advantages to ordinary people. To begin with, the most significant benefit is that friendships are no longer limited by geography. This is because people can exchange ideas, learn about each other's cultures and build international friendships through social

media and video calls. For example, a Bangladeshi student who chats weekly with a partner in Canada improves her English, and she learns about Canadian life. In addition, online communication not only connects friends but also allows teams in different countries to work together without expensive travel. As a result of this cooperation, small firms can find foreign partners and skilled workers abroad, which creates new business opportunities. Overall, connecting with people across borders broadens minds and opens new doors in study and work.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that international online communication also has some drawbacks. Firstly, many users experience misunderstandings when they talk with people from different cultures. Without shared

customs or a common first language, a joke can easily sound offensive; as a result, friendships may end in arguments. For instance, a young person who uses informal slang in a chat with a Japanese partner may seem rude, which can upset the partner. Secondly, online fraud can be a serious danger, as criminals send fake emails and messages that look as if they come from a bank. If people trust a stranger they have only met online, they may share personal details and, consequently, lose their savings. Overall, these cultural and safety risks can make online contact with strangers abroad stressful.

In conclusion, the internet now lets people talk to anyone in the world. While such contact may lead to misunderstandings and scams, it builds

friendships across borders and creates chances to learn and work together.

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39 · COM-14

> *With the development of online communication, people will never be alone and will always be able to make new friends. To what extent do you agree?*

It is often argued that the growth of online communication means that nobody will ever feel lonely and that finding new friends will always be easy. I completely disagree with this view because online contact cannot replace real companionship and online friendships are often weak.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that online contact cannot fully replace real companionship. This is

because, although people have hundreds of online "friends", some feel more isolated than ever. Users constantly see carefully edited photos of other people's holidays, bodies and achievements; as a result, many begin to compare themselves unfavourably with others and feel even lonelier. For example, a young worker who chats online every evening may see a friend's holiday photos and feel that their own life is dull, and this can leave them feeling even more alone. Therefore, a busy online life does not mean that a person is no longer alone.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that friendships made online are often weak. When people know each other only through a screen, they may not be there to help in a crisis, such as an illness or an accident. For instance, a teenager with many followers

may still feel lonely if nobody visits them when they are sick, which shows that many contacts do not equal true friendship. Although some people argue that shy people, in particular, may find it easier to start a conversation online, a first conversation does not always grow into a lasting relationship. Consequently, making contacts online does not guarantee new friends whom a person can truly depend on.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that internet communication cannot end loneliness or guarantee genuine friends. Messages and video chats do not match the presence of another person, and many web relationships are too fragile to offer support.

> *Communication through text messaging and other instant forms of online communication is short and basic. Some people think this will be the death of grammar and spelling. Do you agree or disagree?*

It is often argued that the short, simple language of text messages and online chats will eventually destroy correct grammar and spelling. I completely disagree with this view because people can easily switch between informal and formal writing and schools continue to teach standard language.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that people naturally use different styles of language for different situations. This is because people simply switch between informal and formal

styles, as they have always done, just as they speak differently to friends and to employers. Most young people know that text messages and social media posts are usually brief and informal; as a result, they write very differently in a job application. For example, a student who texts in short forms all day can still write a well-organised essay in class, and this shows that the two styles do not have to mix. Therefore, texting simply adds a new informal style without destroying the standard language.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that formal writing is still taught and required. When students enter schools, universities or workplaces, they must produce essays, reports and emails with correct grammar and spelling, so they have a strong reason to keep these skills. For instance, a job

applicant who wants to impress an employer will check every word of their application carefully, which shows that accuracy still matters in real life. Although some people argue that students bring these habits into their academic writing, teachers can correct such mistakes easily through regular practice and feedback. Consequently, good grammar and spelling will survive for as long as education and employment continue to demand them.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that instant messaging will not bring an end to accurate grammar and spelling. People clearly understand which style suits each situation, and education and employers will continue to expect careful writing.

41 · CRI-01

> *The crime rate nowadays is decreasing compared to the past due to advanced technology which can prevent and solve crime. Do you agree or disagree?*

Sample answer 1

It is often argued that crime is lower today than in the past because advanced technology helps to prevent and solve it. I completely disagree with this view because technology has created new types of crime and online criminals are very difficult to catch.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that technology has created new types of crime. This is because online fraud and hacking are increasing rapidly as more people manage their money through the internet. Criminals send

fake emails and messages that look as if they come from a bank, encouraging people to share their passwords; as a result, a single click on a dangerous link can lead to the loss of a person's savings. For example, a retired teacher who answers a fake bank message may lose their pension in a few minutes, and this crime can happen without any thief entering the house. Therefore, crime has simply moved online and changed its form instead of falling.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that online criminals are very difficult to catch. When a crime is committed through the internet, police face a serious problem, because online criminals often operate from other countries and can hide their identity. For instance, a hacker who robs a family in Dhaka from another country under a

false name may never be found, which leaves the victim without justice. Although some people argue that CCTV cameras, mobile phone records and DNA databases have helped to identify criminals, these tools are useful mainly for street crimes instead of crimes committed online. Consequently, technology cannot be given credit for a general fall in crime.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that modern technology has not made crime less common than it was in the past. It has opened the door to digital offences such as fraud, and it also allows offenders to hide across national borders.

Sample answer 2

It is often argued that there is less crime today than in the past because advanced technology helps to prevent and solve it.

I completely disagree with this view because technology helps criminals as well as the police and it cannot remove the causes of crime.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that technology helps criminals as well as the police. This is because criminals have also used technology to commit new types of crime, such as online fraud and hacking. Cybercrime is one of the fastest-growing types of crime in the world, and it affects individuals, businesses and governments; as a result, people can now be robbed without leaving their homes. For example, a criminal in another country can empty a victim's bank account in minutes through a fake message, and this crime may never appear in local police records. Therefore, technology has changed the

form of crime more than it has reduced it.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that technology cannot remove the causes of crime. When people commit crimes because of their situation, cameras and databases do not help, as they cannot solve the underlying causes of crime, such as poverty, unemployment, poor education and drug addiction. For instance, a young person without a job may still steal from a market in spite of the CCTV cameras, which only record the crime after it has happened. Although some people argue that DNA testing has helped solve many crimes, solving a crime afterwards does not mean that fewer crimes are being committed. Consequently, technology alone cannot be responsible for a lower crime rate.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that advanced technology has not caused a general fall in crime. Offenders now use digital tools to find new victims, and cameras and databases also fail to address problems such as poverty and addiction.

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42 · CRI-15

> *Internet crime is increasing rapidly as more and more people are using the internet to make financial transactions. What can be done to tackle this problem?*

Sample answer 1

Online fraud and hacking are increasing rapidly as more people manage their money through the internet. Banks and governments can tackle this by

improving security, and individuals can help by learning safe online habits.

The most effective solution is for banks and governments to make online payments much harder to attack. Hackers can steal financial data within seconds; therefore, banks must invest heavily in cybersecurity. Banks use computer systems to detect unusual payments that might be fraud, and they can block suspicious transactions before any money is lost. For example, if a criminal tries to move a customer's savings to a foreign account at midnight, the bank's system can stop the payment and warn the customer immediately. Consequently, these measures make it much harder for online criminals to succeed.

In addition, individuals could protect themselves by learning a few safe habits.

Criminals send fake emails and messages that look as if they come from a bank, encouraging people to share their passwords, so users should never share PINs or one-time codes. Individuals also have a role to play: using strong passwords, turning on two-step verification and avoiding suspicious links can greatly reduce the risk of online fraud. For instance, an elderly woman who has turned on two-step verification will keep her account safe even if a criminal steals her password, because the thief cannot receive the code. Consequently, well-informed users would give criminals far fewer victims.

In conclusion, internet crime can be reduced if banks and governments strengthen online security. Careful habits among ordinary users, such as

protecting passwords and codes, would also make online payments much safer.

Sample answer 2

As more people use the internet to make payments and manage their savings, online crime is rising quickly. Governments can tackle this by creating specialist police units, and banks can help by protecting and educating their customers.

The most effective solution is for governments to give the police the tools to fight online crime. Governments should create specialist cybercrime units with trained officers and modern equipment, and they should pass strong laws against online fraud and data theft. Because cybercrime crosses borders, international cooperation between police forces is essential for tracking and arresting criminals. For example, if a

fraudster abroad steals money from a bank account in Bangladesh, police in both countries can share information quickly to trace and arrest him. Consequently, criminals would no longer feel safe hiding behind a screen in another country.

In addition, banks could protect their customers more actively. They can use stronger security systems, such as two-step verification, monitor unusual transactions and quickly block suspicious accounts. Banks should also teach customers about common scams through text messages, posters and short videos, especially elderly people and new internet users. For instance, a pensioner who is warned by text that banks never ask for PINs may refuse to share his code with a caller pretending to be from the bank, which protects his life savings.

Together, these measures would make online payments much safer for every customer.

In conclusion, internet fraud can be reduced if governments create skilled cybercrime units and work with other countries. Stronger bank security and regular customer education would also leave criminals with far fewer victims.

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43 · BUS-02

> *More and more business meetings are taking place online. What are the advantages and disadvantages of this trend?*

More and more business meetings are now held online instead of in offices. Although online meetings can weaken trust and are often disrupted by technical problems, they also save

companies time and money and reduce travel.

There is little doubt that online meetings offer considerable advantages to companies and their employees. To begin with, the most significant benefit is that online meetings can replace some business travel, which reduces flights and fuel use. This is because employees no longer waste hours travelling between cities or waiting at airports. For example, a sales team that once flew to Chittagong every month can now hold the same meeting by video, which saves time and fuel. In addition, online meetings not only save money but also make it easy for companies to work with partners in other countries. As a result of this wider reach, even small firms can find foreign customers and skilled workers abroad, which helps them grow. Overall, holding

meetings online makes businesses more efficient, more international and more environmentally friendly.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that online meetings also have some drawbacks. Firstly, many companies find it harder to build trust with new clients through a screen. Without body language or informal chat, online conversations are often short and shallow; as a result, important deals may be lost. For instance, a foreign buyer who has never met a supplier in person may prefer a competitor he has visited, which means a lost contract. Secondly, technical problems can be a serious obstacle, as poor internet connections often interrupt important discussions. If the video keeps freezing during a presentation, participants may lose concentration and, consequently, the meeting may fail to

reach any decision. Overall, these relationship and technical problems can make online meetings less effective than meeting face to face.

In conclusion, video calls have replaced many traditional business meetings. While they may weaken trust between partners and be disrupted by poor connections, they save time and money and help firms work internationally.

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44 · BUS-08

> *An increasing number of people are buying what they need online. What are the advantages and disadvantages of shopping online for both individuals and companies?*

More and more people now shop online rather than in stores. Although online shopping can expose customers to fraud

and harm local shops, it also offers convenience to shoppers and lower costs to firms.

There is little doubt that online shopping offers considerable advantages to both customers and companies. To begin with, the most significant benefit for individuals is that they can buy goods without leaving home. This is because they can compare prices, read reviews and order goods at any time of day, which saves both time and money. For example, a worker who compares phone prices online at night can order the cheapest one, and this saves a market trip. In addition, for companies, online selling not only reduces operating costs but also reaches customers far beyond the local area. As a result, a small entrepreneur can open an online store or a social media page and sell products

across the country. Overall, e-commerce saves shoppers effort and gives businesses of every size a much larger market.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that online shopping also has some drawbacks. Firstly, many customers experience problems with quality and fraud when they buy from unknown sellers. Without the chance to touch products, they cannot check what they are paying for; as a result, they may be cheated. For instance, a student who pays for a phone on a social media page may receive a fake model, which wastes his savings. Secondly, small shops face a serious threat, as they cannot match the prices and delivery speed of big online retailers. If local shops continue to lose customers, many will close and, consequently, town centres can become

empty, and communities lose part of their character. Overall, these consumer and business problems make online shopping risky for some buyers and communities.

In conclusion, internet shopping has become part of everyday life. While it may expose shoppers to cheating and push small shops out of business, it offers convenience to customers and wider markets to sellers.

Environment

45 · ENV-01

> *Human activity has had a negative impact on plants and animals around the world. Some people think that this cannot be changed, while others believe actions can be taken to bring about a change. Discuss both and give your opinion.*

Human activity has seriously damaged plants and animals worldwide. While some people argue that this damage cannot be reversed, others believe that determined action can still change the situation. I completely support the latter view because many damaged areas can recover.

On the one hand, people who hold the pessimistic view argue that the damage is too great to stop. As human populations grow, forests are cleared for farms, roads, housing and industry, leaving animals with nowhere to live and find food. Natural habitats are being lost faster than they can recover; as a result, many species are in danger. For example, the Sundarbans mangrove forest is home to the Bengal tiger, but pressure from human activity and rising sea levels threatens this unique environment. For this reason, many people believe that the damage to nature cannot be changed.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that action can bring change because large-scale tree-planting programmes, especially with native species, can restore damaged land. When wildlife is

protected by strict anti-poaching laws and local people are employed as forest guards, illegal hunting falls, and damaged forests can recover. For instance, a village guide who earns money from eco-tourism has a strong reason to protect the forest, which helps wildlife to return. Although some people argue that growing populations will always destroy nature, people can also choose to protect it when they gain from doing so. Consequently, the harm done to plants and animals can still be changed.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether the damage to plants and animals can be reversed. While growing populations put great pressure on nature, I firmly believe that change is possible because protected forests can recover.

46 · ENV-02

> *It is often said that governments spend too much money on projects to protect wildlife, while there are other problems that are more important. Do you agree or disagree?*

It is often said that governments spend too much on protecting wildlife when more serious problems need their attention. I completely disagree with this view because conservation protects the natural systems that humans depend on and also creates jobs for local communities.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that protecting wildlife also protects the natural systems that humans need. This is because every species plays a role in its ecosystem, and if one species disappears, the whole

system can be affected. Bees and other insects pollinate many of the crops we eat; as a result, losing them would directly threaten the food supply of millions of people. For example, a village that loses its bees may harvest far less fruit and fewer vegetables, and this can leave many families without enough food. Therefore, money spent on wildlife is also money spent on human survival.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that wildlife projects bring direct economic benefits to people. When visitors come to see rare animals, they spend money, because national parks and wildlife reserves attract tourists, who pay for guides, hotels and food, creating jobs for local people. For instance, a villager near a forest reserve who works as a guide can earn a steady income, which gives their family a reason

to protect the animals. Although some people argue that a hospital or school should come before a tiger reserve, the money spent on conservation is usually a small part of national budgets. Consequently, cutting these projects would save very little money and cost poor communities a valuable source of income.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that public money spent on wildlife is not wasted, even when other serious problems exist. Healthy ecosystems support human life, and nature-based tourism also gives poor communities a reliable way to earn money.

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47 · ENV-03

> *Some people think the best way to solve global environmental problems*

> *is to increase the cost of fuel. To what extent do you agree or disagree?*

It is sometimes claimed that making fuel more expensive is the most effective answer to the world's environmental problems. I completely disagree with this view because higher prices hurt poor families most and they do nothing to solve many other environmental problems.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that higher fuel prices hurt poor families most. This is because poor households spend a larger share of their income on transport and cooking fuel than wealthy households do. The prices of food and other goods also rise when transport becomes more expensive; as a result, these families may have to spend less on meals or school fees. For example, a rickshaw puller who must pay

more for rice and vegetables may have to take a child out of school, while rich drivers will hardly notice the difference. Therefore, this policy places the heaviest burden on those who have done least to cause the problem.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that fuel prices do nothing to solve many other environmental problems. When governments rely only on fuel costs, they ignore issues that have little connection with petrol, such as deforestation, plastic waste and illegal hunting. For instance, a higher diesel price will not stop a company from dumping plastic in a river or cutting down a forest, which needs strict laws instead. Although some people argue that expensive fuel makes people drive less, a person cannot take the bus if there is no reliable bus service.

Consequently, governments should create the rules and the infrastructure that make green choices easy and affordable instead of simply raising prices.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that raising the price of fuel is not the best way to protect the global environment. This policy is unfair to low-income households, and it also leaves problems such as plastic waste and forest loss untouched.

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48 · ENV-04

> *Some people think an international car-free day is an effective way to reduce air pollution. Others think there are more effective ways to do*

> *this. Discuss both sides and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that an international car-free day can reduce air pollution effectively, others believe that there are better solutions. I completely support the latter view because one day cannot solve a problem that exists all year.

On the one hand, people who support car-free days argue that they raise public awareness of dirty air. Some cities have tried car-free days or charges for driving in the city centre, which raise awareness and reduce traffic. Streets are closed to traffic for a day; as a result, people see how much cars affect their city. For example, a family who walks or cycles on a car-free day may discover that short journeys do not need a car, and this can change their habits. For this reason,

many people believe that such a day is an effective way to reduce pollution.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that other measures are more effective because air pollution continues all year. When a car-free day ends, drivers simply return to their cars, but governments can invest in public transport, such as metro rail systems and reliable bus networks. For instance, a worker in Dhaka who can take the metro rail to the office every day may leave their motorbike at home, which reduces pollution all year. Although some people argue that a car-free day raises awareness, awareness alone cannot help people who have no other way to travel. Consequently, if cities invest in public transport, fewer people will drive, and the air will become cleaner.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether a car-free day is the best way to reduce air pollution. While such a day can raise awareness, I firmly believe that other solutions are better because public transport reduces traffic every day.

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49 · ENV-05

> *While some people consider global warming to be the most pressing environmental problem which we have at the moment, others believe that deforestation has a more devastating impact on our world. Discuss both sides and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that deforestation is doing the most damage to our planet, others believe that global

warming is the most urgent environmental problem. I completely support the latter view because it affects every country.

On the one hand, people who focus on forests argue that deforestation causes immediate and visible damage. Large areas of forest are cleared to create farmland for crops and cattle, or to grow plantation crops such as palm oil. Without tree roots to hold the soil, heavy rain can wash it away, causing soil erosion, floods and landslides; as a result, homes and lives can be lost. For example, when hills are cleared for housing, nearby villages may be buried by landslides in the rainy season, and whole families may lose their homes. For this reason, many people believe that deforestation has the more devastating impact.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that global warming is the more pressing problem because it threatens the whole planet. When temperatures rise, storms and droughts become stronger, and farmers in many regions suffer from unpredictable rainfall, which threatens food security. For instance, low-lying countries such as Bangladesh face more frequent floods and cyclones, and salt water is entering farmland in coastal areas, making it harder to grow crops. Although some people argue that cleared forests cause faster damage, these losses are mainly local, whereas rising temperatures harm people in every region. Consequently, global warming is the greatest environmental threat today.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether deforestation or global warming is the more serious problem.

While cutting down forests causes severe local damage, I firmly believe that global warming is worse because it affects the whole world.

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50 · ENV-06

> *The government should reduce the amount of money spent on local environmental problems and instead increase funding into urgent and more threatening issues such as global warming. To what extent do you agree?*

It is often argued that governments should cut spending on local environmental problems and use this money for more serious threats such as global warming. I completely disagree with this view because local pollution

damages people's health and it also destroys their livelihoods.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that local pollution directly damages people's health every day. This is because breathing polluted air every day can cause asthma, lung disease and heart problems, and children and elderly people are especially vulnerable. Dirty rivers also spread disease in communities that have no other water supply; as a result, families face high medical bills and hospitals become overcrowded. For example, a family that drinks from a polluted river may spend much of its income on medicine, and this harm is happening now, not decades in the future. Therefore, local problems are urgent because they are already harming people today.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that local environmental damage destroys people's livelihoods. When governments ignore this damage, ordinary workers suffer first, as when rivers are poisoned, fishing communities lose their income, and when soil is damaged, farmers produce less food. For instance, a fishing family whose river is full of factory waste may have to move to a city slum, which creates new social problems. Although some people argue that global warming is a far greater threat, local problems, like a polluted river or a lack of parks in a city, are usually best solved by national and local authorities. Consequently, governments must keep funding local projects, because nobody else will do this work.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that money for local environmental projects

should not be moved to global issues. Pollution nearby threatens public health now, and it also takes away the jobs and food that ordinary families need.

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51 · ENV-07

> *With increasing populations and ever-growing urban centres, many countries are losing their natural beauty spots. What benefits are there to protecting places of natural beauty? How can this be solved?*

As populations and cities grow, many countries are losing their places of natural beauty. These places improve people's health and support tourism, and their loss can be prevented through national parks and smarter city planning.

One of the main benefits of protecting natural places is better health for people. They provide clean air and water, protect biodiversity and offer people a place to relax and escape the stress of city life, which improves mental health. For example, a family from Dhaka who spends a weekend in the tea gardens of Sylhet can breathe clean air and return home much calmer, and this helps them cope with city stress. Another important benefit is that beautiful natural places attract visitors. Tourists pay for hotels, guides, transport and food; as a result, places such as the beach at Cox's Bazar support thousands of local families. Consequently, these places are valuable for both people's well-being and the national economy.

The most effective solution is for governments to turn important beauty

spots into national parks. Governments can declare protected areas and national parks where cutting trees and building are banned, and they must enforce these laws strictly. For instance, a hill forest that becomes a national park can no longer be cleared for housing, which keeps it safe for future generations. In addition, city planners could find space for new homes without destroying nature. Housing needs can often be met by building upwards or developing unused industrial land, rather than destroying parks. Together, these measures would allow cities to grow while their natural beauty survives.

In conclusion, places of natural beauty keep people healthy and bring tourism income to local communities. National parks and careful planning of new

housing would protect them as cities continue to expand.

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52 · ENV-08

> *Although many people value their public parks, this space could be better used for other purposes such as residential areas for the ever-growing population or to develop business and boost the economy. To what extent do you agree or disagree with this?*

It is sometimes claimed that city parks should be replaced with homes for the growing population or with businesses that support the economy. I completely disagree with this view because parks protect people's health and cities can find other land for development.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that parks are essential for people's physical and mental health. This is because parks give children a safe place to play and adults a place to exercise, relax and meet neighbours, which improves both physical and mental health. Trees absorb pollution, provide shade and reduce temperatures in hot weather; as a result, people who live near green spaces can breathe cleaner air. For example, in a crowded city such as Dhaka, a family living beside a large park can breathe cleaner air and escape the summer heat, and losing it would leave them with only traffic fumes. Therefore, parks are not a luxury but a basic need for urban families.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that cities can find other land for housing and business. When a

city needs more homes, housing needs can often be met by building upwards or developing unused industrial land, rather than destroying parks. For instance, an old factory site can be turned into apartments while the nearby park remains open to everyone, which gives families both a home and a place to relax. Although some people argue that a growing population needs housing and businesses need space to grow, once a natural place is covered with concrete, it is almost impossible to restore it. Consequently, destroying parks is a permanent loss that growing cities can easily avoid.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that public green spaces should not be sacrificed for apartments or commercial buildings. They keep city residents healthy, and

urban growth can take place on unused land without destroying them.

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53 · ENV-09

> *With deforestation, urban development and illegal hunting, many animal species are becoming endangered as they lose their habitat and some are even threatened to the point of extinction. Do you think it is important to protect animals? What measures can be taken to deal with this problem?*

Deforestation, urban development and illegal hunting are pushing many animal species towards extinction. I firmly believe that protecting animals is important, and strict anti-poaching laws and community involvement would help to save them.

I firmly believe that protecting animals is important because every species helps to keep the natural system that humans depend on in balance. Every species plays a role in its ecosystem; for instance, bees and other insects pollinate many of the crops we eat, and predators control the population of other animals. For example, if bees disappeared from an area, farmers would lose much of their fruit and vegetable harvest, which would raise food prices for everyone. Although some people argue that housing and farming should come first, people themselves suffer when wildlife disappears, because their food and water depend on healthy ecosystems. Therefore, protecting animals is also a way of protecting ourselves.

One important measure is for governments to enforce strict anti-

poaching laws in protected areas. When trained forest guards patrol national parks and hunters receive heavy fines or prison sentences, killing rare animals becomes far too risky. For instance, a poacher who knows that rangers patrol the Sundarbans day and night is much less likely to hunt tigers there. In addition, governments could employ local people as forest guards or tourist guides. When communities earn money from living animals, they have a strong reason to protect them. Together, these measures would give endangered species a real chance of survival.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that saving animals matters because ecosystems and human life depend on them. Tough laws against hunting and jobs that reward local people for

protecting wildlife would help endangered species to survive.

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54 · ENV-10

> *Global warming is one of the biggest threats to our environment. What causes global warming? What solutions are there to this problem?*

Global warming is among the most serious dangers facing the natural world today. It is mainly caused by burning fossil fuels and destroying forests, but renewable energy and forest protection can tackle this problem.

The main cause of global warming is the burning of fossil fuels. When coal, oil and natural gas are burned in power stations, factories, cars and aeroplanes, they release carbon dioxide and other greenhouse gases into the atmosphere.

For example, a power station that burns coal to supply a large city releases carbon dioxide every day, and this gas traps heat around the Earth like a blanket. Another important cause is deforestation, which is often carried out to create farmland. Trees absorb carbon dioxide; when forests are cut down or burned, this natural protection is lost. Consequently, more heat is trapped around the planet every year.

The most effective solution is for governments to replace fossil fuels with renewable energy. When they offer financial incentives, such as subsidies or tax reductions, households and businesses can afford solar panels, so less coal and oil are burned. For instance, a Bangladeshi village family that installs solar panels with government help no longer depends on

electricity from coal, which reduces its carbon emissions. In addition, governments could protect the world's remaining forests. They can declare protected areas and national parks where cutting trees and building are banned, and large-scale tree-planting programmes, especially with native species, can restore damaged land. Together, these measures would reduce greenhouse gases and slow the warming of the planet.

In conclusion, global warming results mainly from the use of coal, oil and gas and the loss of trees. Clean power and stronger protection of woodland would significantly reduce this threat to the planet.

55 · ENV-11

> *Both governments and individuals are spending vast amounts of money protecting animals and their habitat. This money could be better spent dealing with fundamental issues in society such as poverty and health care. To what extent do you agree?*

It is often argued that the large sums spent on protecting animals and their homes should instead be used to tackle poverty and improve healthcare. I completely disagree with this view because conservation protects what humans need to survive and it can also reduce poverty.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that protecting animals and their habitats also protects what humans need to survive. This is because protecting

forests and rivers also protects the clean water, food and climate that humans depend on. Damaged forests and polluted rivers make people sick; as a result, healthcare costs rise and the poorest families suffer first. For example, a village that loses its forest and drinks from a polluted river may face constant illness, and this forces poor families to spend their small savings on medicine. Therefore, conservation supports human health as well as animals.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that conservation can actually reduce poverty. When people earn a living from nature, they gain a strong reason to protect it, as national parks and wildlife reserves attract tourists, who pay for guides, hotels and food, creating jobs for local people. For instance, a family living near a reserve

who open a small guesthouse may be able to send their children to school, which helps them to escape poverty. Although some people argue that poverty is more urgent, the money spent on conservation is usually a small part of national budgets. Consequently, moving this money elsewhere would hardly solve poverty, and it would destroy a useful source of income.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that money for protecting wildlife and habitats should not be redirected to other social problems. Healthy nature keeps human communities alive, and it also offers poor families useful work and income.

> *As a result of growth in some urban centres, the environment in those cities is deteriorating. How could this issue be tackled by both the government and individuals?*

As many cities grow rapidly, their air, water and streets are becoming dirtier and more crowded. Governments can tackle this by improving public transport and controlling pollution, while individuals can help by changing their daily habits.

The most effective solution is for governments to reduce traffic and pollution in growing cities. Governments can invest in public transport, such as metro rail systems and reliable bus networks, so that people do not need private cars. Strict rules on vehicle

emissions and factory pollution, together with fines for those who break them, can reduce dirty air. For example, a factory owner who must pay a heavy fine for releasing black smoke will soon install filters, which makes the air in nearby neighbourhoods much cleaner. Consequently, government action can tackle the biggest sources of urban pollution.

In addition, individuals could change their daily habits to protect their city. Individuals can contribute too, by using public transport, sharing cars, keeping their vehicles well maintained and taking part in tree-planting or clean-up activities. Separating household waste, avoiding plastic bags and saving electricity at home also reduce the pressure on overloaded city services. For instance, a family that stops using plastic

bags and separates its waste can help to keep local drains clear, which reduces flooding in the rainy season. Together, these measures would make crowded cities much cleaner and healthier places for everyone to live.

In conclusion, the declining environment of growing cities can be improved if governments invest in transport and enforce pollution laws. Responsible habits among residents, such as reducing waste, would add to this progress.

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57 · ENV-13

> *Some people think that current environmental issues are global problems and should therefore be dealt with by the government while others believe that these problems can only be tackled by individuals.*

> *Discuss both sides and give your opinion.*

While some people believe that environmental damage can only be reduced by ordinary citizens, others argue that such worldwide problems are the responsibility of governments. I completely support the latter view because only governments have the necessary power.

On the one hand, people who support individual action argue that every person contributes to the problem through the energy they use and the products they buy. Individual actions may seem small, but they add up when millions of people take part. By using public transport and avoiding single-use plastic, ordinary families can reduce pressure on the environment. For example, a family in Dhaka that travels by bus and carries

cloth bags produces less waste, and this change costs them very little. For this reason, many people believe that protecting the environment must begin with the ordinary citizen.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that governments should deal with these problems because they alone have the power to act on a large scale. When pollution comes mainly from power stations and factories, strict laws and large investments in clean energy are required, and a single person cannot provide them. For instance, a factory owner who pollutes a river may ignore residents' complaints, but a law with heavy fines can force every factory to clean up its waste. Although some people argue that small actions add up, people can only make green choices if those choices are available and affordable.

Consequently, individual effort cannot succeed unless governments take the lead.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether citizens or national leaders should tackle environmental damage. While individual choices can reduce waste and pollution, I firmly believe that governments should solve these problems because only they can make changes on the required scale.

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58 · ENV-14

> *Global environmental issues are the responsibility of rich nations not of poorer nations. Do you agree with this opinion?*

It is sometimes claimed that solving the world's environmental problems is the duty of wealthy countries and not of

poorer ones. I completely disagree with this view because developing countries are now major polluters and they also have the power to solve their own problems.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that developing countries are now major sources of pollution. This is because some developing countries are now among the fastest-growing sources of emissions as they industrialise. If only some countries reduce their emissions while others continue to pollute heavily, the overall problem will not be solved; as a result, every nation must take part. For example, a new coal power station in a poor country releases the same gases as one in a rich country, and these gases warm the whole planet in exactly the same way. Therefore, global problems

cannot be solved if poorer nations are excused from the effort.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that poorer nations have the power to solve many of their own problems. When environmental damage happens inside a country, its government can act, because deforestation, river pollution and waste problems also occur in poorer countries, and their own governments have the power to address them. For instance, a government in a developing country can stop factories from releasing untreated waste into rivers, which protects its own people. Although some people argue that rich countries have produced the largest share of greenhouse gases over the past two centuries, this history does not remove the duty of other countries to act today. Consequently, poorer nations

should act now instead of waiting for rich countries.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that protecting the planet is a duty for every country, whatever its wealth. Poorer nations now add greatly to global pollution, and their leaders are also able to deal with damage at home.

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59 · ENV-15

> *Many people believe that global environmental problems should be dealt with internationally rather than domestically. What is your opinion?*

It is often argued that the world's environmental problems should be solved through cooperation between countries rather than by each country alone. I completely agree with this view

because these problems cross national borders and countries are more willing to act together.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that environmental problems cross national borders. This is because greenhouse gases released in one country warm the whole planet, air pollution can travel to neighbouring countries, and plastic dumped in one river can end up on beaches thousands of kilometres away. No single government can control what happens beyond its own borders; as a result, domestic action alone cannot protect its citizens. For example, a shared river can only be protected if all neighbouring countries control pollution, and one careless factory upstream can harm millions of people downstream. Therefore, problems that belong to the

whole world need solutions that involve the whole world.

Another important reason for my agreement is that countries are more willing to act together. When a government acts alone, it may hesitate, because countries may also worry that strict environmental rules will make their industries less competitive, so they are more willing to act if they know that others are doing the same. For instance, a country may accept a limit on factory emissions when its trading partners accept the same limit, which protects its businesses. Although some people argue that national governments understand local conditions better, global warming and ocean plastic are far too large for them. Consequently, international agreements offer the strongest way to deal with these threats.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that worldwide environmental threats should be tackled jointly by nations instead of separately. Pollution pays no attention to borders, and shared agreements also give governments the confidence to introduce stronger rules.

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60 · ENV-16

> *Many animals are being hunted to the brink of extinction in order to fulfil the demand and greed of mankind for decorative purposes as well as for other reasons, such as traditional medicine. How can this issue be tackled?*

Many animals are being hunted almost to extinction to supply decorative items and traditional medicines. Governments can tackle this by enforcing strict laws

against poaching, and campaigners can help by reducing the demand for animal products.

The most effective solution is for governments to make poaching and smuggling far more difficult. Because these products can be sold for high prices, criminal groups are willing to take great risks. Strong border controls, heavy prison sentences for traffickers and well-trained forest guards with modern equipment can make those risks much greater than the profits. For example, a smuggler who knows that customs officers check every container for ivory is far less likely to try to move it across the border. Consequently, strict enforcement can cut the supply of these products before they reach the market.

In addition, awareness campaigns could reduce the demand for animal products.

Public campaigns, supported by well-known celebrities, can show consumers that buying ivory, horns or animal skins directly causes the death of endangered animals. Doctors and traditional healers can also promote alternative medicines that do not use animal parts, so buyers have a safe choice. For instance, a man who learns that a rhino was killed to make his medicine may choose a herbal remedy instead, which removes one more buyer from the market. Together, these measures would make hunting endangered animals both dangerous and unprofitable.

In conclusion, the hunting of rare animals for decoration and medicine can be reduced if governments enforce tough laws. Education that lowers the demand for animal products would also remove the profit that drives poaching.

61 · ENV-17

> *Restricting air travel is the only way to prevent air pollution. Do you agree?*

It is sometimes claimed that limiting the number of flights is the only solution to air pollution. I completely disagree with this view because most dirty air comes from other sources and many other solutions are more effective.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that most air pollution comes from sources other than aeroplanes. This is because it comes from vehicle exhaust, factories, construction dust, brick kilns and the burning of waste, which affect cities every day. These sources are located close to where people live and work; as a result, they cause far more harm to public health than planes flying

high above. For example, brick kilns on the outskirts of many cities produce thick smoke during the dry season, and this smoke is breathed by thousands of local families. Therefore, restricting flights would leave the main causes of dirty air untouched.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that many other solutions are more effective. When governments want cleaner air, they can use strict rules on vehicle emissions and factory pollution, together with fines for those who break them, and they can replace coal power stations with renewable energy. For instance, a city that fines factories for releasing black smoke can reduce air pollution within months, which protects local families every single day. Although some people argue that aeroplanes burn large

amounts of fuel, restricting travel completely would be neither realistic nor fair. Consequently, it is clearly wrong to describe limits on air travel as the only answer.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that reducing air travel is not the only way to stop air pollution. Vehicles and factories create far more everyday pollution, and stronger laws and cleaner transport can clean the air more effectively.

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62 · TOU-09

> *Many people around the world now take regular international flights. Do the advantages of this trend outweigh the disadvantages to the environment?*

Many people around the world now take international flights for work and

holidays. Although frequent flying adds to climate change and damages popular natural sites, it supports millions of jobs and keeps families connected. In my opinion, the advantages clearly outweigh the disadvantages.

There is little doubt that regular international flights offer considerable advantages to people and economies. To begin with, the greatest benefit is that air travel supports tourism and international trade. This is because tourism generates income and employment for millions of people, including hotel staff, guides, drivers and craftspeople. For example, a tour guide in Nepal who shows foreign visitors around the mountains can earn enough to send his children to a good school. In addition, flights not only bring cultures together but also connect families

separated by migration. As a result of cheaper air travel, a Bangladeshi worker in the Middle East can visit his family every year, which keeps their bonds strong. Overall, regular flights support jobs, family life and understanding between people from different nations.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that frequent flying also has some drawbacks. Firstly, the most serious problem is the large amount of carbon that aeroplanes produce. Aeroplanes burn large amounts of fuel; as a result, frequent flying adds significantly to climate change. For instance, a single long-distance return flight can produce as much carbon per passenger as several months of driving, which shows how quickly the damage adds up. Secondly, mass tourism can damage the very natural places that travellers come to see

and enjoy. If popular beaches, mountains and islands are crowded with hotels and roads, habitats are destroyed and, consequently, wildlife disappears. Although these problems are serious, cleaner aircraft fuels and responsible travel choices can greatly reduce them.

In conclusion, international air travel has become a normal part of modern life. While it increases carbon emissions and puts pressure on fragile natural sites, it creates jobs and keeps people connected across borders. Therefore, I believe the benefits outweigh the drawbacks.

63 · TOU-10

> *Raising the cost of international flights is the best way to reduce air pollution. Do you agree?*

It is sometimes claimed that making overseas flights more expensive is the most effective way to cut air pollution. I completely disagree with this view because higher prices are unfair to ordinary families and flights are not the main cause of air pollution.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that higher flight prices are unfair to ordinary families. This is because this would make travel a privilege for the rich and would hurt families who need to visit relatives abroad. Wealthy passengers can easily pay an extra charge; as a result, they would keep flying while poorer passengers stay at

home. For example, a Bangladeshi worker in the Middle East who saves for a whole year to visit their family may no longer be able to afford the ticket, and this would keep parents and children apart. Therefore, this policy would punish people who fly out of need and not for pleasure.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that flights are not the main source of air pollution in most countries. When people breathe dirty air in cities, the real causes are on the ground, because it comes from vehicle exhaust, factories, construction dust, brick kilns and the burning of waste. For instance, a family living beside a busy road in Dhaka breathes traffic fumes all day, which a more expensive ticket would not change. Although some people argue that higher prices could reduce

unnecessary flights and raise money for clean energy, strict rules on vehicle emissions and factory pollution would clean the air much faster. Consequently, raising ticket prices cannot be the best way to deal with this problem.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that increasing the cost of overseas air travel is not the most effective way to reduce pollution. It places an unfair burden on ordinary travellers, and it also ignores the traffic and factories that cause most dirty air.

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64 · HOU-02

> *Planting trees is very important for the environment. Some people say trees should be planted in the vacant areas of cities and towns, while*

> *others say housing should be built instead. Do you agree or disagree?*

While some people argue that empty land in cities should be used for housing, others believe that trees should be planted there. I completely support the latter view because green spaces make cities healthier for everyone who lives in them.

On the one hand, people who support building homes argue that a growing population needs housing and businesses need space to grow. Rising rents push many low-income families into crowded slums with poor sanitation. New flats can be built on empty land quite quickly; as a result, more families can afford a safe home. For example, an apartment block on a vacant plot in Dhaka could house hundreds of families, and this would reduce pressure on

nearby slums. For this reason, many people believe that vacant land should be used for housing.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that trees should be planted on this land because trees absorb pollution, provide shade and reduce temperatures in hot weather. When a crowded area has a park, residents enjoy cleaner air, and they also have a place to exercise, relax and meet neighbours. For instance, a small green area in a crowded part of Dhaka can provide cool shade for thousands of residents, which makes hot summer months easier to bear. Although some people argue that families urgently need homes, housing needs can often be met by building upwards or developing unused industrial land. Consequently, vacant land in cities should be kept for trees.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether vacant urban land should be used for trees or for housing. While growing cities need more homes, I firmly believe that trees should come first because green areas protect people's health.

Health & Lifestyle

65 · HEA-01

> *The prevention of health problems and illness is more important than treatment and medicine. Government funding should reflect this. To what extent do you agree?*

It is often argued that stopping people from becoming ill matters more than curing them, and that public health budgets should follow this principle. I completely agree with this view because prevention is far cheaper than treatment and it also protects people's quality of life.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that prevention is far cheaper than treatment. This is because it is

usually far cheaper to prevent a disease than to treat it, and public money is always limited. Encouraging people to stop smoking, eat healthily and exercise can reduce the number of people who develop lung cancer, diabetes and heart disease; as a result, hospitals have more money for other patients. For example, a campaign that helps thousands of people to stop smoking costs much less than treating them for lung cancer, and this saved money can then be used for other health services. Therefore, prevention is an investment that makes treatment more affordable.

Another important reason for my agreement is that prevention protects people's quality of life. When people avoid serious illness, they can continue to work, study and care for their families, and they do not have to suffer pain or

long hospital stays. For instance, a middle-aged worker whose high blood pressure is found during a regular check-up can change their diet and avoid a heart attack, which keeps them healthy and working. Although some people argue that people will still have accidents, catch infections, develop genetic illnesses and grow old, hospitals will need fewer resources when preventable diseases decline. Consequently, government funding should give prevention the priority that it deserves.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that stopping illness should be more important than curing it in public health spending. Early action saves large sums of public money, and it also allows citizens to live longer and more active lives.

> *The number of people who are at risk of serious health problems due to being overweight is increasing. What is the reason for the growth in overweight people in society? How can this problem be solved?*

A growing number of people now face serious health risks because they are overweight. This is mainly because of unhealthy diets and a lack of exercise, but healthier food policies and more active routines can tackle this problem.

One of the main causes of this trend is an unhealthy diet, especially the regular consumption of fast food, sweets, fried snacks and sugary drinks. Portion sizes have also grown, and many people eat more calories than their bodies need. For example, an office worker who buys a

burger and a sugary drink every lunchtime may eat too many calories, and this extra energy is stored as fat. Another important cause is a lack of physical activity. Many jobs now involve sitting at a desk all day, people travel by car or motorbike instead of walking, and leisure time is often spent watching television or using smartphones. Consequently, many people burn far fewer calories than they consume.

The most effective solution is for governments to make healthy food the easier choice. If they tax sugary drinks and require clear food labels, people are less likely to buy unhealthy products. For instance, an office worker who sees the sugar content on a clearly labelled drink may choose water instead, which reduces their daily calories. In addition, governments and individuals could make

exercise part of daily life. When cities build parks and cycle lanes, people can walk or cycle more, and even simple activities, such as walking for thirty minutes a day, can make a significant difference. Together, these measures would help people to maintain a healthy weight.

In conclusion, more people are overweight because they eat too many calories and move too little. Clearer rules on food and more chances for daily activity would help people to stay healthy.

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67 · HEA-03

> *The amount of time spent on sport and exercise should be increased in schools in order to tackle the problem of overweight children. Do you think*

> *this is the best way to deal with the problem? What other solutions can you suggest?*

More school sport is often suggested as an answer to the rising number of overweight children. I firmly believe that this is not the best way, and healthier school meals and better habits at home would work better.

I firmly believe that extra school sport is not the best way to tackle this problem because diet has a stronger effect on weight than exercise. When children regularly eat more calories than their bodies need, one extra hour of activity cannot balance them, so they continue to gain weight. For example, a child who plays football for an hour at school but drinks several cans of soft drink and eats fried snacks at home will still gain weight. Although some people argue that

physical education keeps children active, it cannot undo the effects of an unhealthy diet. Therefore, increasing school sport alone cannot be the most effective answer.

The most effective alternative is for schools to improve the food that they provide. If schools offer healthy lunches, sell fruit instead of sweets and remove sugary drinks from vending machines, children will find healthy choices much easier. For instance, a pupil who can no longer buy a soft drink at break may start drinking water instead, which removes a large amount of sugar from their diet. In addition, parents could build better habits at home. When they prepare home-cooked meals and limit screen time, children eat fewer fried snacks and spend more time playing outside. Together, these measures would tackle

the main causes of childhood obesity far more effectively than extra sport.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that adding more sport to the timetable is not the ideal answer because food matters more. Healthier school food and sensible routines at home would help children to reach a healthy weight.

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68 · HEA-04

> *More and more people are suffering from health problems caused by a modern life style which cannot be treated with modern medicines. Some people think that a return to traditional medicine should be encouraged. To what extent do you agree?*

Because modern medicines cannot cure many illnesses caused by today's way of

life, it is sometimes claimed that people should go back to traditional remedies. I completely disagree with this view because these treatments can be dangerous and lifestyle diseases really need lifestyle change.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that many traditional treatments can be dangerous. This is because many traditional remedies have not been scientifically tested, so it is often unclear whether they work, what dose is safe or whether they interact dangerously with other medicines. People may use traditional remedies instead of seeking proper medical treatment for serious illnesses; as a result, diagnosis may be delayed until it is too late. For example, a patient with a serious infection who drinks herbal tea instead of taking antibiotics may become much worse, and

this delay can even cost them their life. Therefore, encouraging a return to these treatments would put many patients at risk.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that lifestyle diseases really need lifestyle change. When people become ill because of how they live, the answer is not necessarily traditional medicine but lifestyle change itself: better diet, more exercise, less stress and no smoking. For instance, an office worker with high blood pressure can improve their health by walking every day and eating less salt, which requires no special remedy at all. Although some people argue that some traditional remedies are cheap and easily available, low cost does not make a treatment safe or effective. Consequently, governments should promote healthy habits instead of

encouraging people to rely on untested treatments.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that traditional medicine should not be promoted as the answer to modern health problems. Untested remedies can seriously harm patients, and healthier daily habits are a far better way to deal with these conditions.

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69 · HEA-05

> *Health care should not be provided for free regardless of a person's income. The health of a person is in their own hands and they should, therefore, be held accountable for that. Do you agree with this opinion?*

It is sometimes claimed that medical care should not be free for everyone, because each person controls their own

health and should pay for it. I completely disagree with this view because many illnesses are beyond people's control and poor families cannot afford treatment.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that many illnesses are beyond people's control. This is because many illnesses are caused by genetics, accidents, poverty, pollution or old age, not by personal choices. Nobody chooses to be born with a weak heart or to be injured in a road accident; as a result, it is wrong to blame patients for most medical problems. For example, a child who develops a serious disease cannot be held responsible for it, and their treatment should not depend on what their parents earn. Therefore, health is not simply in people's own hands, and it would also be very difficult and unfair to decide who "deserves" treatment.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that poor families cannot afford treatment. When medical care is not free, poor families may delay seeing a doctor until a problem becomes serious, or they may have to sell land, borrow money or take children out of school to pay medical bills. For instance, in many developing countries, a single serious illness can push a family into long-term poverty, which can affect their children for many years. Although some people argue that taxes must be high to pay for it, no one should be denied treatment because they cannot afford it. Consequently, essential healthcare should remain free regardless of a person's income.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that every citizen should receive free medical care, whatever their income. Much sickness

has nothing to do with personal choices, and free treatment also protects low-income households from debt and hardship.

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70 · HEA-06

> *The best way to improve health is to exercise daily. To what extent do you agree?*

It is sometimes claimed that exercising every day is the most effective way to become healthier. I completely disagree with this view because exercise cannot cancel the effects of a poor diet and good health also depends on sleep and low stress.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that exercise cannot cancel the effects of a poor diet. This is because many fast foods and processed meals are

high in fat, sugar and salt, but low in vitamins, minerals and fibre. A person can easily eat more calories in one meal than they burn during a long walk; as a result, daily exercise alone may not prevent weight gain or illness. For example, a person who jogs every morning but drinks several soft drinks a day may still develop diabetes, and this shows that food has a powerful effect on health. Therefore, a healthy diet is at least as important as physical activity.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that good health also depends on enough sleep and low stress. When people feel anxious or sleep badly, their bodies and minds suffer, because a person who exercises every day but eats a poor diet, smokes, sleeps badly or suffers from constant stress will not be completely healthy. For instance, a

student who goes to the gym daily but studies until three every morning may still feel exhausted and depressed, which can damage their mental health. Although some people argue that physical activity helps people to maintain a healthy weight, on its own it is not enough. Consequently, a balanced approach is a better way to improve health than exercise alone.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that daily exercise is not the best single way to improve health. Physical activity cannot make up for unhealthy eating, and people also need proper rest and a calm mind to stay well.

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71 · HEA-07

> *Some people think that public health is the responsibility of the*

> *government while others think that people should be responsible for their own health. Discuss both sides and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that every person should be responsible for their own health, others believe that public health is the duty of governments. I completely support the latter view because individual choices depend on the wider environment.

On the one hand, people who support personal responsibility argue that health depends largely on daily choices. Adults choose what they eat and whether they exercise, and parents decide what their children eat at home. A person who smokes, drinks heavily or eats a very unhealthy diet is choosing to increase their risk of illness. For example, no law can force a person to go for a walk or

stop eating sweets at home, and these small decisions can shape their health for years. For this reason, many people believe that individuals should take responsibility for their own health.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that public health is the government's duty because individuals make their choices within an environment that is shaped by powerful food companies, advertising, city planning and prices. When unhealthy food is cheaper than healthy food, and when there are no parks or safe footpaths, it is difficult for people to stay healthy. For instance, a low-income family that lives far from any park and cannot afford fresh food may rely on cheap fried snacks, which increases the risk of obesity. Although some people argue that adults freely choose their habits, those choices are limited by what

is available and affordable. Consequently, governments must create a healthier environment so that public health can improve.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether governments or individuals should be responsible for public health. While personal habits affect everyone's health, I firmly believe that this duty belongs to governments because they shape the conditions in which people live.

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72 · HEA-08

> *Doctors should be responsible for educating their patients about how to improve their health. Do you agree with this?*

It is often argued that doctors should have the duty of teaching patients how to

become healthier. I completely agree with this view because patients trust their doctors' advice and health education can prevent serious illness in the future.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that patients trust advice from their doctors. This is because doctors understand each patient's medical history and can explain how lifestyle affects their particular condition. Some people search their symptoms online and either become unnecessarily worried or try to treat themselves; as a result, clear advice from a trained professional is extremely valuable. For example, a patient with diabetes is more likely to change their diet after a serious talk with their own doctor than after reading an online article, and this change can control the disease. Therefore, doctors

are in the best position to teach people how to live more healthily.

Another important reason for my agreement is that health education from doctors can prevent serious illness. When doctors are advising patients on how to improve their lifestyle, they can help them to act before a small problem becomes a dangerous one. For instance, a doctor who explains to a patient with high blood pressure how to reduce salt and walk daily may prevent a future heart attack, which also avoids expensive treatment. Although some people argue that doctors in busy hospitals have only a few minutes for each patient, even a short piece of personal advice can make a real difference. Consequently, prevention is an investment that makes treatment more affordable, and doctors should lead this work.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that teaching patients about healthy living should be part of every doctor's job. People take medical advice seriously, and early guidance can also stop minor conditions from developing into dangerous diseases.

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73 · HEA-09

> *Walking is known to be beneficial for health and yet fewer and fewer people are walking these days. What are the reasons for this? What can be done to tackle this problem?*

Despite its well-known health benefits, walking is becoming less common in modern life. This is mainly because city streets are unsafe and technology has made it unnecessary, but safer footpaths

and better daily habits can tackle this problem.

One of the main causes of this trend is that walking in large cities has become unpleasant and dangerous. Heavy traffic, air pollution and broken footpaths make short journeys on foot stressful, so many people avoid them. For example, a parent who must walk beside fast buses on a broken footpath may take a rickshaw for a five-minute journey, and this soon becomes a habit. Another important cause is technology, which has removed much of the physical effort from daily life. Lifts replace stairs, and online shopping means that people do not even need to walk to the shops. Consequently, walking has gradually disappeared from the daily routines of many people.

The most effective solution is for governments to make streets safer for pedestrians. When city planners build safe footpaths and separate them from traffic, walking becomes pleasant and practical rather than stressful. For instance, a parent who can reach the local market on a wide, well-lit footpath may no longer need a rickshaw, which adds exercise to their day at no cost. In addition, employers and individuals can bring walking back into everyday routines. Workplaces can encourage staff to use the stairs, while people can walk to nearby shops instead of ordering online, and these small changes quickly add up. Together, these measures would make walking a normal part of modern life again.

In conclusion, people walk less because urban streets are hazardous and

technology has reduced physical effort. Safer pedestrian routes and small changes to everyday habits would encourage more people to walk regularly.

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74 · FOO-01

> *With a growing world population one of the most pressing issues is that of feeding such a large number of people. Some people think that GM foods offer a viable solution to this problem. To what extent do you agree or disagree?*

As the global population continues to rise, it is often argued that genetically modified crops are a practical way to feed everyone. I completely agree with this view because these crops produce larger harvests and they can also survive difficult weather conditions.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that GM crops produce larger harvests. This is because scientists can develop plants that grow faster and resist pests and diseases, so farmers lose less of their crop each year. Higher yields also mean that less forest needs to be cleared for new farmland; as a result, more food can be grown without damaging the natural environment. For example, a small farmer who plants pest-resistant rice may harvest much more from the same piece of land, and this means that no nearby forest has to be cleared. Therefore, GM foods offer a realistic way to increase the world's food supply.

Another important reason for my agreement is that GM crops can survive difficult weather conditions. When climate change brings drought, floods or salty soil, ordinary crops often fail, but

some GM varieties can continue to grow in these conditions. For instance, farmers in coastal Bangladesh, where salt water is entering farmland, could grow salt-tolerant rice, which would protect their income and their food supply. Although some people argue that GM foods may have long-term effects on human health, careful testing can ensure that only safe products reach the market. Consequently, these crops can protect food production in the regions that are most at risk of hunger.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that genetically modified food is a workable answer to the challenge of feeding a growing world. Such crops give farmers bigger yields, and they also remain productive when the climate becomes harsh.

75 · FOO-02

> *Some people think that educating people about the problems of eating too much fast food has no effect and that other measures should be taken to tackle this issue. What is your opinion?*

It is sometimes claimed that warning people about the dangers of too much fast food has no real effect and that different action is needed. I completely agree with this view because knowledge alone does not change eating habits and other measures work far better.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that knowledge alone does not change eating habits. This is because most people already know that burgers, fried chicken and soft drinks are unhealthy, yet they continue to eat them.

Fast food is quick and convenient, which is important for people who work long hours, study late or have long journeys to and from work; as a result, they choose it even when they understand the risks. For example, a tired office worker who has seen many health campaigns may still buy fried chicken on the way home, and this habit is unlikely to change after another campaign. Therefore, information campaigns alone cannot solve this problem.

Another important reason for my agreement is that other measures work far better. When the price of unhealthy food rises, behaviour changes, because taxes on sugary drinks can encourage companies to reduce sugar and customers to choose healthier options. For instance, a student who finds that a soft drink now costs much more may

choose water instead, which reduces their sugar intake every day. Although some people argue that schools can teach children basic cooking skills and the principles of a balanced diet, these lessons cannot compete with cheap food and constant advertising. Consequently, governments should rely on taxes, clear labels and advertising rules to tackle this problem.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that teaching the public about fast food is not enough, and stronger action is required. Awareness rarely alters what people eat, and price controls and advertising limits are also more likely to succeed.

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76 · FOO-03

> *People should only buy food sourced locally. What are the advantages and*

> *disadvantages of this?*

Some people argue that consumers should buy only food produced in their own area. Although this approach can limit people's diets and raise prices after poor harvests, it also supports local farmers and provides fresher food.

There is little doubt that buying local food offers considerable advantages to farmers and shoppers. To begin with, the most significant benefit is that money spent on local produce stays in the community. This is because families who buy rice, fish and vegetables from nearby producers pay farmers, which helps them earn a fair income. For example, a farmer who sells vegetables at a village market keeps most of the profit, and this lets him pay his children's school fees. In addition, local food is not only fresher but also better for the environment,

because it travels shorter distances. As a result of shorter journeys from farm to table, vegetables keep more vitamins, and lorries use less fuel, which reduces pollution. Overall, eating locally builds stronger rural communities and a healthier, greener food system.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that buying only local food also has some drawbacks. Firstly, many families would have a less varied diet if they could not buy food from other regions. Without imported products such as wheat, fruit and spices, meals become repetitive; as a result, people may lack some important nutrients. For instance, a family in a cold country that ate only local food would have little fresh fruit in winter, which could harm their health. Secondly, poor harvests can be a serious obstacle, as floods or droughts can destroy local

crops in a single season. If no food could be brought in, prices would rise sharply and, consequently, poor families might go hungry. Overall, these dietary and supply problems could make a local-only diet unhealthy and unreliable.

In conclusion, eating only food from nearby farms is a popular idea. While it may narrow people's diets and leave them exposed to poor harvests, it helps farmers earn more and gives families fresher food.

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77 · FOO-04

> *The government should ban convenience foods to improve public health. Do you agree?*

It is sometimes claimed that governments should stop the sale of convenience foods in order to make

people healthier. I completely disagree with this view because a ban would be unrealistic and it would also limit personal freedom.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that a ban would be unrealistic and would cause new problems. This is because banning fast food or convenience food would be very difficult to enforce, would cause many people to lose their jobs and might simply create illegal markets. Millions of people earn their living from these products; as a result, a ban would take away the income of many families. For example, a factory worker who packs instant noodles could lose their job overnight, and this would harm their whole family without making anyone healthier. Therefore, this policy would create more problems than it would solve.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that a ban would limit personal freedom. When people decide what to eat, they make a personal choice, as adults should be free to decide what they eat and drink, even if their choices are not healthy. For instance, a busy parent who chooses a frozen meal on a difficult evening is making a personal decision, which does no harm if it happens only occasionally. Although some people argue that many fast foods and processed meals are high in fat, sugar and salt, most people can enjoy fast food occasionally without harm. Consequently, clear nutritional information and education would improve public health without taking away this choice.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that removing ready-made food from shops is

not the right way to improve public health. Such a law could not work in practice, and it would also take away people's right to choose their own meals.

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78 · FOO-05

> *Some people think that the increase in the number of obese people should be the responsibility of the government, while others think it should be the responsibility of individuals. Discuss both sides and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that individuals should be responsible for the rise in obesity, others believe that this problem should be handled by the government. I completely support the latter view because obesity affects the whole of society.

On the one hand, people who blame individuals argue that obesity results from personal decisions. Portion sizes have also grown, and many people eat more calories than their bodies need. Many people also drive or take a rickshaw even for very short journeys; as a result, they burn very few calories. For example, a person who drinks two cans of soft drink every day and never walks to work is making choices that lead to weight gain, and no one forces them to do this. For this reason, many people believe that individuals are responsible for their own weight.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that the government should deal with this problem because treating obesity-related diseases costs public healthcare systems a great deal of money. When unhealthy food is cheap and heavily advertised,

many people buy it every day, and only governments have the power to change these prices. For instance, a sugar tax can push companies to make healthier drinks, which helps millions of customers to reduce their sugar intake. Although some people argue that adults choose what they eat, these choices are strongly influenced by price and advertising. Consequently, the government is in the best position to tackle obesity.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether governments or individuals should be responsible for the rise in obesity. While people choose their own meals, I firmly believe that governments should tackle this problem because its costs are carried by society.

> *With a growing population, many people believe that we should focus on producing more GM foods. What are the advantages and disadvantages of doing this?*

Many people believe that more genetically modified (GM) food is needed to feed a growing population. Although GM crops may raise safety concerns and make farmers dependent on big companies, they can also increase harvests and reduce pesticide use.

There is little doubt that GM technology offers considerable advantages to farmers and growing populations. To begin with, the most significant benefit is that GM crops can produce much larger harvests. This is because scientists can design plants that resist insects and

survive drought or salty soil, which reduces crop losses. For example, a farmer in a coastal area with salty soil could grow a salt-tolerant rice variety, and this would protect her family's income. In addition, GM crops not only increase the food supply but also need fewer chemical pesticides. As a result of using fewer chemicals, farmers save money and rivers stay cleaner, which benefits both people and wildlife. Overall, GM technology could make food production more productive, affordable and environmentally friendly, especially in developing countries.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that GM foods also have some drawbacks. Firstly, many consumers feel uneasy about eating food whose genes have been changed in a laboratory. Without clear labels and simple

information, they cannot judge the risks themselves; as a result, many refuse to buy GM products. For instance, a shopper who sees that a product contains GM corn may choose a more expensive natural brand, which raises her food costs. Secondly, seed control by a few large companies can be a serious obstacle, as farmers may have to buy new seeds every year. If seed prices rise or a harvest fails, small farmers may fall into debt and, consequently, lose their land. Overall, these trust and economic problems can make GM farming risky for consumers and small farmers alike.

In conclusion, GM crops are often seen as a way to feed the world. While such crops may worry shoppers and leave small farmers in debt, they can produce bigger harvests with fewer chemicals.

> *Putting a tax on sugar is a good way to reduce the number of people incurring health problems from eating too much sugary foods and drinks. Do you agree?*

It is often argued that taxing sugar is an effective way to reduce the health problems caused by too many sweet foods and drinks. I completely agree with this view because higher prices discourage unhealthy habits and the money can also support healthier choices.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that higher prices discourage unhealthy habits. This is because, when the price of a product rises, people usually buy less of it, especially young people and those on low incomes. A tax

on sugary drinks can encourage people to choose water or milk instead; as a result, they consume less sugar, and it can push companies to reduce the amount of sugar in their products. For example, higher taxes on cigarettes have been followed by a fall in smoking in many countries, and there is good reason to expect a similar result with sugary drinks. Therefore, a sugar tax can reduce the number of people who develop diet-related diseases.

Another important reason for my agreement is that the money raised can support healthier choices. When governments collect this tax, the money they raise can be used to make healthy food cheaper, for example by supporting fruit and vegetable markets, and to fund education campaigns. For instance, a poor family that pays a little more for

soft drinks could also pay less for fresh vegetables, which would improve the whole family's diet. Although some people argue that such taxes fall most heavily on poor families, these families also suffer most from diet-related illness and gain most from cheaper healthy food. Consequently, a tax on unhealthy products can pay directly for cheaper healthy food and better health education.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that a tax on sugar is an effective way to reduce diet-related illness. Extra costs persuade consumers to buy less sugar, and the income can also make nutritious food cheaper for ordinary families.

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81 · FOO-08

> *An increasing number of children are overweight which could result in*

> *many problems when they grow older both in terms of their health and health care costs. Why do you think so many children are overweight? What could be done to solve this problem?*

More and more children are becoming overweight, which could harm their health when they grow older. This is mainly because they eat unhealthy food and rarely play outside, but healthier school meals and safe playgrounds can tackle this problem.

One of the main causes of this trend is that children eat too much unhealthy food. Busy parents may also buy ready-made food because they have little time to cook, and children are surrounded by advertisements for snacks and soft drinks. For example, a child who plays football for an hour at school but drinks

several cans of soft drink and eats fried snacks at home will still gain weight. Another important cause is that many children no longer play outside. In some cities, there are few safe parks or playgrounds, so parents prefer to keep their children indoors, where they often play video games. Consequently, these children burn little energy, and many become overweight adults.

The most effective solution is for schools to make healthy food the normal choice. Schools can improve the food they provide by offering healthy lunches, selling fruit instead of sweets and removing sugary drinks from vending machines. For instance, a child who can only buy fruit and water during the school day may gradually lose the taste for soft drinks, which reduces the calories they consume. In addition,

parents and governments could give children more chances to be active. When governments build playgrounds and parents limit screen time, children have a safe and enjoyable alternative to video games. Together, these measures would help children to develop healthy habits.

In conclusion, many young people are overweight because of poor diets and too little outdoor activity. Better school food and more safe places to play would help them to stay healthy as they grow older.

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82 · FOO-09

> *Unless fast foods and ready-made meals are banned, traditional*

> *methods of cooking will soon be lost. To what extent do you agree?*

It is sometimes claimed that traditional cooking will soon disappear if fast food and ready meals are not banned. I completely disagree with this view because most families still value home cooking and schools and parents can protect these skills without a ban.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that most families still value home cooking. This is because traditional dishes are closely connected with family life, culture and religion, so people do not give them up easily. Most people can enjoy fast food occasionally without harm; as a result, a burger at the weekend does not mean the end of home cooking. For example, a Bangladeshi family that orders pizza on Friday will still prepare traditional dishes for Eid

and other festivals, and these meals bring relatives together every year. Therefore, traditional cooking is far stronger than this view suggests.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that schools and parents can protect cooking skills without a ban. When young people learn to cook, traditional food stays alive, and schools can teach children basic cooking skills and the principles of a balanced diet. For instance, a school that teaches pupils to prepare a simple fish curry passes on a valuable skill, which costs little and can last a lifetime. Although some people argue that traditional cooking skills may not be passed on to the next generation, banning fast food completely would be unrealistic and would limit personal freedom. Consequently, education and

family habits are the best ways to protect these dishes for the future.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that traditional methods of cooking can survive without any ban on fast food. Home-cooked meals remain an important part of family culture, and lessons at home and at school can also keep these skills alive.

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83 · FOO-10

> *With a fast pace of modern life more and more people are turning towards fast food for their main meals. Do you think the advantages outweigh the disadvantages?*

As modern life speeds up, more people now depend on fast food for their main meals. Although fast food can save busy people time and money, it often damages

their health and weakens family cooking traditions. In my opinion, the disadvantages of this trend outweigh the advantages.

There is little doubt that fast food offers considerable advantages to busy people. To begin with, fast food is quick and convenient, which is important for people who work long hours. This is because a hot meal can be ordered through a delivery app and arrive in minutes, so no time is spent shopping or cooking. For example, a worker who leaves the office late can buy dinner on the way home, which saves her time and energy. In addition, fast food is not only cheap but also available on almost every street corner in towns and cities. As a result of these low prices, students and low-income workers can afford a filling meal, which reduces their daily

expenses. Overall, fast food makes everyday life more convenient and affordable for people with busy schedules.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that fast food also has some drawbacks. Firstly, many people experience health problems, because fast foods and processed meals are high in fat, sugar and salt. Without enough vitamins and fibre, they often gain weight; as a result, their risk of diabetes and heart disease rises. For instance, a child who eats fried chicken every day may become overweight, which can harm his health for life. Secondly, the decline of home cooking can be a serious problem, as many busy families stop cooking and eating together. If parents rarely cook, traditional cooking skills may not be passed on to the next generation and,

consequently, local food culture may disappear. Although some people can enjoy fast food in moderation, these health and family problems often cause lasting harm.

In conclusion, relying on fast food has become a common modern habit. While takeaway meals can be quick and affordable, they frequently lead to illness and reduce the time families spend cooking together. Therefore, I believe that the drawbacks outweigh the benefits.

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84 · FOO-11

> *Everyone should adopt a vegetarian diet because eating meat can cause*

> *serious health problems. Do you agree or disagree?*

It is sometimes claimed that everybody should stop eating meat because it can lead to serious illness. I completely disagree with this view because meat provides important nutrients and people should be free to follow their own culture and food choices.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that meat provides important nutrients. This is because meat, fish and eggs contain protein, iron and vitamin B12, which are important for growing children and pregnant women. In poor communities, it can be difficult to get these nutrients from plants alone; as a result, a diet without meat could actually make some people weaker. For example, a child in a low-income family who eats a small amount of fish or chicken each

week receives nutrition that rice and vegetables may not provide, and this helps them to grow properly. Therefore, giving up meat completely could damage the health of many people instead of improving it.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that people should be free to follow their own culture and food choices. When people decide what to eat, they are making a personal decision, as adults should be free to decide what they eat and drink, and food is also a part of religion and tradition. For instance, sharing meat during Eid is an important tradition in Bangladesh, which brings together rich and poor families and strengthens community life. Although some people argue that red and processed meats can increase the risk of heart disease, this only shows that

people should eat less of them. Consequently, moderation is a much better answer than asking everyone to become vegetarian.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that it is wrong to say that the whole population should give up meat. Animal foods supply valuable nutrition, and individuals also have the right to choose meals that reflect their beliefs and traditions.

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85 · FOO-12

> *Many processed foods and ready-made meals contain preservatives and chemicals. What are the advantages to this? Do you think the*

> *advantages outweigh the disadvantages?*

Today, many processed foods and ready-made meals contain chemicals that help them last longer. Although these preservatives can reduce food waste and keep food safe, they often cause allergic reactions and encourage unhealthy diets. In my opinion, the disadvantages of this practice outweigh the advantages.

There is little doubt that preservatives offer considerable advantages to food producers and families. To begin with, preservatives allow food to be stored for weeks, which reduces food waste and makes it easier to keep food at home. This is because milk and meat that would normally spoil within days can stay edible much longer. For example, a family that buys canned fish and packaged milk once a month can cook

even when the market is closed. In addition, preservatives not only stop the growth of harmful bacteria but also allow food to travel long distances. As a result of this protection, safe food can reach remote villages where fresh produce is scarce, which prevents shortages. Overall, preservatives make the modern food supply cheaper, safer and more reliable for millions of families.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that preservatives also have some drawbacks. Firstly, some consumers experience allergic reactions when they eat foods containing certain chemical additives. Without clear labels, they cannot easily avoid these substances; as a result, they may suffer rashes or breathing problems. For instance, a child with asthma who drinks a soda containing certain preservatives may

have difficulty breathing, which frightens the family. Secondly, processed meals are a serious health risk, as they are often high in fat, sugar and salt, but low in vitamins, minerals and fibre. If families eat such meals every day, they may gain weight and, consequently, face obesity, high blood pressure, type 2 diabetes and heart disease. Although some additives are tested and permitted in small amounts, these health risks often matter more than convenience.

In conclusion, most packaged foods now contain chemicals that extend their shelf life. While they can cut waste and keep food safe, they often trigger allergies and encourage unhealthy diets. Therefore, I believe that the drawbacks outweigh the benefits.

> *Over the last few decades, the media has promoted the image of young thin women as being ideal. What problems has this caused? What solutions can you suggest to this issue?*

For several decades, the media has presented young, thin women as the ideal image of beauty. This can lead to low self-esteem and dangerous eating disorders, but honest advertising and better online protection can reduce these effects.

The most serious problem caused by this image is the damage to young people's self-esteem. Many of these images are digitally edited and do not reflect real people, so young people who constantly compare themselves with these images

feel that their bodies are not good enough. For example, a teenage girl who compares herself with an edited photograph of a model may believe that she is unattractive, and this can damage her confidence. Another problem is the harm to physical health. In serious cases, this can lead to eating disorders, such as starving oneself or extreme dieting, which are dangerous to both physical and mental health. Consequently, an image used to sell products can seriously damage young people's well-being.

The most effective solution is for governments to make advertising more honest. If advertisers are required to state when images have been digitally altered, young people can see that these bodies are not real. For instance, a teenage girl who sees a clear label on an edited photograph may compare herself

with it less often, which can protect her confidence. In addition, social media companies and schools could reduce the risk of eating disorders. Companies should remove harmful posts that promote extreme dieting, while schools can teach media literacy, helping students understand how advertising works and why online images are often unrealistic. Together, these measures would encourage healthier ideas about beauty.

In conclusion, the media's thin ideal damages both the confidence and the physical health of young people. Clear labels on edited pictures and better protection online would limit this harm.

87 · SPO-04

> *Ensuring that children have regular physical exercise should be the responsibility of parents and therefore schools should not waste valuable school time having sports lessons as part of the curriculum. To what extent do you agree?*

It is sometimes claimed that exercise is a matter for parents alone, so sports lessons are a waste of valuable school time. I completely disagree with this view because many parents cannot provide regular exercise and school sport also improves children's learning.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that many parents cannot provide regular exercise for their children. This is because many parents work long hours, cannot afford sports clubs or live in areas

without parks. For children from poor families or crowded city areas, school may be the only place where they can play sport safely; as a result, if schools remove sport from the curriculum, many children will hardly exercise at all. For example, a child in a crowded part of Dhaka may have no safe place to play after school, and this child's only exercise may come from a weekly PE lesson. Therefore, schools must share this responsibility with parents.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that sports lessons are not a waste of school time. When children move during the school day, their studies also benefit, as physical activity can actually improve academic performance, because it helps children concentrate and reduces stress. For instance, a student who plays cricket at

lunchtime often returns to class calmer and more focused, which helps them to understand difficult lessons. Although some people argue that parents should decide how children spend their free time, school programmes can reach every child, regardless of family background. Consequently, sports lessons deserve a regular place in the school curriculum.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that physical education is a valuable use of school time and not simply a duty for parents. Many families lack the time or money to organise exercise, and active pupils also perform better in the classroom.

88 · SPO-06

> *Some people think that companies should provide employees with exercise time during the day. What is your opinion about this?*

It is often argued that employers should give their staff time to exercise during the working day. I completely agree with this view because this policy protects workers' health and it also makes companies more productive.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that this policy protects workers' health. This is because many jobs now involve sitting at a desk all day, and long working hours also leave people feeling too tired or too busy to exercise. Physical activity helps people to maintain a healthy weight, strengthens the heart and lungs, and reduces the risk of

diabetes, high blood pressure and some cancers; as a result, employees stay healthier for longer. For example, an office worker who walks during a daily break may lose weight and lower their blood pressure, and this habit can protect their health. Therefore, a short exercise break is a sensible way to protect people who sit all day.

Another important reason for my agreement is that exercise time also makes companies more productive. When employees are healthy and relaxed, they concentrate better, make fewer mistakes and take fewer sick days, so the company loses less working time. For instance, a company that offers a thirty-minute walking break after lunch may find that staff feel more energetic in the afternoon, which improves the quality of their work. Although some

people argue that exercise breaks waste paid working time, employers can provide exercise facilities, flexible breaks or "walking meetings" at very little cost. Consequently, exercise time is an investment for employers and not simply a cost.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that businesses should allow employees to be physically active during their office hours. Regular movement keeps staff fit and well, and healthier workers also produce much better results for their employers.

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89 · SPO-07

> *With an increasing overweight population some people think universities should make sport a compulsory module on all degree*

> *courses. To what extent do you agree?*

Because more people are now overweight, it is sometimes claimed that universities should require every student to take a sports module. I completely disagree with this view because university students are adults who should make their own choices and compulsory sport adds extra pressure.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that university students are adults who should make their own choices. This is because adults should be free to decide what they eat and drink and how they spend their free time. People rarely enjoy activities that they are forced to do; as a result, students who are made to exercise may stop as soon as they graduate. For example, a science student who hates team games may attend a compulsory

football class only to get the credit, and this experience could make them dislike sport even more. Therefore, compulsion is unlikely to create the healthy habits that this policy aims to build.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that compulsory sport would add extra pressure. When students already have long hours of study, part-time jobs or family responsibilities, an additional module would leave them with less time to rest and prepare for exams. For instance, a student who works in a restaurant every evening to pay their fees may find it extremely difficult to attend weekly sports classes, which could lower their marks. Although some people argue that universities are another stage of life where young people often become less active, universities can certainly offer

cheap and attractive sports facilities to encourage students to stay active. Consequently, encouragement is a far better solution than an extra compulsory course.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that sport should not be a required part of every university degree. Young adults have the right to decide how they stay fit, and an additional course would also increase the stress they already face.

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90 · GOV-01

> *Should governments make decisions about people's lifestyle, or should people make their own decisions?*

Sample answer 1

While some people argue that governments should make decisions about how citizens live, others believe

that people should make these choices themselves. I completely support the latter view because adults know their own needs best.

On the one hand, people who support government control argue that laws can also protect people who do not make the unhealthy choice. Bans on smoking in restaurants, offices and public transport protect non-smokers from second-hand smoke. Unhealthy habits can also be reduced through taxes; as a result, fewer people suffer from serious illness. For example, a smoker who faces a higher price for cigarettes may decide to stop, and this protects both their own health and their family's. For this reason, many people believe that governments should control lifestyle choices.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that people should make their own decisions

because adults should be free to decide what they eat and drink, even if their choices are not healthy. When a rule is made for a whole country, it cannot suit everyone, because each person has different needs, cultures and religious beliefs. For instance, a government cannot decide how many hours a night worker should sleep or which sport a patient with back pain should play, which shows that one rule does not fit all. Although some people argue that taxes and bans reduce illness, such laws limit personal freedom in private matters. Consequently, lifestyle decisions should be left to individuals.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether governments or citizens should control lifestyle decisions. While some laws can reduce illness, I firmly believe that adults should

decide for themselves because they understand their own lives best.

Sample answer 2

While some people argue that governments should control how citizens live, others believe that these decisions belong to individuals. I completely support the latter view because adults have the right to run their own private lives.

On the one hand, people who support government action argue that laws can also protect people from harm. Seat-belt laws, speed limits, bans on smoking in public places and food safety rules have saved many lives. Dangerous behaviour can be controlled by clear rules; as a result, the whole of society becomes safer. For example, a driver who is fined for not wearing a seat belt may wear one every day, and this can save their life in

an accident. For this reason, many people believe that governments should make lifestyle decisions.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that individuals should decide because adults should have the right to make their own decisions about their private lives, as long as they do not harm others. If governments decide what people eat, wear or do in their free time, citizens may feel that their freedom is being taken away, and they may lose trust in their leaders. For instance, a person who is told what clothes to wear may start to resent the government, which can damage public trust. Although some people argue that laws save lives, these rules are about public safety, not private lifestyle choices. Consequently, private decisions should be left to people themselves.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether lifestyle decisions should be made by governments or by individuals. While road safety laws can save lives, I firmly believe that people should make these decisions because freedom is essential in private life.

Government & Public Spending

91 · GOV-02

> *A government has a responsibility to its citizens to ensure their safety. Therefore, some people think that the government should increase spending on defence but spend less on social benefits. To what extent do you agree?*

It is sometimes claimed that, because governments must keep citizens safe, they should spend more on the military and less on social benefits. I completely disagree with this view because social benefits also protect people and excessive military spending is often wasteful.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that social benefits also protect people. This is because the main argument for welfare is that it acts as a safety net, and people can lose their jobs, become seriously ill or suffer accidents through no fault of their own. Without support, they may fall into deep poverty, lose their homes or be unable to feed their children; as a result, many citizens would face daily danger. For example, a worker who loses their job can still feed their family while they retrain, and this support can prevent a temporary problem from becoming a disaster. Therefore, social benefits make citizens safer, just as an army does.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that excessive military spending is often wasteful. When governments buy more weapons than

they need, they lose money for public services, as modern weapons are extremely expensive, and money spent on them cannot be used for schools, hospitals or infrastructure. For instance, a country with no immediate threat may buy new fighter planes while village hospitals have no medicine, which does little to protect ordinary families. Although some people argue that a government's first responsibility is to protect its citizens, a larger army cannot protect them from hunger, illness or unemployment. Consequently, defence spending should be sufficient to protect the country and should not grow at the cost of welfare.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that governments should not cut welfare in order to pay for more armed forces. Financial support keeps vulnerable

people secure, and large weapons budgets also take money away from more useful public services.

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92 · GOV-03

> *Some people think that the government is responsible for the rise in obesity in children, while others think it is the fault of the parents. Discuss both sides and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that the government is to blame for rising obesity among children, others believe that parents are at fault. I completely support the latter view because parents decide what their children eat every day.

On the one hand, people who blame the government argue that it controls the environment in which children grow up.

In some cities, there are few safe parks or playgrounds, so parents prefer to keep their children indoors. Many children spend hours playing video games instead of playing outside, and they are surrounded by advertisements for snacks and soft drinks. For example, if junk food can be advertised freely during cartoons, children will keep asking for it, and this makes healthy eating harder for every family. For this reason, many people believe that the government is responsible for childhood obesity.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that parents are responsible because parents decide what their children eat at home. When children are young, they cannot make informed decisions, so they eat the food that adults provide. For instance, a child who is given fried snacks and soft drinks at home every day is likely to gain

weight, whatever the government does. Although some people argue that advertising and the lack of parks are to blame, parents can prepare home-cooked meals, limit screen time, encourage outdoor play and act as role models. Consequently, parents hold the real responsibility for their children's weight.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether governments or parents are to blame for rising obesity among children. While advertising and a lack of parks make healthy living harder, I firmly believe that parents are responsible because they control daily meals.

93 · GOV-05

> *The government should lower the budget for the arts in order to allocate more money to education. To what extent do you agree?*

It is sometimes claimed that the government should cut its arts budget and move this money to schools and universities. I completely disagree with this view because the arts budget is too small to help education and cutting it would harm culture and learning.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that the arts budget is too small to make a real difference to education. This is because arts funding is usually a very small part of public spending, while schools and universities need very large sums of money. Moving this money would not pay for many teachers or

buildings; as a result, education would gain little and the arts would lose almost everything. For example, the cost of running a national theatre for a year might repair only a few village schools, and this would do little for an entire school system. Therefore, governments should look for this money in other places, such as by reducing waste and corruption.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that cutting the arts budget would harm culture and learning. When public support disappears, culture suffers, because many valuable art forms, especially traditional ones such as folk music, crafts and classical dance, cannot survive on ticket sales alone. For instance, a folk dance group that earns little from tickets may close without public money, which would also end its

free performances for local schoolchildren. Although some people argue that education is the foundation of long-term development, creative skills are an important part of that education. Consequently, reducing arts funding would damage the very thing that it is supposed to improve.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that taking money from the arts is the wrong way to pay for education. The amount saved would be too small to help schools, and the loss would also damage national culture and children's development.

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94 · GOV-06

> *Some people think that only the government can make significant changes in society, while others think*

> *that individuals can have a lot of influence. What is your opinion?*

While some people argue that only governments can bring about real change in society, others believe that individuals can be very influential. I completely support the latter view because many important changes began with ordinary people.

On the one hand, people who support the role of government argue that some problems are too large for individuals to solve alone. Only governments can pass laws, collect taxes and build national systems such as hospitals, schools, roads and electricity networks. Large sums of public money are required for such projects; as a result, ordinary citizens cannot provide them. For example, no individual, however rich, could build a national railway alone, and this kind of

project can change the lives of millions. For this reason, many people believe that only governments can make significant changes.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that individuals have great influence because many important changes began with ordinary people. When citizens refuse to accept injustice, they can attract wide support, and public campaigns often begin with citizens and later become government policy. For instance, the Language Movement of 1952 in Bangladesh was started by students and ordinary citizens, which shows that people can change history. Although some people argue that only governments can pass laws, today, social media allows a single person to raise awareness of a problem and mobilise thousands of supporters. Consequently,

significant change does not depend on governments alone.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether major changes in society come from governments or from individuals. While governments have the power to pass laws, I firmly believe that individuals can be very influential because ordinary people started many important movements.

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95 · ART-01

> *Some people think that the government is wasting money on the arts and that this money could be better spent elsewhere. To what extent do you agree with this view?*

It is often argued that public money given to the arts is wasted and should be used for other purposes. I completely

disagree with this view because the arts protect a nation's culture and they also support the economy.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that the arts help to preserve a nation's culture and identity. This is because music, literature, theatre and traditional crafts record a country's history and values, and they connect each generation with the last. Public support matters most when foreign entertainment strongly influences young people; as a result, local traditions can survive alongside global culture. For example, a government grant can help a folk music group to perform in schools, and this allows children to learn about their own heritage. Therefore, money spent on the arts is an investment in national identity.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that the arts also support the economy. When a country has a lively cultural life, it earns money, because museums, galleries, festivals and theatres attract tourists, who spend money on hotels, restaurants and transport. For instance, a traditional music festival can attract visitors from many countries and support local businesses, which creates income for families in the area. Although some people argue that this money should go to hospitals and schools, the amount spent on the arts is very small compared with their budgets. Consequently, arts funding brings real returns and should not be considered a waste of public money.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that government spending on the arts is a

wise use of public funds. Cultural activities keep the country's heritage alive, and they also bring visitors and jobs to many communities.

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96 · ART-06

> *Most artists earn low salaries and should therefore receive funding from the government in order for them to continue with their work. To what extent do you agree?*

Because most artists have low incomes, it is often argued that the government should give them financial support so that they can continue their work. I completely agree with this view because artists protect the national culture and many art forms cannot survive without public money.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that artists protect the national culture. This is because the arts, including music, literature, painting, theatre, dance and film, help to preserve a nation's culture and identity. Art also tells each generation where it comes from; as a result, a country without active artists slowly loses part of its identity. For example, a small government grant can allow a village craftsperson to train young apprentices, so that a traditional skill such as nakshi kantha embroidery is passed on to the next generation. Therefore, artists whose work preserves traditional culture deserve public support.

Another important reason for my agreement is that many art forms cannot survive without public money. When artists depend only on sales, their work

is at risk, because many valuable art forms, especially traditional ones such as folk music, crafts and classical dance, cannot survive on ticket sales alone. For instance, a classical dancer who earns very little may leave the profession to find a better-paid job, which means that their skills are lost for ever. Although some people argue that artists should support themselves through the market, like any other business, the market rewards popularity and not cultural value. Consequently, government funding is necessary to keep these artists working.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that public money should be used to support artists who earn little. Their work keeps national traditions alive, and many creative fields would also disappear if they had to rely on commercial income.

97 · SPA-01

> *Some scientists think that there are intelligent life forms on other planets and that messages should be sent to contact them. Other scientists think it is a bad idea and would be dangerous. Discuss both views and give your own opinion.*

While some scientists argue that sending messages to other planets would be dangerous, others believe that we should try to contact intelligent life. I completely support the latter view because the possible benefits are far greater than the risk.

On the one hand, scientists who oppose this idea argue that trying to contact intelligent life on other planets could be dangerous if it attracted unfriendly attention. A more advanced civilisation

might see humans as a threat or want to use Earth's resources. Once a message is sent, it cannot be taken back; as a result, a single mistake could never be corrected. For example, a signal that reveals our location could never be recalled, and this could put the whole of humanity at risk. For this reason, many scientists believe that sending messages would be a serious mistake.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that we should try to make contact because this could be one of the greatest discoveries in history. When people learn that they are not alone in the universe, their understanding of life changes, and scientists may gain knowledge that could not be found on Earth. For instance, a reply from another planet could teach engineers about technology that we have never imagined, which could benefit

people everywhere. Although some people argue that a message could attract an enemy, space is so large that any message would take many years to arrive. Consequently, the chance of such a discovery is worth this small risk.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether messages should be sent to intelligent life on other planets. While such contact could involve some danger, I firmly believe that messages should be sent because the benefits for science could be enormous.

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98 · SPA-02

> *The government is spending a lot of money to discover life on other planets. Some people think that the government is wasting money and should spend more money*

> *addressing the problems of the public. To what extent do you agree?*

It is often argued that the large sums that governments spend on searching for life on other planets are wasted and should be used to solve people's problems. I completely agree with this view because basic human needs are more urgent and this research brings little benefit to ordinary citizens.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that basic human needs are far more urgent. This is because millions of people still live in extreme poverty, without enough food, clean water, healthcare or education. The cost of a single major space mission could build many hospitals or schools; as a result, each mission represents a lost chance to save lives on Earth. For example, a family without clean drinking water

gains nothing from a photograph of a distant planet, and the same money could give their whole village a safe well. Therefore, it seems wrong for governments to spend money exploring distant planets while their own citizens are suffering.

Another important reason for my agreement is that this search brings little benefit to ordinary citizens. When a government funds this work, space programmes mainly benefit wealthy countries and companies, and the results may not appear for many decades. For instance, even if a probe found tiny living organisms on a distant planet, this discovery would not feed a hungry child or create jobs for unemployed graduates. Although some people argue that space programmes have given us useful satellites, these already exist, and

searching for alien life adds little to them. Consequently, governments should move this money to health, education and poverty reduction.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that looking for life beyond Earth is a poor use of public money. Hunger and disease demand immediate action, and this kind of exploration also makes little difference to the daily lives of most citizens.

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99 · SPA-03

> *Some people think that space exploration is a waste of resources, while others think that it is essential for mankind to continue to explore*

> *the universe in which we live. Discuss both sides and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that space exploration is a waste of valuable resources, others believe that it is essential for humanity. I completely support the latter view because space research brings practical benefits to life on Earth.

On the one hand, people who oppose space exploration argue that it costs enormous sums of money, which could be used to solve urgent problems. Millions of people still live in extreme poverty, without enough food, clean water, healthcare or education. Huge budgets are spent on distant planets while these needs remain; as a result, governments seem to have the wrong priorities. For example, a farmer in a drought-hit region gains nothing directly

from new pictures of a distant planet, and this can make such spending seem unfair. For this reason, many people believe that space exploration is a waste of resources.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that space exploration is essential because it has brought many practical benefits to daily life. When storms and floods threaten people, satellites, which were developed through space programmes, now provide weather forecasts, and these forecasts give families time to act. For instance, weather satellites can warn coastal communities in Bangladesh about cyclones several days in advance, and these early warnings have helped to save many lives. Although some people argue that this money should help the poor, these satellites protect poor communities directly. Consequently,

funding space research is a wise investment for the future of humanity.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether space exploration wastes money or is necessary for humanity. While problems such as poverty are urgent, I firmly believe that this research is essential because its benefits already protect lives on Earth.

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100 · SOC-03

> *Most societies have homeless people. Some people think that the best way to help them is to give them money. To what extent do you agree?*

It is sometimes claimed that giving cash is the most effective way to help people who have no home. I completely disagree with this view because money does not solve the deeper causes of homelessness

and housing and training offer a more lasting solution.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that money does not solve the real reasons why people become homeless. This is because cash alone does not solve the deeper causes of homelessness, such as unemployment, mental illness, addiction or family breakdown. These problems need professional help and time; as a result, a person can receive money for many years and still sleep on the street. For example, someone with an addiction might spend the money in a way that makes the problem worse, and this could push them further away from a normal life. Therefore, cash may relieve a problem for a day without removing its cause.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that housing and

training offer a more lasting solution. When people have a safe place to live, they can begin to rebuild their lives, and governments can offer job training, help with finding work and basic healthcare. For instance, a homeless person who learns to repair mobile phones in a shelter may find steady work, which allows them to pay rent and live independently. Although some people argue that cash respects their freedom to decide what they need, freedom means little to someone with no home or job. Consequently, the best approach is to give people a hand up, not just a handout.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that handing out money is not the best way to support homeless people. Cash cannot deal with the problems behind their

situation, and shelter and job skills also give them a real chance of independence.

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101 · SOC-04

> *More developing countries are given aid from international organisations to help them with their development plans. Some people argue that financial aid is important, but others suggest that practical aid and advice are more important. Discuss both views and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that money is the most useful form of international aid, others believe that practical help and advice are more important. I completely support the latter view because skills last much longer than money.

On the one hand, people who support financial aid argue that money is needed

for large projects and emergencies. Money allows countries to fund large projects quickly and respond flexibly to their own priorities. Hospitals and bridges cannot be built without funding; as a result, poor countries often depend on outside help. For example, a country that receives money after a cyclone can quickly rebuild bridges and hospitals, and this helps thousands of families to return to normal life. For this reason, many people believe that financial aid is the most important form of support.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that practical aid is more important because it builds skills that remain in the country long after the aid ends. When local people are trained as doctors, teachers and engineers, they can solve problems themselves, and their countries become less dependent. For instance, foreign

experts who train local engineers to maintain a water system leave behind skills that last for years, even after those experts go home. Although some people argue that large projects need money first, money may be stolen by officials or spent on projects that benefit powerful people rather than the poor. Consequently, it is better to teach a person to fish than to give them a fish.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether financial help or practical advice is more useful to developing countries. While money is valuable in emergencies, I firmly believe that practical aid is more important because it builds long-term self-reliance.

102 · SPO-05

> *Many countries want to host international sports events, while other countries think that hosting sports events has more problems than benefits. Discuss both views and give your opinion.*

While some countries are keen to host international sports events, others believe that these events bring more problems than benefits. I completely support the latter view because the costs of hosting them are usually enormous.

On the one hand, people who support hosting argue that it puts the host country in the international spotlight, improving its image and attracting tourists and foreign investors. During the event, visitors spend money on hotels, restaurants, transport and

souvenirs, which supports local businesses and creates temporary jobs. New roads and metro lines are also built for these events; as a result, residents can benefit for many years. For example, a city that builds a new metro line for a tournament can still use it long after the event, and this improves daily travel for residents. For this reason, many countries want to host such events.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that hosting creates more problems because the costs of hosting major events are often enormous. When a government builds new stadiums and security systems, less money remains for schools, hospitals or housing, and several host cities have been left with large debts. For instance, a poor country may spend heavily on a stadium that is rarely used after the event, which wastes money that

could have built many local schools. Although some people argue that tourists and new roads bring long-term benefits, these gains rarely cover the total cost. Consequently, international sports events are a poor use of public money.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether hosting international sports events brings more benefits or more problems. While these events can improve a country's image, I firmly believe that the problems are greater because they cost huge amounts of public money.

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103 · TRA-08

> *Poor infrastructure hinders under-developed countries from progressing and modernising. Some*

> *people think that this should be the first problem tackled by foreign aid. To what extent do you agree with this opinion?*

It is often argued that weak infrastructure holds back poor countries, so foreign aid should deal with this problem first. I completely agree with this view because good infrastructure allows the economy to grow and it also gives people access to essential services.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that good infrastructure allows the economy to grow. This is because poor infrastructure makes it difficult for farmers to sell their crops, for businesses to grow and for children to reach school. Better roads, ports and electricity also attract foreign companies; as a result, new jobs and skills come into the country. For example, a foreign clothing

company may open a large factory near a new port, and this can bring hundreds of jobs and useful skills to the local area. Therefore, good infrastructure lays the foundations for long-term development.

Another important reason for my agreement is that infrastructure gives people access to essential services. When a village has roads and power, daily life changes, because a new bridge or road can connect isolated villages to markets and hospitals, transforming people's lives. For instance, a new road can allow a sick villager to reach a hospital in one hour instead of a whole day, which can save their life. Although some people argue that aid can be extremely valuable in emergencies, emergency help solves a problem for a short time and does not build a country's future. Consequently, foreign donors should make

infrastructure their first goal in under-developed countries.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that foreign aid should focus first on building better infrastructure. Transport and power networks create economic growth, and they also connect remote communities with the schools and hospitals they need.

Work & Employment

104 · WRK-01

> *Some employers want to be able to contact their staff at all times, even on holidays. Does this development have more advantages than disadvantages?*

Some employers now expect to reach their staff at any time, even when employees are on holiday. Although this constant contact can help companies solve urgent problems and serve clients abroad, it often causes stress and lowers productivity. In my view, this development brings more drawbacks than benefits.

There is little doubt that constant contact with staff offers considerable

advantages to employers. To begin with, the most significant benefit is that managers can solve urgent problems quickly, without waiting for the next working day. This is because with smartphones and email, employees can be contacted at any time, including evenings, weekends and holidays. For example, if a factory machine breaks down at night, an engineer who answers the phone can prevent a long and costly delay. In addition, constant contact not only speeds up decisions but also helps companies that serve clients in other time zones. As a result of having someone always available, these firms can respond to customers overseas immediately, which protects important business relationships. Overall, reaching staff at any time can save companies money and keep customers satisfied.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that constant contact also has some drawbacks. Firstly, many employees experience serious stress when they are never allowed to switch off from work. Without real rest, they cannot recover; as a result, they may suffer poor sleep, high blood pressure and back pain. For instance, a manager who answers office calls until midnight may sleep badly and wake up with a headache, which makes the next working day much harder. Secondly, falling productivity can be a serious obstacle, as tired people make more mistakes and lose creativity. If staff feel exhausted all year, they may do poorer work and, consequently, the company may lose the profits it wanted to protect. Although some urgent calls are necessary, these health and productivity problems often harm workers and companies alike.

In conclusion, expecting employees to answer messages at all hours is becoming common. While it can help firms handle emergencies and serve foreign clients, it frequently exhausts workers and reduces the quality of their work. Overall, I believe this is a negative development.

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105 · WRK-02

> *More and more people are moving away from an agricultural background to relocate to cities in order to look for work. What will be the consequences of this? What solutions can you offer?*

A growing number of people are leaving farming behind and moving to cities to find work. This can lead to overcrowded cities and ageing villages, but affordable

urban housing and rural development can reduce these effects.

The most serious consequence of this trend is that cities become overcrowded. As more people arrive, housing becomes expensive, slums grow, and traffic and pollution increase. For example, a young farmer who moves to Dhaka to work in a garment factory may have to share a crowded room without clean water, and this can harm their health. Another important consequence is that rural areas lose their workers. Villages may lose their young and energetic workers, leaving older people behind, so fewer people are left to work on the farms. Consequently, this movement places pressure on cities and may reduce food production in the countryside.

The most effective solution is for governments to prepare cities for these

new workers. When they build affordable housing and improve public transport, migrants can live in decent conditions and travel to work more easily. For instance, a garment worker who can rent a cheap, clean flat near a bus route no longer needs to live in a slum, which protects their health. In addition, governments could invest in rural areas. Rural development, such as better roads, schools and small industries, can reduce pressure to move to cities, because young people can find good jobs near their homes. Together, these measures would protect cities and keep villages productive.

In conclusion, moving from farms to cities leaves urban areas crowded and the countryside short of workers. Decent city housing and investment in villages

would limit these effects and help both areas.

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106 · WRK-03

> *Completing university education is thought by some to be the best way to get a good job. On the other hand, other people think that getting experience and developing soft skills is more important. Discuss both sides and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that a university degree is the best route to a good job, others believe that experience and soft skills are more important. I completely support the latter view because employers want people who can do the work.

On the one hand, people who value university education argue that many

professions, such as medicine, engineering, law and teaching, require formal qualifications. A degree shows employers that a candidate has knowledge in a particular field. Graduates are often offered a wider range of jobs; as a result, they tend to earn higher salaries. For example, a graduate in engineering may be offered several well-paid posts that are closed to other applicants, and this can lead to a respected career. For this reason, many people believe that a degree is the best way to get a good job.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that experience and soft skills matter more because employers often complain that graduates have theoretical knowledge but lack practical experience and soft skills. When the number of graduates has grown faster than the number of

suitable jobs, a degree alone does not make a candidate stand out, and practical skills decide who is chosen. For instance, a student who has worked in a shop has learned to deal with customers, handle responsibility and work under pressure, which may impress employers more than good marks. Although some people argue that a degree opens many doors, it cannot guarantee a job. Consequently, experience and soft skills are the stronger route to employment.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether a degree or practical experience leads to a better job. While university qualifications are required in some professions, I firmly believe that experience and soft skills are more important because employers value capable workers.

107 · WRK-04

> *First impressions are important. Some people think that doing well in interviews is the key to securing a good job. To what extent do you agree?*

It is sometimes claimed that performing well at an interview is the key to getting a good job, because first impressions count. I completely disagree with this view because skills and experience matter more and employers now use other methods to judge candidates.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that skills and experience matter more than a good interview. This is because employers look for candidates who combine knowledge with experience, and these qualities are built over many years. Some highly capable

people are nervous in interviews and perform poorly, while others are skilled at presenting themselves but less effective in the actual job; as a result, a short conversation can easily give the wrong picture. For example, a quiet engineer with ten years of experience may solve real problems much better than a confident graduate who speaks well, and this ability is what the company really needs. Therefore, real ability is the true key to a good job.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that employers now use other methods to judge candidates. When a company hires new staff, it often looks beyond the interview, and many companies now use additional methods, such as practical tests, group tasks and trial periods, to assess candidates more fairly. For instance, a software company

may give applicants a coding test, because a confident conversation cannot show whether someone can actually write good programs. Although some people argue that first impressions matter, a good first impression will not keep someone in a job if they cannot do the work. Consequently, the interview is only one small step in the process of securing a good position.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that success in an interview is not the key to finding a good job. Practical ability and work experience carry more weight, and modern employers also test candidates in several other ways.

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108 · WRK-05

> *Finding job satisfaction is considered to be a luxury in many developing*

> *countries. Why do you think that is? Do you think job satisfaction is important?*

In many developing countries, job satisfaction is seen as a luxury that few workers can afford. This is mainly because families need a steady income and good jobs are scarce, and I firmly believe that it still matters.

One of the main reasons for this is that workers must put their family's income first. In developing countries, where there is often little social security, a well-paid job may be the only protection against illness, unemployment or old age. For example, for a young person who must support parents and younger siblings, choosing a low-paid job simply because it is interesting may not be a realistic option. Another important reason is that there are far more job

seekers than good jobs. When hundreds of graduates apply for one position, people accept any work they can find; as a result, few can choose a job they enjoy. Consequently, job satisfaction is sometimes described as a luxury in poorer countries.

As for whether job satisfaction is important, I firmly believe that it is because people spend a large part of their lives at work. If they find their work boring, meaningless or stressful, they may feel unhappy every day, regardless of how much they earn. For instance, a bank clerk who hates his job may come home exhausted and irritable every evening, which can harm both his health and his family life. Although some people argue that money matters more in poorer countries, workers who enjoy their jobs are usually more motivated,

more creative and more loyal. Therefore, job satisfaction is important even where incomes are low.

In conclusion, many people in developing nations cannot put enjoyment first because they must support their families and jobs are limited. I firmly believe that job satisfaction still matters because it protects workers' health and happiness.

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109 · WRK-06

> *Many people find it hard to balance their work with other parts of their lives. What are the reasons for this? How can this problem be overcome?*

Nowadays, many people struggle to find time for family, health and leisure alongside their jobs. This is mainly because of long working hours and

constant online contact, but flexible jobs and clear limits on work messages can tackle this problem.

One of the main causes of this problem is the long working hours of many modern jobs. In competitive economies, many employees work long hours because they fear losing their jobs or want to gain promotion. For example, a bank employee who hopes for promotion may stay at the office until late every evening, and this leaves little time for their children. Another important cause is technology, which allows employers to contact their staff at any time by phone and email. When workers receive messages late at night or on holiday, they cannot fully relax, and their stress increases. Consequently, work now fills much of the time once kept for other parts of life.

The most effective solution is for employers to offer flexible working hours. When staff can choose their hours or work from home on some days, they still have time for their families. For instance, a bank employee who starts work early and leaves at four o'clock can collect their children from school, which strengthens family life. In addition, managers and individuals could set clear limits on work messages. Managers should not contact employees after office hours except in genuine emergencies, and individuals can switch off work notifications in the evening. Together, these measures would give people the time and energy to enjoy their lives outside work.

In conclusion, many people find this balance difficult because jobs take up long hours and follow them home

through technology. Flexible schedules and firm limits on after-work messages would help them to rest.

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110 · WRK-07

> *More companies should employ older people. What are the advantages and disadvantages for a company of doing this?*

It has been suggested that more companies should hire older people. Although older staff may cost more and need extra training in new technology, they also bring valuable experience and great loyalty to a business.

There is little doubt that employing older workers offers considerable advantages to companies. To begin with, the most significant benefit is that older employees usually have years of

experience and knowledge that cannot be learned quickly from books. This is because they have dealt with many different situations, so they can make sound decisions under pressure. For example, an experienced bank manager who has handled many difficult clients can calm an angry customer quickly, and this protects the bank's reputation. In addition, older workers not only stay longer in one job but also act as mentors, passing on their knowledge to younger colleagues. As a result of this loyalty, firms spend less on recruiting new staff, which reduces their costs. Overall, teams that mix young and older workers often combine new ideas with practical wisdom.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that hiring older people also has some drawbacks. Firstly, many companies face

higher wage costs, as older workers may expect higher salaries because of their experience. Some may also have health problems that lead to more sick days; as a result, the company pays extra for replacement staff. For instance, a small shop whose senior manager is often ill may have to pay a temporary worker as well, which reduces its profits. Secondly, new software can be a serious obstacle, as some older workers may find it harder to learn new technology. If they cannot use modern systems confidently, they may work more slowly and, consequently, need costly training. Overall, these financial and technical issues can make older staff a costly choice for some businesses.

In conclusion, hiring workers in their fifties and sixties is a growing trend. While they may demand higher pay and

struggle with new technology, they offer companies deep experience, loyalty and guidance for younger staff.

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111 · WRK-08

> *Doctors, nurses and teachers make a great contribution to society and should be paid more than entertainment and sports celebrities. Do you agree or disagree?*

It is often argued that doctors, nurses and teachers make a greater contribution to society, so they should earn more than film and sports stars. I completely agree with this view because their work is essential to society and low pay causes serious shortages.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that the work of doctors, nurses and teachers is essential to society. This

is because doctors and nurses save lives every day, while teachers prepare the next generation of workers and citizens. Without good teachers, there would be no future doctors, engineers or scientists; as a result, the whole of society depends on their work. For example, a village teacher who prepares a poor child for medical college may give the country a future doctor, and this shows how much every community depends on such work. Therefore, essential workers deserve better pay and recognition.

Another important reason for my agreement is that low pay causes serious shortages. When salaries remain low, talented young people avoid these careers, and when highly educated professionals move abroad permanently, their home countries suffer from brain

drain. For instance, many Bangladeshi doctors and nurses move to the UK or the Middle East for better pay and training, which leaves local hospitals with too few staff. Although some people argue that celebrity incomes are set by the market, governments can still raise the salaries of the professionals they employ. Consequently, paying these workers more would benefit every citizen who needs a hospital or a school.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that medical staff and teachers should receive higher salaries than entertainers and athletes. Their daily work keeps society healthy and educated, and better pay would also persuade more talented people to stay in these professions.

> *Many children are encouraged by their parents to get a part-time job in their free time. What are the advantages and disadvantages to children of doing so?*

These days, many parents urge their children to find part-time work outside school hours. Although such work can harm their studies and expose them to unfair treatment, it also teaches responsibility and the value of money.

There is little doubt that part-time work offers considerable advantages to young people. To begin with, the most significant benefit is that work teaches responsibility and discipline. This is because young workers must arrive on time, follow instructions, serve customers politely and complete tasks

properly. For example, a teenager who works in a café at weekends soon learns to be punctual and polite, and this helps him later at work. In addition, a part-time job not only gives young people their own income but also helps them understand the value of money. As a result of working hard for their wages, teenagers are more likely to spend carefully and save, which prepares them for adult life. Overall, part-time work helps children develop the habits and financial skills they will need in the future.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that part-time jobs also have some drawbacks. Firstly, many students experience falling grades when work takes time and energy away from studying. Without enough rest after a long shift, they often feel exhausted; as a

result, they cannot concentrate in class or complete their homework. For instance, a student who delivers food until midnight before an exam may perform poorly, which can affect his chances of entering university. Secondly, unfair treatment is a serious risk, as some employers pay very low wages, ask young people to work long or late hours. If young workers do not understand their rights, they may accept these conditions and, consequently, risk their health and safety. Overall, these academic and safety risks can make part-time work harmful for some children.

In conclusion, many teenagers now combine school with paid work. While a job may lower their grades and leave them open to exploitation, it builds discipline and teaches them to manage money wisely.

113 · WRK-10

> *In many developing countries, there is an increasing movement of workers from rural areas into the cities. Why do you think this happens? What problems can this cause?*

A growing number of workers in developing nations are leaving villages for urban areas. This is mainly because farming pays poorly and cities offer more jobs, and this movement can lead to overcrowded cities and ageing villages.

One of the main reasons for this movement is that farming provides low and uncertain incomes. Rural areas offer few other jobs, so a poor harvest can leave a whole family without enough money. For example, a young farmer who earns very little may move to Dhaka

to work in a garment factory, and a regular wage can help the family escape poverty. Another important reason is that cities offer far more jobs in offices, shops and services. They also have better schools and hospitals; as a result, parents may believe that their children will have a brighter future there. Consequently, many rural families see the city as the best way to improve their lives.

The most serious problem caused by this trend is that cities become overcrowded. Housing becomes expensive as more people arrive, so many newcomers have no choice but to live in slums. For instance, a garment worker who cannot afford a flat may share one small room in a slum, which often lacks clean water and proper sanitation. Another problem is that villages lose their young and

energetic workers, which leaves older people behind. Farms may then have too few workers, and elderly parents may have nobody nearby to care for them. As a result, this movement puts pressure on both cities and villages.

In conclusion, rural workers move because agriculture pays little and urban areas provide more opportunities. However, this movement puts heavy pressure on city housing and deprives villages of their younger workers.

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114 · WRK-11

> *In some developing countries, it is difficult to get good teachers to work in rural areas, which can have a negative impact on the education of children in those rural communities. Why do you think good teachers do*

> *not want to work in rural areas in developing countries? What could be done to solve this problem?*

In some developing countries, rural schools struggle to attract good teachers, and this harms children's education. This is mainly because of better conditions in cities and isolation in villages, but financial incentives and local training can tackle this problem.

One of the main causes of this problem is that cities offer teachers a much better life. Good teachers often prefer to work in cities, where salaries are higher, living conditions are better and their own children can attend good schools. For example, a young teacher from Dhaka who is offered a low salary on a remote river island may choose a city school, and this leaves the village without a qualified teacher. Another important

cause is that teachers in remote areas often feel isolated. They are far from their families and have fewer chances for training and promotion. Consequently, village schools are left with too few teachers, or with teachers who have little training.

The most effective solution is for governments to make rural posts more attractive. Governments can offer incentives to teachers who work in remote areas, such as higher salaries, free housing and faster promotion. For instance, a young teacher who receives free housing and a higher salary on a river island may accept the post, which gives village children a qualified teacher. In addition, governments could train young people from rural areas as teachers. Since these teachers already have family and friends in the village,

they are less likely to feel isolated and more likely to stay in their home communities. Together, these measures would narrow the gap between city and village schools.

In conclusion, good teachers avoid the countryside because urban jobs offer better conditions and village life can feel lonely. Better rewards and training local people would give rural children the education they deserve.

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115 · WRK-12

> *Having a good university degree guarantees people a good job. To what extent do you agree?*

It is sometimes claimed that a good university qualification guarantees a well-paid and satisfying career. I completely disagree with this view

because the job market is crowded with graduates and employers also look for practical experience and soft skills.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that a degree is not enough in a crowded job market. This is because, in many countries, the number of graduates has grown faster than the number of graduate jobs. Many young people with degrees are unemployed or work in jobs that do not match their qualifications; as a result, they may feel that their long years of study have been wasted. For example, some business graduates in Bangladesh spend years applying for jobs or work as delivery riders while they wait for a suitable position, and this shows that a certificate alone is not enough. Therefore, a degree is no longer a guarantee of employment.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that employers also look for practical experience and soft skills. When companies compare candidates, they look beyond academic results, because employers frequently complain that graduates have theoretical knowledge but lack practical experience and soft skills, such as communication, teamwork, problem-solving and time management. For instance, a graduate with excellent marks who cannot work in a team may lose a job to a candidate with useful internship experience, which shows what employers really value. Although some people argue that many professions require a degree, having the qualification only allows a person to apply for such jobs. Consequently, a degree opens a door, and graduates must bring other abilities to walk through it.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that an excellent degree does not promise a good career. Too many qualified people are competing for too few positions, and recruiters also expect real work experience and strong personal skills.

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116 · WRK-13

> *The number of people working online from home has grown in some countries. What advantages and disadvantages can come of this trend?*

Working online from home has become increasingly common in many countries. Although this trend can cause loneliness and blur the line between work and home, it also saves commuting time and gives workers more flexibility.

There is little doubt that working from home offers considerable advantages to employees and employers. To begin with, the most significant benefit is that working from home saves commuting time and money. This is because in large cities with heavy traffic, workers may save several hours a day, which they can spend resting. For example, a Dhaka office worker who once spent three hours a day in traffic can now rest instead, and she feels far less tired. In addition, remote work not only offers staff flexibility but also helps companies reduce office costs. As a result of this flexibility, parents can take their children to school and still finish their work, which reduces stress at home. Overall, home working gives people more control over their time and saves money for workers and businesses.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that working from home also has some drawbacks. Firstly, many people feel lonely and isolated because they miss daily contact with colleagues. Without face-to-face conversations, teamwork becomes slower; as a result, young employees have fewer chances to learn from experienced colleagues. For instance, a new graduate working alone at home may not get quick advice from senior colleagues, which slows his progress. Secondly, the loss of a clear working day can be a serious obstacle, as the boundary between work and home life can disappear. If a parent with young children works in a noisy home without a quiet room, they may keep working late and, consequently, feel exhausted. Overall, these social and practical problems can make remote work

stressful and less productive for some employees.

In conclusion, remote work is now a normal part of working life. While home workers may feel cut off and find it hard to switch off, they avoid long journeys and enjoy more freedom.

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117 · WRK-14

> *Some people with a good education and experience in their field decide to move abroad to work. Why do you think that is? What problems does this cause?*

Many well-educated and experienced professionals choose to leave their country to work abroad. This is mainly because foreign jobs pay more and offer better conditions, and this can lead to brain drain and separated families.

One of the main reasons for this is that skilled workers can earn far higher salaries abroad. Workers can earn much higher wages abroad and send money home to their families. For example, a Bangladeshi doctor who moves to the UK may earn several times more than at home, and this money can give the whole family a more comfortable life. Another important reason is the better working conditions in richer countries. Professionals at home often face heavy workloads, slow promotion and limited research funding; as a result, modern hospitals and laboratories abroad seem far more attractive. Consequently, many talented people see a career overseas as the best way to progress.

The most serious problem caused by this trend is brain drain. Doctors, nurses, engineers and scientists are often trained

at great public expense, and when they leave, their skills are lost to their own country. For instance, when many doctors leave, rural hospitals face a shortage of staff, and patients must wait much longer for treatment. Another problem is that families are separated for many years. Living far from their families for many years can cause loneliness and family problems, and children may grow up seeing a parent only once a year. Consequently, both the home country and the migrants' families pay a heavy price.

In conclusion, skilled professionals move overseas mainly for higher pay and better working conditions. However, this weakens public services at home, such as hospitals, and keeps many families apart for years.

> *Paying all workers the same salary in a company promotes harmony and respect amongst colleagues. To what extent do you agree or disagree?*

It is sometimes claimed that giving every employee in a company the same salary creates harmony and respect at work. I completely disagree with this view because equal pay reduces motivation and it is also unfair to skilled and experienced staff.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that equal pay reduces motivation. This is because hard-working and highly skilled employees would receive no extra reward for their effort. People usually work harder when they can see a clear reward; as a result, a

company without one may see its performance fall. For example, if a senior engineer earned the same as a new trainee, the engineer might stop working hard, and this attitude could soon spread to other members of the team. Therefore, the same salary for everyone would damage the company's performance and the attitude of its staff.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that equal pay is unfair to skilled and experienced staff. When a manager who carries heavy responsibilities earns the same as a junior assistant, that manager may feel angry and undervalued, which creates resentment rather than harmony. For instance, an experienced accountant who sees a beginner receive the same salary may move to a competitor, which means that the company loses its best worker.

Although some people argue that paying all workers the same salary would promote harmony among colleagues, true respect comes from fair treatment and not from identical pay. Consequently, pay should reflect skills, responsibility and performance, as long as the system is transparent and fair.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that paying identical wages to all staff will not create a respectful workplace. It removes the reason to work hard, and it also ignores the differences in people's abilities and responsibilities.

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119 · WRK-16

> *Getting promotion is one of the biggest drives for people to apply themselves and work hard in the modern workplace. Why do you*

> *think people are so driven to get promotion? What other factors influence people to work hard?*

Many employees work hard mainly because they hope to be promoted. This is mainly because promotion brings a higher salary and social status, and interesting work and job security also motivate people.

One of the main reasons for this is money. A promotion usually brings a higher salary, which allows people to support their families and improve their standard of living. For example, a junior officer who becomes a manager may finally afford a bigger flat and a better school for his children, and this makes the extra effort worthwhile. Another important reason is the status that a higher position brings. In many societies, a person's job title strongly

affects how they are seen by family, friends and the community; as a result, a new title makes employees feel proud and respected. Consequently, the desire to be promoted encourages many employees to work hard and develop their skills.

One important factor besides promotion is interesting work. When people enjoy what they do and feel that it helps others, they are willing to work long hours without any extra reward. For instance, a nurse who cares deeply about her patients may stay late to comfort a frightened child, even though she has no hope of promotion. Another important factor is job security. When unemployment is high, people fear losing their jobs; as a result, they work harder to show that they are valuable to their employer. Consequently,

promotion is only one of several forces that make people work hard.

In conclusion, people chase promotion because it raises their income and their standing in society. However, enjoyable work and the fear of losing a job also push many employees to make a great effort.

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120 · WRK-17

> *Bringing in foreign workers to fill positions that domestic workers are unwilling to do can cause problems in the local community and should therefore be stopped. To what extent do you agree with this?*

It is sometimes claimed that hiring foreign workers for jobs that local people refuse to do creates problems and should be stopped. I completely disagree with

this view because these workers fill important gaps in the labour market and migration also benefits their home countries.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that foreign workers fill important gaps in the labour market. This is because many local people do not want physically demanding jobs, such as construction, cleaning and caring for elderly people. Migrant workers fill important gaps in the labour market, support the economy and often do essential but difficult work; as a result, hospitals, building sites and many other services can continue to operate. For example, many Bangladeshi workers in the Middle East work in construction, a job that few local people want to do, and this work helps to build roads and homes for the local community. Therefore,

stopping this practice would leave many necessary jobs unfilled.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that migration also benefits the workers' home countries. When people work overseas, their families benefit directly, because workers can earn much higher wages abroad and send money home to their families. For instance, a construction worker in Dubai who sends money to their village in Bangladesh can pay for their children's education, which gives the next generation a better future. Although some people argue that foreign workers put pressure on housing and local services, good planning, fair wages and language classes can reduce these problems. Consequently, governments should manage this system carefully instead of bringing it to an end.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that countries should continue to recruit overseas workers for jobs that local people do not want. These employees keep important services running, and their earnings also improve life for families back home.

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121 · WRK-18

> *Some people think that employers should ensure a supportive and pleasant work environment where each employee is respected and valued equally, while others think employers should focus instead on providing better facilities and equipment. What is your opinion?*

While some people argue that employers should concentrate on better facilities and equipment, others believe that a

supportive workplace where everyone is respected matters more. I completely support the latter view because respected employees are more motivated.

On the one hand, people who support investment in equipment argue that modern tools help employees to work faster and more safely. AI tools can save workers time on routine paperwork, allowing them to focus on more creative and meaningful tasks. Many hours are wasted when machines are slow or unreliable; as a result, productivity falls. For example, a designer with a slow computer may lose hours every week waiting for files to open, and this delays the whole team. For this reason, many people believe that employers should focus on facilities and equipment.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that a supportive environment matters more

because employees who feel respected, listened to and valued are more likely to give their best effort. When managers treat staff fairly and value their work, people enjoy coming to the office, and they are less likely to leave. For instance, a supportive manager who praises good work and helps staff to improve can motivate people more than a small pay rise. Although some people argue that modern equipment saves time, a workplace with constant criticism, unfair treatment or bullying can destroy motivation, however good the tools may be. Consequently, respect is the most valuable thing that an employer can provide.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether employers should focus on respect at work or on better equipment. While modern facilities help

people to work efficiently, I firmly believe that a respectful workplace is more important because it increases motivation.

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122 · WRK-19

> *Some people think that people should choose their job based on income in order to provide security for their family. Do you think money is an important factor when choosing a job? What other factors should be considered?*

Some people believe that a job should be chosen mainly for its salary, because a good income protects the family. I firmly believe that money is an important factor, and job satisfaction and career growth should also be considered.

I firmly believe that money is an important factor when choosing a job because it gives a family security. A good salary allows people to provide for their families, pay for their children's education, buy or rent a decent home and save for the future. For example, for a young person who must support parents and younger siblings, choosing a low-paid job simply because it is interesting may not be a realistic option. Although some people argue that money cannot buy happiness, a lack of money brings constant worry about rent, bills and school fees. Therefore, income deserves serious attention in any career decision.

One important factor that should also be considered is job satisfaction. If people find their work boring, meaningless or stressful, they may feel unhappy every

day, regardless of how much they earn. For instance, a well-paid accountant who hates his work may dread every Monday morning, which can slowly damage his health and his family life. Another important factor is career growth. A job with good training and chances of promotion can lead to a much higher salary later; as a result, a low starting wage is not always a bad choice. Consequently, a wise job seeker looks beyond the first salary.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that pay matters when people choose a career because it protects their families. Enjoyment of the work and future career prospects should also guide this important decision.

123 · BUS-01

> *In some countries, a few people earn extremely high salaries. Some people think that this is good for a country, while others believe that the government should control salaries and limit the amount people can earn. Discuss both views and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that governments should limit the very high salaries that a few people earn, others believe that these incomes benefit the country. I completely support the latter view because high rewards encourage hard work and new businesses.

On the one hand, people who support salary limits argue that very high incomes are unfair. A few people earn millions while ordinary workers struggle

to make ends meet. Such differences are seen as unjust by many citizens; as a result, this could widen the gap between rich and poor and create social tension. For example, the director of a large company may earn hundreds of times more than a factory worker in the same company, and this can cause anger among the staff. For this reason, many people believe that governments should control salaries.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that high salaries are good for a country because they reward talent and encourage risk. When people can earn large rewards, they are willing to study hard and start businesses, and new businesses create jobs for other people. For instance, many of today's large companies started as small businesses run by one or two people with an idea,

which shows how the hope of high rewards can benefit thousands of workers. Although some people argue that such incomes are unfair, a legal limit could simply persuade talented professionals to move abroad. Consequently, countries gain more by allowing these high salaries.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether very high salaries benefit a country or should be limited by law. While such incomes can increase inequality, I firmly believe that they are good for a country because they reward talent and create jobs.

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124 · BUS-13

> *Some people think that, when recruiting, companies should aim to take on people who are innovative*

> *and able to work independently, while others consider that they should recruit people who are able to work in a team and follow instructions. Discuss both views and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that companies should recruit team players who follow instructions, others believe that innovative and independent people are more valuable. I completely support the latter view because new ideas drive business success.

On the one hand, people who prefer team players argue that most work today is done in groups rather than by individuals. Employees must communicate well, share information and respect decisions so that projects run smoothly. Serious mistakes can be avoided when instructions are followed

carefully; as a result, the whole team works more safely. For example, factory workers who follow safety instructions exactly are less likely to cause an accident, and this protects everyone on the production line. For this reason, many people believe that companies should recruit people who work well in a team.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that innovative employees are more valuable because companies must constantly develop new products. When machines can work continuously and perform repetitive tasks accurately, businesses need people who can think creatively, and these workers also need less supervision. For instance, a software company may depend on one creative developer to design an app that attracts millions of users, which could change the

future of the business. Although some people argue that following instructions prevents mistakes, machines can now do much of this routine work. Consequently, companies should aim to recruit innovative and independent people.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether companies should choose independent thinkers or obedient team members. While teamwork keeps daily work safe and smooth, I firmly believe that innovative people are more valuable because their ideas help companies to grow.

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125 · BUS-15

> *Small businesses should avoid recruiting young women who do not have their own family in order to*

> *avoid paying maternity leave later on. To what extent do you agree or disagree?*

It is sometimes claimed that small companies should not employ young women without children, in order to avoid paying for maternity leave later. I completely disagree with this view because this practice is unfair to women and it also harms small businesses.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that this practice is unfair to women. This is because people should be judged on their ability, not their gender, and not every young woman will have children or take long leave. Such discrimination is not only unfair but also illegal in many countries; as a result, employers who follow this policy could also face legal problems. For example, a talented young accountant who is

rejected only because she might have a baby one day could take the company to court, and this case could damage its name and its finances. Therefore, refusing to hire someone on this basis cannot be justified.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that this policy also harms small businesses. When an employer rejects half of the population, it loses skilled staff, because companies that recruit from the whole population, rather than only half of it, have access to more talent and different perspectives. For instance, a small company that refuses to interview young women may hire a weaker candidate, which can reduce the quality of its work. Although some people argue that maternity leave is costly for small companies, governments can help by paying part of

this cost. Consequently, recruiting the best person for each job is also the best choice for business.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that small businesses should not avoid hiring young women because of possible maternity leave. Such a policy treats female candidates unjustly, and it also prevents employers from finding the most talented staff.

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126 · BUS-16

> *Sales companies should recruit people who are hungry for money, as they will make the most dedicated workers. Do you think money is the driving force behind hard work? What factors should be taken into*

> *consideration when recruiting staff for sales positions?*

Some argue that sales companies should hire money-hungry people because they will work the hardest. I firmly believe that money is not the main driving force, and communication skills and honesty matter more in salespeople.

I firmly believe that money is not the main driving force behind hard work because once people earn enough to live comfortably, other factors often become more important. When workers find their job interesting and feel appreciated by their managers, they put in extra effort that no bonus could buy. For example, a nurse on a modest salary may still work extra hours because she cares about her patients, which shows that commitment does not depend on pay. Although some people argue that people

who are "hungry for money" make the most dedicated workers, such workers often leave when a rival offers more commission. Therefore, money is a motivator but not the main reason for hard work.

One important factor when recruiting sales staff is strong communication skills. Good salespeople must listen carefully to customers and explain products clearly, so they can match the right product to each buyer and build trust. For instance, a mobile phone shop needs staff who can calmly help an angry customer, which keeps that customer loyal to the shop. Another important factor is honesty. A salesperson who cares only about commission may mislead customers; as a result, the company's reputation can be seriously damaged. Consequently, companies

should test these qualities through role-plays and trial periods.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that hard work is driven by more than money because interest and appreciation also motivate people. Sales companies should choose staff who communicate well and treat customers honestly.

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127 · LEI-02

> *Having more money and less free time is better than earning less money and having more free time. Discuss both views and state your opinion.*

While some people argue that having more money is better than having more free time, others believe that extra leisure is more valuable. I completely support the latter view because time with

family and good health cannot be bought.

On the one hand, people who prefer a higher income argue that money brings security. A good salary allows people to provide for their families, pay for their children's education, buy or rent a decent home and save for the future. Little social support is offered in many developing countries; as a result, a well-paid job may be the only protection against illness, unemployment or old age. For example, a worker who saves extra income from overtime can pay for treatment when a parent falls ill, and this would be impossible on a low salary. For this reason, many people believe that more money is worth the loss of free time.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that more free time is better because extra

money tends to add less to happiness than interesting work, good relationships and free time. When people work very long hours, family relationships may suffer, and constant pressure can lead to stress, anxiety and burnout. For instance, a parent who works every evening may earn more but miss their children's school events, which can weaken the bond between them. Although some people argue that a high income brings security, people can live securely on a moderate salary if they manage it carefully. Consequently, extra free time is more valuable than extra money.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether more money or more free time leads to a better life. While a high income provides security, I firmly believe that free time is more valuable

because it protects people's health and family relationships.

Crime & Punishment

128 · CRI-02

> *Many criminals commit further crimes as soon as they are released from prison. What do you think are the causes of this? What possible solutions can you suggest?*

Many offenders return to crime soon after they leave prison. This is mainly because they cannot find legal work and prison fails to change them, but employment support and rehabilitation can tackle this problem.

One of the main causes of reoffending is the difficulty of finding legal work after prison. Many employers are unwilling to hire someone with a criminal record, because they fear that the person may

steal or cause trouble. For example, a former prisoner who is rejected by every employer may be unable to pay rent or support their family, and crime may then appear to be the only way to survive. Another important cause is that prison itself often fails to change offenders' behaviour. Prisoners who spend years with other criminals, without education or training, often learn new criminal skills and join a criminal gang. Consequently, many people leave prison less prepared for normal life than when they entered.

The most effective solution is for governments to help former prisoners find work. If companies receive tax benefits for hiring former offenders, employers will worry less about the risk, and more ex-prisoners will find jobs. For instance, a former prisoner who is hired

by a local factory gains a steady income to pay rent, which removes the need to steal. In addition, prisons could focus on rehabilitation, not only punishment. When prisoners receive education and vocational training, such as carpentry or computer skills, they leave with useful skills, and counselling helps them to take responsibility for their actions. Together, these measures would break the cycle of crime and make society safer.

In conclusion, criminals often reoffend because employers reject them and prison does not improve their behaviour. Practical help with jobs and better training behind bars would reduce crime and protect communities.

129 · CRI-03

> *It is often thought that the increase in juvenile crime can be attributed to violence in the media. Do you agree that this is the main cause of juvenile crime? What solutions can you offer to deal with this situation?*

It is often claimed that violence in the media is the main reason for rising juvenile crime. I firmly believe that it is not the main cause, and support for families and positive activities for teenagers would work better.

I firmly believe that media violence is not the main cause of juvenile crime because the vast majority of people who watch violent films or play violent games never become violent in real life. When teenagers do turn to crime, problems at home, poverty and bad company usually

matter far more. For example, a child who grows up in a violent home or a dangerous neighbourhood is far more likely to become violent than a child who simply watches action films. Although some people argue that children often imitate what they see, most young viewers understand that films are not real life. Therefore, blaming the media ignores the real roots of youth crime.

The most effective solution is for schools and social workers to support families and children at risk. If schools identify troubled pupils early and offer counselling, problems at home can be dealt with before they lead to crime. For instance, a boy who is angry because his parents fight at home may calm down after regular sessions with a school counsellor. In addition, communities could offer teenagers positive ways to

spend their free time. When young people join youth clubs, sports teams or vocational courses, they gain positive role models and spend less time with gangs. Together, these measures would tackle the real causes of youth crime.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that violent media is not the main cause of youth crime because family and social problems matter far more. Early support for troubled children and useful activities for teenagers would reduce it.

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130 · CRI-04

> *In some societies, the number of crimes committed by teenagers is growing. Some people think that, regardless of age, teenagers who commit major crimes should receive*

> *adult punishment. To what extent do you agree?*

As more teenagers commit crimes, it is sometimes claimed that those guilty of major offences should receive the same punishment as adults. I completely disagree with this view because teenagers are less mature than adults and adult prisons can make them more dangerous.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that teenagers are less mature than adults. This is because young people are still developing, both emotionally and mentally. They are more likely to act without thinking about the consequences and more open to change; as a result, they deserve a chance to correct their mistakes. For example, a sixteen-year-old who joins friends in a violent robbery may not fully understand

the result of their actions, and this lack of judgement is very different from an adult's planned crime. Therefore, the law should not judge teenagers in the same way as adults.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that adult prisons can make young offenders more dangerous. When teenagers are locked up with older criminals, they learn the wrong lessons, because placing teenagers in adult prisons can expose them to experienced criminals and make them more likely to reoffend. For instance, a teenager who spends ten years in an adult prison may leave as a more dangerous criminal with no education or skills, which puts the public at greater risk. Although some people argue that the harm to victims is the same, long sentences in adult prisons do not prevent future crime.

Consequently, many legal systems treat young offenders differently, focusing on education and rehabilitation rather than long prison sentences.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that young offenders should not receive the same sentences as adults, even for major crimes. Their judgement is not yet fully formed, and time among hardened criminals would also make them far more likely to reoffend.

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131 · CRI-05

> *Some countries are struggling with an increase in the rate of crime. Many people think that having more police on the streets is the only way*

> *to reduce crime. To what extent do you agree?*

As crime rates rise in some countries, many believe that putting more police on the streets is the only solution. I completely disagree with this view because the police cannot solve the causes of crime and there are other effective ways to prevent it.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that the police cannot solve the causes of crime. This is because police can catch criminals, but they cannot solve the underlying causes of crime, such as poverty, unemployment, poor education and drug addiction. People in these situations may keep breaking the law; as a result, officers arrest one offender while another soon takes their place. For example, a young person with no job in a poor neighbourhood may join

a gang whether there are police nearby or not, and this problem cannot be solved by patrols. Therefore, more officers can only deal with the results of crime.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that there are other effective ways to prevent crime. When governments want long-term results, they can act early, as governments can tackle the causes of crime by creating jobs, improving schools and providing youth programmes and social support in poor neighbourhoods. For instance, a youth programme that teaches poor teenagers a useful trade can keep them away from gangs, which protects people without extra officers. Although some people argue that a visible police presence can deter crime, this effect is often short-term and hiring more

officers is also expensive. Consequently, police work must be combined with social programmes and community involvement.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that a stronger police presence is not the only way to reduce crime. Officers cannot remove the social problems that lead to law-breaking, and better schools, jobs and urban planning can also keep communities safe.

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132 · CRI-06

> *Some people think that women should not be allowed to work in the police force. Do you agree or disagree?*

It is sometimes claimed that women should not be given the opportunity to work as police officers. I completely

disagree with this view because modern policing needs many different skills and excluding women would be deeply unfair.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that modern policing needs many different skills. This is because modern policing involves many skills, including communication, investigation and working with victims, and female officers are often particularly effective in cases involving women and children. Not all police work depends on physical strength; as a result, a force that includes women can serve the whole community better. For example, a victim of sexual violence may feel more comfortable reporting the crime to a female officer than to a male one, and this can help the police to catch the offender. Therefore,

female officers make the police stronger and more effective.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that excluding women would be deeply unfair. When women are denied a career because of their gender, their rights are ignored, as it is a matter of fairness and human rights: people should be judged on their ability, not their gender. For instance, a fit and intelligent young woman who passes the same tests as male candidates should have the same chance of serving her country, which is already possible in Bangladesh. Although some people argue that the work can be physically dangerous, officers are selected through fitness tests and training, whatever their gender. Consequently, most countries now recruit both men and women, and this is the right approach.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that women should have the right to join the police. A mixed force brings a wider range of abilities to the job, and equal access to this profession is also a matter of basic justice.

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133 · CRI-07

> *Many crimes are often related to the consumption of alcohol. Some people think that the best way to reduce the crime rate is to ban alcohol. Do you think this is an effective measure against crime? What other solutions can you suggest?*

Because many crimes are linked to alcohol, some people believe that banning it is the best way to reduce crime. I firmly believe that a ban would not be effective, and controlling sales

and treating addiction would work better.

I firmly believe that banning alcohol would not be an effective measure against crime because it would create new criminal activity. When alcohol is banned, illegal markets appear, controlled by criminals, and people may drink dangerous homemade alcohol. For example, a man who can no longer buy alcohol legally may buy cheap homemade liquor from a gang, which can make him seriously ill and gives the profits to criminals. Although some people argue that domestic violence, fights and dangerous driving are often linked to alcohol, a ban would push drinking out of sight rather than stop it. Therefore, a complete ban would bring more problems than it solves.

The most effective alternative is for governments to control how alcohol is sold. When bars must close early and young people cannot buy alcohol, there are fewer late-night fights and drink-driving accidents. For instance, a town that stops bars from serving alcohol after midnight may see far fewer fights on its streets in the early morning. In addition, health services could offer treatment to people who are already addicted. For people who are already addicted, treatment and rehabilitation programmes, including medical care, counselling and support groups, can help them recover and return to normal life. Together, these measures would reduce alcohol-related crime without the dangers of a ban.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that prohibiting alcohol would fail because it

would create illegal markets run by criminals. Stricter control of sales and treatment for addicts would reduce alcohol-related crime more successfully.

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134 · CRI-08

> *Some people think certain prisoners should be made to do unpaid community work instead of being put behind bars. To what extent do you agree?*

It is often argued that certain offenders should perform unpaid work for the community instead of being sent to prison. I completely agree with this view because this punishment is more useful to society and it also reduces the risk of future crime.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that community work is more

useful to society than prison. This is because community work allows offenders to pay back to society for the harm they have caused. Keeping a person in prison is expensive, while community service requires only supervision; as a result, public money can be saved for schools and hospitals. For example, a young person who repairs damaged public property under one supervisor costs far less than a prisoner, and the money saved can help to pay for a local school. Therefore, this punishment benefits both local people and taxpayers.

Another important reason for my agreement is that community work reduces the risk of future crime. When offenders stay in the community, they can keep their jobs and family relationships, which are important for

staying away from crime. For instance, a first-time offender who continues working and lives at home does not meet serious criminals in prison, which reduces the risk that they will learn new criminal behaviour. Although some people argue that they do not provide enough deterrence or justice, a well-supervised programme can be a hard and public punishment. Consequently, unpaid community work is a better choice than prison for first-time and non-violent offenders.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that some offenders should do unpaid community service and not go to prison. This sentence gives something back to the public, and it also helps people to return to a normal and law-abiding life.

135 · CRI-09

> *Many people believe that having a fixed punishment for all crimes is more efficient. What are the advantages and disadvantages of having a fixed punishment?*

Some people believe that giving every crime a fixed punishment would make the justice system more efficient. Although fixed penalties can ignore personal circumstances and remove judges' mercy, they bring consistency and faster trials.

There is little doubt that fixed punishments offer considerable advantages to the justice system. To begin with, the main argument for fixed punishments is consistency and fairness. This is because everyone who commits the same crime receives the same

penalty, which can increase public trust in the justice system and reduce the influence of corruption, personal bias or prejudice. For example, a rich businessman and a poor rickshaw driver who commit the same offence would receive the same sentence, which shows that the law treats everyone equally. In addition, fixed punishments are not only clear but also faster for the courts. As a result of removing long debates about sentences, cases can be completed more quickly and cheaply, which reduces court delays. Overall, fixed punishments could make the legal system more trusted and efficient.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that fixed punishments also have some drawbacks. Firstly, the biggest problem is that they ignore individual circumstances. Two people may commit

the same crime for very different reasons; as a result, the same penalty can be deeply unfair. For instance, a hungry person who steals food to feed their children is not the same as a professional criminal who steals expensive goods to sell. Secondly, judges would lose the power to show mercy to young or mentally ill offenders. If a teenager who shows genuine regret receives the same sentence as a repeat offender, he may lose hope of a fresh start and, consequently, become more likely to reoffend. Overall, these problems could make a fixed system feel harsh and unjust to many citizens.

In conclusion, giving each crime one set penalty is an idea that many people support. While fixed punishments may treat different situations unfairly, they

make justice more consistent and efficient.

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136 · CRI-10

> *Some people think that the government should be responsible for crime prevention, while others believe that it is the responsibility of the individual to protect themselves. Discuss both sides and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that individuals must protect themselves from crime, others believe that prevention is the responsibility of the government. I completely support the latter view because only governments can tackle the causes of crime.

On the one hand, people who support personal responsibility argue that police

cannot be everywhere. People can lock their doors, avoid displaying valuable items in public, use strong passwords online and be careful at night. Communities can organise neighbourhood watch groups, in which residents look out for suspicious activity and report it to the police. For example, residents who watch their street at night and report suspicious visitors may stop a burglary before it happens, and this makes the area safer for everyone. For this reason, many people believe that individuals should be responsible for their own safety.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that crime prevention is the government's duty because governments can tackle the causes of crime by creating jobs, improving schools and providing youth programmes. When young people are

given jobs and good schools, they are less likely to turn to crime, and no individual can provide these things. For instance, a teenager in a poor area who joins a government training programme may find work instead of joining a gang, which makes the whole neighbourhood safer. Although some people argue that locks and careful habits prevent crime, these precautions protect only one home and do not remove the reasons why crimes happen. Consequently, preventing crime must be the responsibility of the government.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether crime prevention is the duty of governments or of individuals. While sensible precautions can protect a home, I firmly believe that governments should be responsible because only they can deal with the causes of crime.

137 · CRI-11

> *The death penalty is the best way to control and reduce serious crime. To what extent do you agree?*

It is sometimes claimed that executing criminals is the most effective way to control serious crime. I completely disagree with this view because there is no clear evidence that it reduces crime and innocent people may be executed.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that the death penalty does not clearly reduce crime. This is because there is no clear evidence that countries with the death penalty have lower murder rates than similar countries without it. Many serious crimes are committed in anger or by people who never expect to be caught; as a result, they do not think about the punishment.

For example, a person who kills during a violent argument is unlikely to stop and consider the law, and this shows why a harsher sentence may not prevent such a crime. Therefore, it is the certainty of being caught, not the severity of punishment, that deters most criminals.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that the death penalty carries the risk of executing innocent people. When courts make errors, the results can be terrible, because witnesses can make mistakes, evidence can be misunderstood, and police or courts can be influenced by corruption or prejudice. For instance, in several countries, people who were sentenced to death have later been proved innocent, sometimes through new DNA evidence, which shows that this danger is real. Although some people argue that some crimes are

so terrible that death is the only fitting punishment, once a person has been executed, such a mistake can never be corrected. Consequently, life imprisonment without the possibility of release is a better alternative.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that capital punishment is not the best way to deal with serious crime. It has not been proved to stop offenders, and it also creates the terrible possibility of killing someone who did nothing wrong.

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138 · CRI-12

> *While it is sometimes thought that prison is the best place for criminals, others believe that there are better*

> *ways to deal with them. What is your opinion?*

While some people argue that offenders should always be sent to prison, others believe that there are more effective ways to deal with them. I completely support the latter view because prison often makes criminals worse.

On the one hand, people who support prison argue that it plays an essential role in protecting society. People who commit serious violent crimes, such as murder, rape or armed robbery, need to be kept away from society so that they cannot harm others. Prison also acts as a deterrent; as a result, the fear of losing one's freedom may stop some people from committing crimes. For example, someone thinking of stealing a car may change their mind when imagining years in prison, and this protects a possible

victim. For this reason, many people believe that prison is the best place for criminals.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that there are better ways to deal with criminals because young or first-time offenders who are imprisoned for minor crimes may mix with experienced criminals. When they are released, many struggle to find work because of their criminal record, and they soon return to crime. For instance, a teenager caught shoplifting may learn more from community service and counselling than from six months behind bars, which gives them a better chance of finding a job. Although some people argue that prison keeps society safe, this protection ends on the day that a prisoner returns to a life of crime. Consequently, methods

that reduce reoffending are more effective than prison.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether criminals should be sent to prison or dealt with in other ways. While prison can deter some offenders, I firmly believe that alternatives are better because education and training help people to stop committing crimes.

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139 · CRI-13

> *The crime rate in most countries is often higher in urban areas than in rural areas. Why do you think that is? What can be done to reduce the crime rate?*

In most countries, crime rates are higher in urban areas than in the countryside. This is mainly because of strong

inequality and anonymity in cities, but more jobs and neighbourhood watch groups can reduce urban crime.

One of the main causes of this difference is the strong inequality found in cities. Wealthy and poor neighbourhoods exist side by side, which can create resentment and temptation. For example, a jobless young person who lives beside a wealthy area may see expensive phones and cars every day, and this can tempt them to steal. Another important cause is that city life is more anonymous. People in cities often do not know their neighbours, so criminals can act anonymously, without being recognised. Consequently, cities offer both stronger reasons to commit crime and a better chance of escaping notice.

The most effective solution is for governments to tackle the causes of crime by creating jobs, improving schools and providing youth programmes and social support in poor neighbourhoods. When young people have a steady income and useful activities, stealing becomes far less tempting. For instance, a jobless young person who joins a training programme and finds work in a local workshop has less reason to steal, which also makes the neighbourhood safer. In addition, communities could reduce anonymity by working together. Communities can organise neighbourhood watch groups, in which residents look out for suspicious activity and report it to the police. Together, these measures would bring some of the safety of village life to large cities.

In conclusion, crime is higher in cities because inequality creates temptation and criminals can hide among strangers. Better opportunities for young people and stronger neighbourhood cooperation would make cities much safer.

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140 · CRI-14

> *Some people think that poverty is the reason behind most crimes. Do you agree or disagree?*

It is sometimes claimed that most crimes are committed because people are poor. I completely disagree with this view because most poor people never break the law and many serious crimes are caused by greed or addiction.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that poverty alone does not explain all crime. This is because most

poor people are honest and never break the law, even when they have very little money. Many families teach their children that stealing is wrong, whatever their situation; as a result, millions of people stay honest in spite of hardship. For example, a rickshaw puller who earns a small daily income may work long hours for many years without ever committing a crime, and this is true of countless poor workers. Therefore, being poor cannot be described as the main reason why people commit crimes.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that many serious crimes are caused by greed or addiction. When wealthy people commit crimes, they do not need the money, as these white-collar crimes are driven by greed rather than need. For instance, a corrupt official who accepts a large bribe is rarely

poor, which shows that fraud, corruption, tax evasion and bribery can come from the wish for more wealth. Although some people argue that poverty and unemployment are often linked to crime, drug and alcohol addiction can lead people to steal in order to pay for their habit, whatever their income. Consequently, governments must look beyond poverty when they try to reduce crime.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that a lack of money is not the reason behind most crimes. The majority of low-income people obey the law, and much serious offending also comes from personal greed and drug use.

141 · CRI-16

> *Some people think that the parents of children who commit crime should also receive a punishment. Do you agree or disagree?*

It is sometimes claimed that mothers and fathers should also be punished when their children commit crimes. I completely disagree with this view because many parents cannot fully control their teenagers and punishment would only harm struggling families further.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that many parents cannot fully control their teenagers. This is because many parents do their best but still cannot control a rebellious teenager. Teenagers want to be accepted by their friends, and if their friends are involved

in crime, they may join in to prove themselves; as a result, even caring parents may not know what their children are doing. For example, a single parent who works two jobs may never know that a teenage son has joined a gang, and this family should not be blamed for a choice that the boy made alone. Therefore, it would be unfair to punish people for actions that they could not prevent.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that punishment would harm struggling families. When parents are fined or sent to prison, the whole household suffers, as punishing them may cause further harm to struggling families. For instance, a poor family that must pay a heavy fine may have less money for food and school fees, which could push the younger children towards

the same problems. Although some people argue that children who lack parental supervision, love and discipline are more likely to behave badly, parenting classes and family support are often seen as fairer than fines or imprisonment. Consequently, governments should help these families instead of making their lives harder.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that parents should not be punished for the crimes of their children. Young people often act beyond the control of their families, and penalties would also make life worse for homes that are already in difficulty.

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142 · MED-02

> *Violence in the media promotes violence in society. To what extent do*

> *you agree?*

Sample answer 1

It is often argued that violent films, games and online videos are making society more violent. I completely disagree with this view because watching violence rarely leads to real violence and other factors have a far stronger effect on behaviour.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that watching violence rarely leads to real violence. This is because most people can tell the difference between a story on a screen and real life, and even though violent films are popular, few viewers become violent. Millions of people watch action films and play games every week; as a result, violence would be far more common if the media were the main cause. For example, in some countries where

violent video games are extremely popular, crime rates have fallen in recent decades, and this suggests that there is no simple link between the two. Therefore, the effect of violent media on society has been greatly exaggerated.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that other factors have a far stronger effect on behaviour. When young people become violent, the real causes are usually found in their lives, such as poverty, family breakdown, drug use and peer pressure. For instance, a teenager who grows up in a violent home and joins a gang learns aggression from the people around them, which is far more powerful than any film. Although some people argue that repeated exposure to violent images may make people less sensitive to the suffering of others, this does not make ordinary

viewers attack anyone. Consequently, governments should focus on these social problems instead of blaming films and games.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that violent media is not responsible for violence in society. Most viewers never copy what they see on a screen, and difficult family and social conditions also play a much greater part in aggressive behaviour.

Sample answer 2

It is often argued that violent content on television, in films and online is making real society more violent. I completely disagree with this view because most viewers never copy what they watch and the media can also teach positive values.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that most viewers never copy what they watch. This is because the vast

majority of people who watch violent films or play violent games never become violent in real life. Violence in society is usually caused by deeper problems, such as poverty, family breakdown, drug use and anger; as a result, it is unfair to blame screens for it. For example, a young man who joins a street fight is usually driven by poverty or family breakdown, while millions of people who enjoy the same action films never hurt anyone. Therefore, the link between violent media and real violence is far weaker than many people believe.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that the media can also teach positive values. When children watch good programmes with their parents, they learn, because high-quality programmes can teach children positive values, such as kindness, cooperation

and respect. For instance, a film that shows the pain of a family who lost a son in a street fight can make young viewers think carefully, which may discourage them from fighting. Although some people argue that young children often copy the words, actions and attitudes they see on screen, television channels and streaming services can support parents through age ratings, parental controls and responsible scheduling. Consequently, the media is more often a useful teacher than a cause of violence.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that violence on screens does not cause violence in society. Almost all viewers remain peaceful in real life, and good films and programmes can also encourage respect and kindness among young people.

Family & Society

143 · FAM-01

> *Nowadays parents put too much pressure on their children to succeed. What is the reason for doing this? Is this a negative or positive development?*

Nowadays, many parents put heavy pressure on their children to achieve success. This is mainly because competition is intense and parents compare their children with others, and I firmly believe that this is a negative development.

One of the main reasons for this is intense competition. Places at the best schools, universities and jobs are limited, and parents fear that their children will

be left behind if they do not perform exceptionally well. For example, a father who knows that thousands of students compete for a few medical college seats may send his daughter to tuition every evening, and this leaves her little time to rest. Another important reason is social comparison with relatives and neighbours. Parents may feel embarrassed if their child's results are worse than a cousin's; as a result, they demand even higher marks. Consequently, many children's lives become filled with study and little else.

As for whether this is positive or negative, I firmly believe that it is a negative development because it damages children's health and happiness. Children who are constantly pushed may suffer from stress, anxiety, sleep problems and depression. For

instance, a teenager who studies until midnight to meet her parents' expectations may lose sleep and feel anxious before every test, which harms both her health and her results. Although some people argue that moderate expectations can have positive effects, constant pressure turns learning into fear rather than motivation. Therefore, pushing children too hard does far more harm than good.

In conclusion, parents push their children hard because competition is fierce and they compare them with other children. I firmly believe that this trend is harmful because it damages young people's health and happiness.

144 · FAM-02

> *Some people think it is better for children to grow up in the city, while others think that life in the countryside is more suitable. What are the advantages and disadvantages of both places?*

Parents often debate whether children should grow up in a busy city or in the quiet countryside. Although cities can be polluted and villages often lack good schools, urban areas offer more opportunities and rural areas provide a healthier environment.

There is little doubt that both cities and the countryside offer considerable advantages to children. To begin with, cities offer many opportunities for children, especially in education and leisure. This is because the best schools,

colleges, libraries, hospitals and sports facilities are usually located in urban areas. For example, a girl in Dhaka who joins a coding club may discover a talent for computing, and this could shape her future career. In addition, the countryside offers a healthier and more natural environment where children can play freely. As a result of cleaner air and outdoor play, rural children stay fit and healthy, which protects them from many illnesses. Overall, each environment supports a different part of a child's growth, from learning to physical health.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that both places also have some drawbacks. Firstly, many city children experience health problems because of air pollution, traffic congestion and noise. Without safe parks or playgrounds nearby, they often stay indoors; as a

result, they spend more time on screens. For instance, a boy in a small city flat with no playground nearby may spend every evening watching videos, which can leave him unfit and unhealthy. Secondly, limited opportunities can be a serious obstacle in rural areas, as schools may lack qualified teachers, laboratories and libraries. If a talented village child has no laboratory or science club, she may lose interest in science and, consequently, never reach her full potential. Overall, these health and educational problems show that neither place is perfect for raising children.

In conclusion, families must choose between urban and rural childhoods. While cities may harm children's health and villages may limit their education, cities offer more opportunities and the

countryside gives them a healthier childhood.

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145 · FAM-03

> *In many modern societies, grandchildren rarely spend any quality time with their grandparents. What do you think are the consequences of this?*

In many modern societies, grandchildren rarely spend quality time with their grandparents. This can lead to loneliness among older people and a loss of family history and traditions for the children.

The most serious consequence is that many grandparents lose the joy and purpose that time with their grandchildren once gave them. Playing with children, helping with homework or teaching a skill keeps older people

mentally and physically active, and it makes them feel valued and needed. When this contact disappears, grandparents may feel isolated and forgotten, which can harm their mental health. For example, a grandmother in a village who sees her grandchildren only during Eid may spend most of the year feeling lonely and unwanted, and her health may suffer as a result. Consequently, many older people lose both their happiness and their sense of purpose in the family.

Another consequence is that children lose touch with their family's past. Through stories, songs, recipes and traditions, grandparents pass on knowledge about the family's past and the community's way of life. Without this contact, children may lose touch with their family history, traditional values

and even their mother tongue or regional dialect. For instance, a child who never hears their grandfather's stories about the Liberation War may know little about their own family's history and the sacrifices it made. Over time, the generation gap may widen, making it harder for different generations to understand each other.

In conclusion, when grandchildren and grandparents rarely meet, older people often feel lonely and forgotten. Children, in turn, lose valuable family stories, values and traditions that connect them with their past.

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146 · FAM-04

> *Nowadays, it seems that different generations within the family spend less time doing activities together.*

> *Why is that? Is it a positive or negative development?*

Members of different generations in a family now seem to share fewer activities. This is mainly because modern life is busy and technology separates people, and I firmly believe that this is a negative development.

One of the main reasons for this is the busy modern lifestyle. Parents often work long hours, while children spend much of their time at school, in private tuition and doing homework. For example, a father who returns home late from the office may find that his son is still at a tuition class, and this means that they rarely eat together. Another important reason is technology, which has changed the way families spend their evenings. In the past, relatives gathered to watch the same television programme,

whereas each member may now spend free time in a separate digital world. Consequently, a family can live in one home and still share very little time.

As for whether this trend is positive or negative, I firmly believe that it is harmful because shared activities strengthen family relationships. When relatives eat, talk and travel together, they learn to understand and support each other, and children feel more secure and confident. For instance, a teenager who talks to their parents at dinner every evening is more likely to ask for help with a problem, which may stop it from becoming serious. Although some people argue that video calls can connect generations, a short call cannot replace the closeness of time spent together. Therefore, this loss of family time is clearly a negative development.

In conclusion, families share less time because daily schedules are crowded and digital devices keep relatives apart. I firmly believe that this change is damaging because it weakens the closest bonds in people's lives.

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147 · FAM-05

> *Children can learn effectively by watching television. Therefore, they should be encouraged to watch television regularly at home and at school. To what extent do you agree or disagree?*

It is sometimes claimed that children learn well from television, so they should be encouraged to watch it regularly at home and at school. I completely disagree with this view because passive watching does not replace active learning

and too much television harms children's development.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that passive watching does not replace active learning. This is because much television is designed mainly for entertainment, and watching passively does not replace active learning, play and conversation. Children simply sit and receive information without asking questions or solving problems; as a result, they quickly forget much of what they see. For example, a child who builds a model volcano with a teacher usually remembers more about science than a child who only watches a programme about it, and this shows the value of active learning. Therefore, television cannot be an effective way of teaching children regularly.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that too much television harms children's development. When television becomes a daily habit, the results can be serious, as children who watch a lot of television or play video games often spend less time playing outside, reading or talking with others. For instance, a four-year-old who watches cartoons all afternoon may have less conversation with adults, which can slow their language development. Although some people argue that well-made documentaries, educational programmes and learning apps can teach children about science, nature, history and languages, these can be used occasionally and do not need to be a regular habit. Consequently, television should not be encouraged as part of a child's daily routine.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that children should not be encouraged to watch television regularly at home or in the classroom. Sitting in front of a screen is a weak way to learn, and it also damages their health and social skills.

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148 · FAM-06

> *Some people think that the role of parents is to discipline their children and teach them about right and wrong. Other people consider that the main responsibility of parents is to nurture their children and provide them with a safe environment to grow up in. Discuss both sides and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that a parent's main role is to discipline children and teach them right from wrong, others

believe that it is to nurture them in a safe home. I completely support the latter view because loved children become confident.

On the one hand, people who support discipline argue that children need clear rules to become responsible adults. Without discipline, children may become selfish, rude or uncontrollable, and they may fail to respect teachers, elders and the law. Bad behaviour is often repeated if it is never corrected; as a result, it can become a lifelong habit. For example, a child who is never punished for lying may continue to lie at school and later at work, and this can damage their relationships. For this reason, many people believe that discipline is the main duty of parents.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that nurturing is the main responsibility of

parents because children who feel loved and secure become more confident. When a home is warm and stable, children have the emotional strength to learn and make friends, and they can cope with stress better. For instance, a teenager who feels safe at home is unlikely to hide problems from their parents instead of asking for help, which allows the family to solve them early. Although some people argue that children need strict correction, punishment without love can make them fearful or even rebellious. Consequently, love and safety are the most important things that parents can provide.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether parents should mainly discipline or nurture their children. While clear rules teach children how to behave, I firmly believe that nurturing is

more important because love and security give young people confidence.

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149 · FAM-07

> *Most modern families have both parents working, and as a result, children spend less and less time with their parents. What is the reason for this? What problems can this cause?*

In most modern families, both parents work, so children see less of them. This is mainly because living costs are high and more women build careers, and this can lead to less supervision and stressed parents.

One of the main reasons for this is that the cost of living has risen sharply, especially in cities. Housing, education, healthcare and transport are expensive, and many families need two incomes

simply to meet their basic needs. For example, a family in Dhaka with two school-age children may find it almost impossible to pay the rent and school fees on one salary, and this forces both parents to work. Another important reason is that more women are now highly educated and want to use their skills and build careers. Society increasingly accepts women's employment; as a result, many couples see a career for both partners as normal. Consequently, dual-income families have become common.

The most serious problem caused by this trend is that children may receive less attention and supervision. Without supervision, some children may spend too much time on screens, eat unhealthy food or fall into bad company. For instance, a twelve-year-old who comes

home to an empty flat every afternoon may play online games for hours instead of doing homework. Another problem is the stress that working parents face. Working mothers in particular often face a double burden, doing paid work during the day and most of the housework and childcare in the evening. Consequently, family life can become tired and tense for both parents and children.

In conclusion, both parents go out to work mainly because of rising living costs and women's career ambitions. However, this leaves children with less supervision and puts working parents, especially mothers, under heavy pressure.

> *The nuclear family is well adapted to move geographically due to its size. Do you think children benefit in any way from moving? Do you think the advantages outweigh the disadvantages?*

Being small, nuclear families can move to new places more easily than large ones. Although moving may cause children stress and separate them from relatives, it also gives them access to better schools and teaches them to adapt. In my opinion, the advantages of moving clearly outweigh the disadvantages.

There is little doubt that moving to a new place offers considerable advantages to children. To begin with, the most significant benefit is access to better

schools and facilities in larger cities. This is because the best schools, colleges, libraries, hospitals and sports facilities are usually located in urban areas. For example, a child whose family moves from a small town to Dhaka may join a science club, and this could spark a lifelong interest. In addition, moving not only broadens children's experience but also teaches them to adapt to change. As a result of making new friends and settling into new routines, children develop confidence and flexibility, which help them later at university and work. Overall, a well-planned move can prepare children for both academic success and a changing world.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that moving also has some drawbacks for children. Firstly, many children experience stress when they suddenly

lose close friends and must join a new school. Without familiar faces around them, they often feel lonely; as a result, their schoolwork may suffer for several months. For instance, a teenager who changes school in the middle of exam preparation may fall behind, which can lower his final results. Secondly, distance from relatives can be a serious obstacle, as nuclear families can be isolated after a move. If grandparents live far away, children may have little contact with them and, consequently, lose an important source of love and support. Although these social and family challenges can be painful at first, most children overcome them once they settle in.

In conclusion, relocating for work or study has become common for small families. While a move may upset

children and separate them from relatives, it brings better schooling and teaches them to adapt. Therefore, I firmly believe that the benefits far outweigh the drawbacks.

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151 · FAM-09

> *In the past, the older generation were a source of knowledge and experience. Nowadays, the older generation have little understanding or experience of the modern world. Has this had any negative impact on the way the elderly are treated by society and the family? What could be done to solve this situation?*

Older people were once valued for their knowledge, but many now know little about the modern world. I firmly believe that this has harmed the way they are

treated, and digital training and community activities could improve the situation.

I firmly believe that this change has had a negative impact because older people's advice is now often ignored. Young people who grow up with digital technology may communicate in ways that older relatives do not understand, and grandparents who cannot use smartphones may feel excluded from family conversations that take place online. For example, a grandfather who cannot use a smartphone may be left out when his family plans a trip in an online group chat, which makes him feel unimportant. Although some people argue that families still respect their elders, many older people now feel that nobody asks for their opinion. Therefore,

this knowledge gap has clearly harmed how elderly people are treated.

The most effective solution is for young people to teach older relatives how to use technology. Young people can teach older relatives how to use smartphones, while older people can share their wisdom and experience. For instance, a grandson who shows his grandfather how to make video calls may also hear stories about his grandfather's youth, which brings them closer. In addition, communities could create more chances for older people to stay active. Community centres, social clubs and volunteer programmes can keep older people active and connected, reducing loneliness and allowing them to share their skills and experience. Together, these measures would help society value its elderly members again.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that older people's limited knowledge of modern life has led others to ignore them. Sharing digital skills within families and offering community activities would help the generations respect each other again.

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152 · FAM-10

> *In many western countries there is an increasing number of couples choosing to have no children. What are the advantages and disadvantages to couples having no children?*

In many Western countries, more couples are deciding not to have children. Although this choice may leave them without family support in old age and contribute to an ageing society, it

also gives them more freedom and money.

There is little doubt that choosing not to have children offers considerable advantages to some couples. To begin with, such couples often have more time and money for their careers, hobbies, travel and each other. This is because they do not need to plan their lives around school hours, childcare or family holidays. For example, a childless couple can start a business or move abroad for work, because no children depend on their income. In addition, childless couples avoid the stress and costs of raising children, which are rising as education and housing become more expensive. As a result of these savings, they can often afford a higher standard of living, and their relationship may become closer. Overall, a life without

children can give couples greater independence and financial security.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that this choice also has some drawbacks. Firstly, many childless people experience loneliness, as they may lack family support in old age. Without children to visit or care for them, they depend on paid carers; as a result, their final years may feel empty. For instance, an elderly widow who has no children may have no one to take her to hospital, which can make illness frightening. Secondly, falling birth rates can be a serious obstacle, as they can lead to an ageing population and fewer workers to support pensions and healthcare. If many couples make this choice, taxes on workers may rise and, consequently, the economy may slow down. Overall, these personal and social

problems can affect both childless people and the wider community.

In conclusion, staying childless is now common in the West. While such couples may lack care in old age and contribute to an ageing population, they enjoy greater freedom and a higher living standard.

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153 · FAM-11

> *These days people are living into their 90s and beyond. As a result, there is increasing concern about care for the elderly. Do you think it is the responsibility of the family to care for their elderly members, or should the government be held responsible?*

While some people argue that governments should be responsible for

caring for older citizens, others believe that this is the duty of their families. I completely support the latter view because older people feel happier at home.

On the one hand, people who support government care argue that families cannot always meet the needs of older people. Many adults work long hours or live far from their parents, and some cannot afford expensive treatment. Serious illnesses require trained staff; as a result, elderly people may need professional medical care that family members are not trained to provide. For example, a patient with dementia may need help day and night from trained nurses, and this is difficult for a busy family to provide. For this reason, many people believe that the government should be responsible.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that families should care for older relatives because parents spend many years raising their children, so it seems natural that children should look after them in old age. When older people stay with their families, they feel loved and respected, and their mental health is usually better. For instance, in many joint families in Bangladesh, grandparents eat with their grandchildren every day and teach them traditions, which gives them a strong sense of purpose. Although some people argue that trained nurses offer better medical care, medical care alone cannot replace the love and company of relatives. Consequently, looking after the elderly should be the responsibility of the family.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether families or governments should look after elderly people. While trained staff can provide good medical care, I firmly believe that this duty belongs to families because older people need love and company.

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154 · FAM-12

> *Children these days have more freedom than in previous generations. Do you think this is a positive or negative development?*

Compared with earlier generations, children today enjoy far more freedom to choose their activities, friends and clothes. Although this freedom can expose them to online dangers and weaken discipline, it also builds independence and encourages creativity.

In my view, this development brings more benefits than drawbacks.

There is little doubt that greater freedom offers considerable advantages to children growing up today. To begin with, when children are allowed to make their own decisions, they develop independence, confidence and responsibility. This is because a child who chooses their own hobbies, manages a small amount of money or travels to school alone learns practical life skills. For example, a girl who manages her own pocket money soon learns to save, and this habit helps her throughout her life. In addition, freedom not only builds independence but also encourages creativity and self-expression in young people. As a result of exploring their own interests, children often become more curious and innovative, which helps

them at school and work. Overall, freedom prepares children well for the decisions and challenges of adult life.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that more freedom also has some drawbacks. Firstly, many children face online dangers, as they do not always have the maturity to understand risks. Without supervision, they browse freely; as a result, they may be exposed to violent or inappropriate content, online bullying or strangers with bad intentions. For instance, a twelve-year-old who chats with strangers online may share personal details, which could put her in danger. Secondly, a lack of rules can be a serious obstacle, as too much freedom may also weaken respect and discipline. If children are rarely told "no", they may struggle to accept rules at school or in society and, consequently,

become disrespectful towards teachers. Although these safety and discipline problems are real, most children avoid them once parents set clear limits.

In conclusion, modern children are given much more independence than in the past. While this freedom may expose them to online risks and weaken discipline, it helps them become confident, responsible and creative. Overall, I believe this is a positive development.

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155 · FAM-13

> *The values we gain from our parents and family have more influence over our future success than any skills or knowledge learned in school. To*

> *what extent do you agree or disagree?*

It is often argued that the values we learn from our families affect our future success more than any skills or knowledge from school. I completely agree with this view because family values build a person's character and they also keep people motivated after failure.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that family values build a person's character. This is because, from an early age, children learn from their parents how to behave, how to treat others and how to respond to challenges. Honest and reliable people are respected at work; as a result, they receive more responsibility and more opportunities over time. For example, an employee who learned honesty from their parents

may refuse a bribe, and this decision can earn them the trust of their managers and customers. Therefore, character is one of the strongest foundations of long-term success.

Another important reason for my agreement is that family values keep people motivated after failure. When life becomes difficult, knowledge alone may not help, because these values often determine whether a person keeps trying after failure, behaves ethically and earns the trust of others. For instance, many doctors and engineers in Bangladesh come from poor village families that taught them to work hard and never give up, which helped them to overcome serious difficulties. Although some people argue that schools provide the knowledge and qualifications that are required for most careers, many

successful people come from families with limited wealth or education but strong values. Consequently, the lessons that we learn at home have the greatest influence on our future.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that the values learned at home matter more for success than anything taught in the classroom. They shape honest and reliable adults, and they also give people the strength to continue when they face setbacks.

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156 · SOC-02

> *In many countries women no longer feel the need to get married. Some people believe that this is because women are able to earn their own income and therefore do not require the financial security that marriage*

> *can bring. To what extent do you agree?*

In many countries, fewer women now feel that they have to marry, and it is often argued that this is because they can support themselves financially. I completely agree with this view because women now have their own income and marriage is no longer necessary for financial security.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that women now have their own income. This is because one of the biggest changes is that more women are working outside the home. Women's employment has improved family incomes and given many women financial independence and greater confidence; as a result, they can make important life decisions for themselves. For example, millions of women work in

the garment industry in Bangladesh, and increasing numbers are doctors, teachers, engineers and business owners, which gives them real choices. Therefore, employment has given many women the freedom to choose their own future.

Another important reason for my agreement is that marriage is no longer necessary for financial security. When a woman can pay for her own home, food and other needs, she no longer has to depend on a husband, so marriage becomes a choice and not a necessity. For instance, a young doctor who earns a good salary can live independently and take time to find the right partner, which was impossible for many women in the past. Although some people argue that it reflects a wider change in values, this new freedom is possible only because women now earn their own money.

Consequently, financial independence is the main reason why fewer women feel the need to marry.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that earning their own money is the reason why many women no longer feel they must marry. Paid work has given them independence, and they also no longer need a husband to feel financially secure.

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157 · COM-05

> *People were happier in previous generations compared to now. To what extent do you agree?*

It is sometimes claimed that people in earlier generations were happier than people are today. I completely disagree with this view because people today live longer and healthier lives and they also

have far more freedom and opportunities.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that people today live longer and healthier lives. This is because, thanks to better healthcare and living standards, people are living much longer than in the past. Many diseases that once killed children can now be prevented or cured; as a result, fewer families suffer the pain of losing a loved one at an early age. For example, a family in the past might have lost a child to an infection that a simple medicine can cure today, and this kind of tragedy is much rarer now. Therefore, modern people have a strong reason to feel more secure and content.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that people now have far more freedom and opportunities. When people can choose their education and

career, they can build the life they want, and women's employment has improved family incomes and given many women financial independence and greater confidence. For instance, many women in the past had no chance to study or choose their own careers, which limited their happiness throughout their lives. Although some people argue that a large family can provide emotional and financial support, this close family life often came with poverty and fewer choices. Consequently, it is wrong to imagine that life in the past was happier than life today.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that earlier generations were not happier than people living today. Modern medicine gives us longer lives, and better education and job opportunities also allow us to choose how we live.

158 · COM-06

> *Some people think that teenagers are happier than adults, but others do not agree. Discuss both sides and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that teenagers lead happier lives than adults, others believe that this is simply not true. I completely support the latter view because young people today face serious pressures of their own.

On the one hand, people who believe that teenagers are happier argue that they have fewer responsibilities. Most teenagers do not have to earn money, pay bills or look after a family. Adults are often exhausted by long working hours, job insecurity, heavy workloads; as a result, they have little time to relax. For example, a teenager can spend a holiday

with friends, while their parents may still be answering work calls, and this makes youth seem carefree. For this reason, many people believe that teenagers are happier than adults.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that teenagers are not happier because students face intense pressure to achieve high exam results, often from their parents and teachers. When school work fills every day, teenagers have little rest, and their worries about results can become very stressful. For instance, in Bangladesh and other parts of Asia, children often attend school during the day and private tuition in the evening, with little time for play or rest. Although some people argue that teenagers have no bills to pay, social media has added a new source of pressure, especially for

young people. Consequently, youth is not a happier time of life than adulthood.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether teenagers are really happier than adults. While young people have fewer financial worries, I firmly believe that they are not happier because exam pressure and social media create serious stress in their lives.

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159 · COM-16

> *Some people think that intelligence is innate, while others think that we can improve our intelligence through learning. Discuss both sides and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that intelligence is something that we are born with, others believe that it can be developed through learning. I completely

support the latter view because experience and education shape our abilities.

On the one hand, people who see intelligence as innate argue that intelligence and personality are largely determined by genes. Some children learn to read or count much earlier than others, even with the same teachers. Special abilities are sometimes shown with very little teaching; as a result, many people think that they must come from birth. For example, a child prodigy may solve difficult mathematical problems at the age of eight with very little training, and this suggests a natural ability. For this reason, many people believe that intelligence is innate.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that we can improve our intelligence because people can improve their abilities

through learning and practice. When children receive good teaching and regular encouragement, their thinking develops, and their confidence grows too. For instance, children whose parents read to them develop better language skills, which helps them to understand difficult ideas at school. Although some people argue that certain children are naturally quicker, some people who did poorly at school later become very successful because of their determination. Consequently, intelligence is not fixed at birth.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether intelligence is fixed at birth or can be improved. While genes may give some children an early advantage, I firmly believe that learning matters more because good teaching and practice can develop anyone's abilities.

> *Our personalities are predetermined by our genes before we are born, and there is nothing that can be done to alter our character traits. To what extent do you agree?*

It is sometimes claimed that our personality is fixed by our genes before birth and that it can never be changed. I completely disagree with this view because upbringing strongly shapes our character and people can also change as they grow older.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that upbringing strongly shapes our character. This is because, from an early age, children learn from their parents how to behave, how to treat others and how to respond to challenges. Children who feel loved and safe tend to

be more confident, curious and emotionally stable; as a result, the same child could develop very differently in another home. For example, very strict parents who use shouting, threats or physical punishment may make children fearful, anxious or rebellious, and these feelings can last into adult life. Therefore, our character is not decided only by our genes.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that people can change as they grow older. When adults start new jobs or become parents, they often become more patient and responsible, as many people change aspects of their personality as they grow older and face new challenges. For instance, a shy student who joins a debating club may slowly become a confident speaker, which shows that a character trait can be

changed through effort. Although some people argue that babies are born with different personalities, everyday experience shows that the environment, including family, education and life experiences, has a strong influence. Consequently, it is wrong to say that nothing can be done to change our character.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that our personalities are not permanently fixed by genes before birth. Family life plays a powerful role in forming who we are, and experience and effort also allow us to develop throughout life.

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161 · COM-20

> *Some people think our first impression of someone is important, while others think we should not*

> *judge another person so quickly and should take our time to get to know them better. Discuss both sides and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that our first impression of a person is very important, others believe that we should take time to know them before judging. I completely support the latter view because first impressions are often inaccurate.

On the one hand, people who value first impressions argue that they are often all we have. First impressions matter: candidates who are well prepared, dress appropriately and communicate confidently are more likely to succeed. Quick decisions must be made in many situations; as a result, people depend on what they first see. For example, an interviewer who has only twenty minutes

with each candidate must judge them quickly, and this first view can decide who gets the job. For this reason, many people believe that first impressions are very important.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that we should not judge people quickly because a first impression is based on just a few minutes. When people are nervous or shy, they do not show their real character, and some highly capable people are nervous in interviews and perform poorly. For instance, a quiet new classmate may seem unfriendly at first but later become a loyal and kind friend, which shows how easily we can be wrong. Although some people argue that quick decisions are often necessary, many companies now use additional methods, such as practical tests, group tasks and trial periods, to assess

candidates more fairly. Consequently, we should take time to know others properly.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether first impressions are reliable or whether people should be judged more slowly. While quick judgements can be useful, I firmly believe that we should take time because a short meeting rarely shows someone's true character.

Media & Advertising

162 · MED-01

> *Some companies sponsor sports as a way to advertise themselves. Some people think it is good, while others think there are disadvantages to this. Discuss both sides and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that company sponsorship of sport has serious disadvantages, others believe that it is good for sport. I completely support the latter view because this money provides valuable funding for clubs and players.

On the one hand, people who criticise sponsorship argue that some sponsors sell products that are harmful to health, such as fast food, sugary drinks. When

these brands are associated with sport, which is supposed to promote health, young fans may receive confusing messages. Unhealthy products are made to look attractive through famous players; as a result, children may want them. For example, a soft-drink company sponsoring a cricket tournament may persuade children that sugary drinks are part of an active life, and this can lead to poor eating habits. For this reason, many people believe that sponsorship is harmful.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that sponsorship is good because sponsorship money can fund better facilities, pay players and support young athletes and grassroots clubs. When clubs receive this money, they do not need high ticket prices, and without sponsors, many tournaments and teams could not exist.

For instance, a bank that sponsors a national football league may pay for youth training programmes across the country, which gives poor children a chance to develop their talent. Although some people argue that unhealthy brands send confusing messages, this problem does not outweigh the opportunities that sponsors create for players and fans. Consequently, company sponsorship brings real benefits to the world of sport.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether company sponsorship is good for sport. While some sponsors promote unhealthy products, I firmly believe that it is positive because this money supports clubs, players and young athletes across the country.

163 · MED-03

> *Most people think that the truth should be objective rather than subjective when it comes to the news. Do you think all news is true? What is the function of a newspaper?*

Most people believe that news reports should present objective facts rather than personal opinions. I firmly believe that not all news is true, and newspapers exist mainly to inform the public and to hold powerful people accountable.

I firmly believe that not all news is true because every report is shaped by human choices. Journalists and editors must choose which stories to cover, which facts to include and which words to use, and these choices can reflect their own views or those of the owners. For example, two newspapers may report the

same election result in very different ways, depending on which political party their owners support. Although some people argue that trained journalists report only facts, in reality, complete objectivity is difficult. Therefore, readers should compare several sources instead of believing every report.

One important function of a newspaper is to inform the public accurately about events that affect their lives. Good journalism helps citizens make informed decisions, especially during elections. For instance, a voter who reads a clear report on each party's plans for healthcare can choose a candidate based on facts, which strengthens democracy. Another important function is to act as a watchdog over people in power. A free press also plays a watchdog role, investigating corruption and holding

powerful people accountable. Consequently, newspapers remain essential for a healthy democracy, even though they are not always perfectly objective.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that news is not always true because journalists and owners make choices that reflect their views. Newspapers still matter because they keep citizens informed and expose the misuse of power.

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164 · MED-04

> *More and more newspapers and news channels are using photographs to support their news articles and stories. Some people think that photographs are not a reliable source of news, while others consider photographs to be*

> *irrefutable. Discuss both sides and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that news photographs are undeniable proof of events, others believe that they are not a reliable source of information. I completely support the latter view because images can easily be changed.

On the one hand, people who trust photographs argue that a picture shows exactly what really happened. A single image of a flood or a war can communicate more emotion than many paragraphs. Written reports can easily be exaggerated; as a result, a photograph seems more honest and direct to many readers. For example, photographs of flooded villages in Bangladesh can show the true scale of a disaster more clearly than a written report, and this makes readers trust the news. For this reason,

many people believe that photographs cannot be questioned.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that photographs are not reliable because they can be edited digitally, taken out of context, or chosen to present only one side of a story. When a picture is shared without information about its time and place, readers cannot know what really happened, and many users share stories without reading them fully or checking the source. For instance, an old photograph of a fire may be shared online as if it showed a new event, which can cause panic. Although some people argue that a picture cannot lie, with modern technology, even video can be faked. Consequently, photographs should not be treated as reliable news.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether news photographs are

reliable or undeniable. While a strong image can show the scale of an event, I firmly believe that photographs are not reliable because they can be edited or used out of context.

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165 · MED-05

> *The majority of news being reported is bad news, such as wars, famines, accidents and crime. Why do you think that is? Do you think the news should be a balance of both good and bad news?*

Most news reports focus on negative events such as wars, accidents and crime. This is mainly because bad news attracts attention and earns money, and I firmly believe that the news should be a balance of good and bad stories.

One of the main reasons for this is that bad news attracts attention. Humans naturally pay more attention to danger, and dramatic or shocking stories attract more viewers, readers and clicks. For example, a serious road accident is far more likely to appear on the front page than a successful community project, and this sells more papers. Another important reason is commercial pressure. Because news organisations depend on audiences for advertising income, they have a commercial incentive to focus on such stories. Consequently, the most dramatic events usually lead the news.

As for whether the news should be balanced, I firmly believe that it should because constant bad news gives people a false picture of the world. When viewers see only disasters and crimes,

they may think that life is getting worse, even though health and education are improving in many areas. For instance, a mother who watches only reports of crime may become too afraid to let her children play outside, which harms their health and confidence. Although some people argue that serious problems must always come first, positive stories can still be reported alongside them. Therefore, a fair mix of good and bad news would serve the public better.

In conclusion, bad news dominates because it attracts audiences and brings in advertising money. I firmly believe that the news should mix good and bad stories because this gives people a more accurate view of the world.

> *In the last few decades, there have been more and more cases of famous people being hounded by the press. Some people think that famous people in the media should have no right to privacy. To what extent do you agree?*

As the press follows famous people more and more closely, it is sometimes claimed that these people should have no right to privacy. I completely disagree with this view because celebrities are human beings who need personal space and their families are also affected.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that celebrities are human beings who need personal space, just like everyone else. This is because constant attention from photographers and

journalists can cause stress, anxiety and depression. Much celebrity reporting is not in the public interest; it is simply gossip; as a result, this harm brings no real benefit to society. For example, a singer who is followed to a hospital by photographers may have to deal with a private illness in public, and this gossip helps nobody while making a difficult time more painful. Therefore, being famous should not mean losing all control over one's private life.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that the press also harms innocent family members. When journalists chase a celebrity, the whole family can suffer, because the children did not choose to be famous, yet they may be photographed at school or in the park and have their lives discussed publicly. For instance, a famous

footballer's young daughter may be bullied at school after a story about her parents appears online, which is unfair to a child who has done nothing wrong. Although some people argue that many celebrities actively seek publicity to build their careers, this choice applies to their work and not to their homes. Consequently, the press should keep celebrities' children out of its stories.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that well-known people should keep their right to a private life. Constant media attention damages their mental health, and it also causes real harm to relatives who never chose to be public figures.

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167 · MED-07

> *With the development of online media, there is no future for the*

> *radio. To what extent do you agree?*

It is sometimes claimed that radio has no future because online media has become so popular. I completely disagree with this view because radio is useful in situations where the internet is not and it is also adapting to new technology.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that radio is useful in situations where the internet is not. This is because people can listen while driving, working or cooking, so they do not need to look at a screen. It is important in rural areas and during emergencies when electricity or internet access is limited; as a result, millions of people still depend on it. For example, during a cyclone, coastal villagers without electricity can still receive important warnings on a battery radio, and this information can save many lives. Therefore, radio continues to

provide a service that online media cannot always offer.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that radio is also adapting to new technology. When listeners move online, radio stations can follow them, as many radio stations now broadcast online as podcasts, adapting to new technology. For instance, a young person who misses a favourite radio programme can download it to their phone and listen on the way to work, which gives the station a new audience. Although some people argue that online media will make radio disappear, radio is cheap, simple and easy to use, even for elderly people. Consequently, radio will continue to have a place in modern life.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that radio will survive in spite of the growth of online media. It remains valuable

wherever screens and internet connections are impractical, and its move to digital platforms also brings it new listeners.

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168 · MED-08

> *Some people believe that what children watch on television influences their behaviour. Others say that the amount of time spent watching television influences their behaviour. Discuss both views and give your own opinion.*

While some people argue that children's behaviour is influenced by the content of television programmes, others believe that viewing time matters more. I completely support the latter view because long hours of television replace healthy activities.

On the one hand, people who focus on content argue that children learn by imitation. Young children often copy the words, actions and attitudes they see on screen. If they watch programmes that show violence, rudeness or dangerous stunts, they may repeat this behaviour at home or at school. For example, a young child who watches fighting cartoons every day may start hitting classmates in the playground, and this behaviour can be difficult to change later. For this reason, many people believe that what children watch on television shapes how they behave.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that viewing time matters more because children who watch television for many hours a day spend less time playing outside, reading, talking with family and making friends. When children lose

these activities, they have fewer chances to learn social skills, and their concentration can suffer. For instance, a child watching cartoons for five hours a day may struggle to concentrate in class, which can lead to restless behaviour. Although some people argue that violent programmes teach bad behaviour, even excellent educational programmes can be harmful if children watch them for many hours. Consequently, time in front of a screen has the greater effect on behaviour.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether the content of programmes or the hours spent watching affect children's behaviour more. While violent shows can encourage copying, I firmly believe that viewing time matters more because long hours take children away from healthy activities.

169 · MED-09

> *Some people think that cinemas will one day close due to the popularity of online streaming services for films and series. Do you agree or disagree?*

It is sometimes claimed that cinemas will eventually shut down because online film and series services have become so popular. I completely disagree with this view because home viewing cannot replace the cinema experience and cinemas are adapting to attract audiences.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that cinemas offer an experience that home viewing cannot fully replace. This is because the big screen, powerful sound systems and immersive atmosphere make films, especially action and fantasy films, more exciting and

memorable. Going to the cinema is also a social activity; as a result, friends and families enjoy it as a special outing. For example, many families in Bangladesh go to the cinema together to watch new films during Eid holidays, and this has become an important part of the celebration. Therefore, people will continue to visit cinemas even if they have streaming at home.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that cinemas are adapting to attract audiences. When customers have more choices, cinemas must give them more, as many cinemas now offer luxury seats, 3D and IMAX screens, food and drink services and special events to attract audiences. For instance, a young couple may choose an IMAX film for a special evening out, which is an experience that they cannot

have on a sofa at home. Although some people argue that streaming services have many advantages, convenience alone cannot match the excitement of a shared night out. Consequently, cinemas are unlikely to disappear completely, and they will remain popular.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that online services will not force cinemas to close. A film on the big screen remains a unique shared event, and cinemas are also finding new ways to keep customers interested.

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170 · MED-10

> *Companies spend millions each year on advertising online, in magazines and on billboards. These adverts can encourage people to buy goods that they do not really need. What are the*

> *positive and negative effects of consumerism?*

Companies spend huge sums on advertising, often persuading people to buy things that they do not really need. Although consumerism can cause debt and environmental damage, it also supports economic growth and encourages innovation.

There is little doubt that consumerism offers considerable advantages to modern economies. To begin with, the most significant benefit is its contribution to economic growth. This is because when people buy more goods, companies produce more and hire more workers in factories, shops and transport. For example, millions of workers are employed in Bangladesh's garment industry because of strong global demand for clothes, and their

wages support whole families. In addition, consumer spending not only creates jobs but also encourages companies to improve their products. As a result of fierce competition between brands, firms develop better, cheaper and more convenient goods for their customers. Overall, consumerism helps to create jobs, raise living standards and improve the products that people use every day.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that consumerism also has some drawbacks. Firstly, many people spend money that they do not have. Easy credit makes buying quick and simple; as a result, many people fall into debt through credit cards and loans, which can cause stress and family problems. For instance, a young worker who buys the latest phone on credit every year may

spend months repaying the loan, which leaves little money for savings. Secondly, excessive buying can be a serious threat to the environment, as it creates huge amounts of waste. If cheap clothes are thrown away after being worn only a few times, landfills grow and, consequently, land and water become more polluted. Overall, these financial and environmental problems can harm both individuals and future generations.

In conclusion, a culture of constant buying is now common in many countries. While consumerism may lead to personal debt and growing waste, it drives economic growth and better products.

171 · MED-11

> *One of the prime times for advertising on TV is when children get back from school. Some people think that advertisements aimed at children should not be allowed. What is your opinion?*

Many companies show television adverts in the afternoon, when children come home from school, and some people think that adverts aimed at children should be banned. I completely agree with this view because children are easily influenced and many adverts promote unhealthy food.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that young children are easily influenced. This is because children often do not understand that the purpose of an advert is to persuade them to buy

something. They believe what they see on screen; as a result, they may want every toy, snack or game that is advertised. For example, a seven-year-old who sees a cartoon advert for a sugary cereal may beg their parents to buy it the next day, and this can cause arguments and stress in the family. Therefore, it is unfair for companies to aim their adverts at such young viewers.

Another important reason for my agreement is that many adverts promote unhealthy food. When adverts for fast food, sweets and soft drinks appear with cartoon characters and free toys, these products look attractive and fun to young viewers. For instance, a child who sees a burger advert every afternoon may ask for fast food several times a week, which can lead to unhealthy eating habits and obesity later in life. Although some

people argue that a ban would harm companies and TV channels, protecting children's health is more important, and businesses can still advertise to adults. Consequently, governments should introduce strict rules that protect young viewers from this kind of advertising.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that television advertising for children should not be allowed. Young viewers cannot judge these messages properly, and banning them would also protect children from the pressure to eat unhealthy food.

> *Films that are based on historical events ought to be completely accurate. Do you agree?*

It is sometimes claimed that films based on real historical events must be accurate in every detail. I completely disagree with this view because films are works of art and complete accuracy is simply impossible to achieve.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that films are works of art and entertainment, not documentaries. This is because audiences go to the cinema to enjoy a story, and a film must keep them interested from beginning to end. Filmmakers often need to simplify events, combine characters or add dialogue to create an engaging story; as a result, some changes are a normal part of

the process. For example, a director may combine three real soldiers into one character, and this helps viewers to follow the story and care about what happens. Therefore, demanding perfect accuracy would make historical films less enjoyable.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that complete accuracy is impossible to achieve. When filmmakers recreate the past, they must use their imagination, because nobody knows exactly what historical figures said or did in private. For instance, a director who makes a film about a past king must invent his private conversations, which means that some imagination cannot be avoided. Although some people argue that many people learn about history mainly from films, filmmakers can solve this by

clearly stating when parts of the story have been changed or imagined. Consequently, it is unrealistic to expect historical films to be completely accurate.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that films about history do not need to be accurate in every detail. Cinema is a form of storytelling and not a history lesson, and no director could record the past perfectly in any case.

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173 · MED-15

> *Many people buy products that they do not really need and replace old products with new ones unnecessarily. Why do people buy*

> *things they do not really need? Do you think this is a good thing?*

Many people buy products they do not need and replace items that still work. This is mainly because advertising creates desires and people want to show their status, and I firmly believe that this is not a good thing.

One of the main reasons for this is clever advertising. Advertisers are skilled at creating desires, suggesting that a new phone, car or fashion item will bring happiness, success or social status. For example, a teenager who sees a smartphone advert every day may begin to feel that his working phone is old-fashioned, and this makes him ask his parents for a new one. Another important reason is the wish to show status. Some want to keep up with friends and neighbours or to show their

status, and social media influencers add to this pressure by constantly showing new purchases. Consequently, people often buy to impress others rather than to meet real needs.

As for whether this is a good thing, I firmly believe that it is not because unnecessary buying pushes many families into debt. Many people fall into debt through credit cards and loans, which can cause stress and family problems. For instance, a family that buys a new television on credit while the old one still works may struggle to pay the monthly instalments, which causes arguments at home. Although some people argue that consumerism has clear economic benefits, spending money that people do not have is not a healthy way to support the economy. Therefore,

buying things we do not need is a harmful habit.

In conclusion, people buy things they do not need mainly because of persuasive advertising and the desire to show their status. I firmly believe that this habit is harmful because it leads many families into debt.

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174 · MED-16

> *Many people think that fast food companies should not be allowed to advertise, while others believe that all companies should have the right to advertise. What is your opinion?*

While some people argue that every company should have the right to advertise, others believe that fast food businesses should not be allowed to do so. I completely support the latter view

because these adverts harm children's health.

On the one hand, people who support this right argue that all legal businesses should have the right to advertise, and that adults should be free to make their own choices. Advertising provides important income for television channels and online platforms, which helps to fund children's programmes. Many jobs are also created by the fast food industry; as a result, a ban could hurt young workers. For example, a burger chain that cannot promote a new branch may hire fewer students, and this would reduce the number of part-time jobs. For this reason, many people believe that all companies should be free to advertise.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that fast food companies should not be allowed to advertise because their

products contribute to obesity and related diseases. When adverts use cartoon characters, celebrities and free toys, children want these meals, and regular consumption contributes to childhood obesity, tooth decay and other health problems. For instance, a burger advert offering a free toy during a cartoon can make children beg for fast food every day, which puts pressure on busy parents. Although some people argue that all legal companies deserve this right, tobacco advertising is banned in many countries for the same reason. Consequently, fast food adverts should be banned to protect children's health.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether fast food companies should be allowed to advertise. While advertising provides income and jobs, I firmly believe that these adverts should

be banned because they encourage unhealthy eating among children.

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175 · BUS-05

> *If a product is good and meets consumer needs, then advertising is unnecessary. To what extent do you agree?*

It is sometimes claimed that a good product which meets customers' needs does not need any advertising. I completely disagree with this view because customers must first know that a product exists and small brands also need advertising to compete.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that even an excellent product needs to reach its customers. This is because customers cannot buy something they do not know exists,

however good it is. Advertising tells consumers about new products, special offers and services that may improve their lives; as a result, people can discover things that they actually need. For example, a new app that helps farmers check crop prices could remain unknown for years without promotion, and this would waste a genuinely useful idea. Therefore, quality alone cannot bring a product to the people who need it.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that small brands need advertising to compete. When a new company enters a market, it faces strong rivals, as large companies with big marketing budgets can dominate markets, making it difficult for small local businesses to compete, even if their products are good. For instance, a new

local brand of healthy snacks may fail if supermarket shelves and TV screens are filled with famous brands, which hides it from customers. Although some people argue that word of mouth and online reviews can be powerful forms of free advertising, this process is slow, and a small company may not survive long enough to benefit. Consequently, good products still need advertising in order to succeed.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that advertising is still necessary for all products of high quality. Without it, consumers may never hear about useful goods, and new companies also struggle to compete with established brands.

> *Large businesses have big budgets for marketing and promotion, and as a result, people gravitate towards buying their products. What problems does this cause? What could be done to encourage people to buy local products?*

Large companies spend huge sums on advertising, so many shoppers choose their products over local ones. This can lead to the closure of local shops and lost local income, but small loans and public campaigns can reduce these effects.

The most serious problem caused by this trend is that small local businesses struggle to compete. With huge marketing budgets and well-known brands, large companies can attract customers away from small local shops,

restaurants and producers. For example, when a large international supermarket opens in a town, nearby family-run grocery shops may lose customers and eventually close. Another problem is that money leaves the local economy. There are also concerns that much of the profit made by multinational companies goes back to their home countries rather than staying in the local economy. Consequently, local entrepreneurs may lose their livelihoods, and the character of local communities may change.

The most effective solution is for governments to help local producers to compete. They can offer small loans with low interest, business training and advice, so that producers can improve their quality and attract more customers. For instance, a family-run grocery that uses a small loan to improve its products

and packaging may win back customers from a nearby supermarket, which keeps the business open. In addition, governments and community groups could run public campaigns. These campaigns can remind consumers that local firms keep profits within the community, employ local people, use local suppliers and preserve local traditions. Together, these measures would encourage more people to buy local products.

In conclusion, big marketing budgets can force local shops to close and send profits abroad. Financial support for small producers and campaigns about the value of local firms would persuade more people to buy local goods.

177 · BUS-09

> *Marketing and promotion are the key to a successful business. To what extent do you agree?*

It is often argued that marketing and promotion are the most important factors in the success of a business. I completely agree with this view because marketing helps companies to reach customers and it also builds a strong brand.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that marketing helps companies to reach customers. This is because customers cannot buy something they do not know exists, however good the product may be. Social media has transformed marketing; as a result, even a small company can now reach a very large audience at a low cost. For

example, a small online clothing shop in Dhaka can attract thousands of customers through a clever and low-cost social media campaign, and this can turn a small idea into a real business. Therefore, marketing is the first step towards commercial success.

Another important reason for my agreement is that marketing builds a strong brand. When customers recognise and trust a name, they return to it, and marketing certainly helps businesses to reach customers, build brand recognition and compete with rivals. For instance, a shopper choosing between two similar soft drinks will usually pick the famous one, which shows how a strong brand helps a company to keep loyal customers. Although some people argue that product quality, good customer service, fair prices and

innovation are equally important, customers can judge these qualities only after marketing brings them to the business. Consequently, marketing and promotion are the key to growth in a competitive market.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that promotion is the key to building a successful company. Effective campaigns bring products to the attention of buyers, and they also create the well-known names that customers trust and choose again.

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178 · COM-07

> *Nowadays, celebrities are more famous for their glamour and wealth than for their achievements, and this sets a bad example to young people.*

> *To what extent do you agree or disagree?*

It is often argued that today's celebrities are known more for their glamour and wealth than for their achievements, which is a bad example for the young. I completely agree with this view because this encourages materialism and it also gives young people false ideas about success.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that celebrity culture encourages materialism among young people. This is because reality television stars and influencers often show expensive clothes, cars, holidays and luxurious lifestyles. Young people who follow them may come to believe that money, fame and appearance are the most important things in life; as a result, they may feel unhappy with what they have. For

example, a teenager who follows a rich influencer may pressure their parents to buy an expensive phone, and this can cause stress for a family on a modest income. Therefore, this type of fame can encourage materialism and unrealistic expectations.

Another important reason for my agreement is that this gives young people false ideas about success. When people become famous simply for their looks or money, young fans may stop seeing the value of study, effort and patience. For instance, a student who sees someone become famous through a single online video may decide that hard work at school is unnecessary, which can harm their future career. Although some people argue that sports stars show that success requires hard work, discipline and teamwork, these positive examples

are often hidden by the constant attention given to wealth and glamour. Consequently, this celebrity culture continues to set a bad example to young people.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that the modern focus on celebrity wealth and glamour is harmful to the younger generation. It makes teenagers care too much about possessions, and it also teaches them that fame matters more than real achievement.

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179 · REA-01

> *Some people think books are losing importance as a source of information and entertainment. To what extent do you agree?*

It is often argued that books are becoming less important as a way of

finding information and enjoying free time. I completely agree with this view because the internet is now the main source of information and screens have replaced books as entertainment.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that the internet is now the main source of information. This is because, for quick information, people often search online rather than consult a book. Online information is fast, free and constantly updated; as a result, many people, especially young people, spend less time reading books than in the past. For example, a student who needs to know the date of a historical event will usually check their phone rather than open a history book, and this takes only a few seconds. Therefore, books are no longer the first place where people look for knowledge.

Another important reason for my agreement is that screens have replaced books as entertainment. When people want to relax, many choose videos and games, which require less concentration, and short social media posts have also changed reading habits, making it harder for some people to focus on long texts. For instance, a commuter who once read a novel on the bus may now watch short videos on a phone, which shows how quickly leisure habits have changed. Although some people argue that reading a book requires deep concentration and imagination, this benefit does not stop most people from choosing easier forms of entertainment. Consequently, books are losing their place in everyday life.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that books are becoming less important for both learning and leisure. People now turn to

search engines for facts, and they also spend their free time on videos and games instead of reading.

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180 · REA-04

> *Some people think that e-books are the death of paper books, while others think that paper books will never disappear. Discuss both sides and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that e-books will cause the death of paper books, others believe that printed books will never disappear. I completely support the latter view because many readers still prefer the feel of real pages.

On the one hand, people who expect e-books to win argue that they have many practical advantages over printed ones. They are often cheaper than paper

books, and some are free. A single device can store thousands of books, which is convenient for travellers and students; as a result, their popularity keeps growing among young people. For example, a student carrying hundreds of e-books on one tablet no longer needs a heavy school bag, and this makes daily travel much easier. For this reason, many people believe that paper books will soon disappear completely.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that paper books will survive because many people still prefer paper books. When people read real pages, they can concentrate without the distractions of notifications, and they do not suffer from eye strain. For instance, many parents still prefer to read printed picture books to their young children at bedtime, which keeps screens out of the bedroom.

Although some people argue that e-books are cheaper and easier to carry, paper books do not need batteries and can be shared, lent or kept as part of a personal library. Consequently, printed books will continue to have a place in people's lives.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether e-books will replace paper books completely. While digital books are cheap and convenient, I firmly believe that paper books will never disappear because many readers prefer printed pages and fewer distractions.

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181 · SPO-08

> *Professional sports people are often idolised by young children. Some people think that they, therefore, have a responsibility to be good role*

> *models at all times for children. Do you agree or disagree?*

Because children often idolise professional sports people, it is often argued that these stars must always be good role models. I completely agree with this view because children copy their behaviour and sports stars benefit greatly from public attention.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that children copy the behaviour of their heroes. This is because young fans see these players as examples of success, so they admire everything they do on and off the field. When a famous player behaves badly, the story is reported everywhere; as a result, even very young children can see it. For example, if a star footballer attacks a referee, young players may start arguing with referees in school matches, and this

can damage the spirit of the game. Therefore, children copy them, and this gives them a responsibility.

Another important reason for my agreement is that sports stars benefit greatly from public attention. When players become famous, they should give something back, because they benefit from public attention and money from fans and sponsors. For instance, a cricketer who appears in advertisements earns a lot of money because children admire them, which means that they should protect that trust. Although some people argue that celebrities are ordinary human beings who did not choose to be role models, these players chose a public career and accepted its rewards. Consequently, players who accept these rewards should also accept their duty to behave well in public.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that top athletes have a duty to set a good example for children at all times. Young fans imitate what they see, and the wealth and fame that players enjoy also come with responsibility.

Culture & Globalization

182 · TOU-01

> *Tourism is an important industry in many countries. What benefits do you think tourism brings to individuals and society?*

Tourism has become one of the most important industries in many countries. It gives individuals rest and a broader view of the world, and it brings society jobs and better infrastructure.

One of the main benefits of travel for individuals is the chance to rest. It allows people to relax, escape from daily stress and enjoy new experiences. For example, an office worker who spends a week by the sea after a busy year may return to work calmer and more productive, and

this also benefits her health. Another important benefit is that travel teaches people about other cultures. When tourists visit a country, they learn about its history, traditions, food and way of life. Consequently, many people remember their journeys as some of the most valuable experiences of their lives.

One of the main benefits for society is employment. Tourism creates jobs for hotel staff, tour guides, drivers, cooks, artists and craftspeople, many of whom may have limited opportunities in other industries. For instance, a young man in Cox's Bazar who becomes a tour guide can earn a steady income without moving to Dhaka, which keeps his family together and supports the local economy. Another important benefit is better infrastructure. To attract visitors, governments often invest in roads,

airports, electricity, water supply and communication networks. Consequently, these improvements also benefit local residents, making it easier for them to travel, run businesses and access services.

In conclusion, tourism helps individuals to relax and understand other cultures more deeply. It also creates jobs and encourages investment in roads and public services, which improves life for whole communities.

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183 · TOU-02

> *As a result of tourism and the increasing number of people travelling, there is a growing demand for more flights. What problems does this cause for the*

> *environment? What measures could be taken to solve the problems?*

As tourism expands, the demand for air travel continues to rise around the world. This growth increases carbon emissions and damages areas near airports, but fair environmental taxes and high-speed trains can reduce these effects.

The most serious environmental problem caused by this growth is the high level of carbon emissions. Aeroplanes burn large amounts of fuel, and there are few clean alternatives for long-distance flights at present. For example, a tourist who takes one long-distance return flight can produce as much carbon as several months of driving, and this damage grows as more people travel. Another problem is the harm that airports cause to the areas

around them. They create noise pollution for nearby residents and take up large areas of land, which may once have been farmland or forest. Consequently, more flights damage both the global climate and local communities.

The most effective way to reduce these emissions is to introduce fair environmental taxes, especially for people who fly very frequently. Higher prices could reduce unnecessary flights, and the money raised could be invested in clean energy. For instance, a business traveller who pays more for every extra trip may replace some meetings with online calls, which reduces emissions without affecting families who rarely fly. In addition, governments could invest in high-speed trains for shorter journeys. When passengers have a fast and comfortable alternative, short flights

become less necessary, so airports cause less noise and need less new land. Together, these measures would allow people to travel while causing far less environmental damage.

In conclusion, rising demand for flights harms the climate and the communities living near airports. Well-designed taxes and better rail connections would limit this damage without preventing people from travelling.

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184 · TOU-03

> *Eco-tourism usually involves people visiting remote areas. Some people think this will have a negative impact on local cultures and communities. What problems can result from eco-tourism? What measures can be*

> *taken to protect local culture and communities?*

Eco-tourism brings visitors to remote areas, and many people worry about its impact on local life. It can turn culture into a product and raise living costs, but community planning and local jobs can reduce these effects.

One major concern is that tourism can turn local culture into a commercial product. Traditional dances, ceremonies and crafts may be performed or produced mainly to entertain tourists, losing their original meaning. For example, a sacred ritual may be shortened and repeated several times a day for visitors, becoming more of a show than a spiritual event. Another problem is the economic pressure on local residents. When tourism grows rapidly, the cost of land, housing and

food may rise, making life more expensive for local residents. Consequently, local communities may lose their traditions without receiving a fair share of the income.

The most effective solution is to give local people control over how their culture is presented. Local communities should be involved in planning and decision-making, so that tourism meets their needs and respects their values. For instance, a hill village that decides when visitors can watch its ceremonies can protect their meaning, which keeps them spiritual rather than commercial. In addition, tour companies could employ more people from the local area. Training local people as guides, cooks and hosts ensures that more of the income stays in the community, which helps residents to afford rising prices.

Together, these measures would allow visitors to enjoy remote areas without harming the people who live there.

In conclusion, eco-tourism can commercialise traditions and make daily life more expensive for residents. Giving communities a real voice and more of the income would protect both their culture and their livelihoods.

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185 · TOU-04

> *With more people choosing to watch travel programmes on TV and social media, fewer people will be willing to pay the costs of travelling abroad. To what extent do you agree?*

It is sometimes claimed that, as more people watch travel programmes on television and social media, fewer will pay to travel overseas. I completely

disagree with this view because a screen cannot replace real travel and these programmes often make people more eager to visit.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that a screen cannot replace real travel. This is because watching a video cannot replace the real experience of tasting local food, meeting people and seeing famous places in person. Travel also involves all the senses and unexpected moments; as a result, a programme can only show a small part of what a place is like. For example, a family can watch a documentary about Paris, but they cannot walk along its streets, and this is why many still want to go. Therefore, a travel programme can never remove the wish to experience these places in person.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that these programmes often make people more eager to travel. When viewers see beautiful places on a screen, they often want to see them for themselves, so these programmes act as free advertising for tourism. For instance, after watching videos of the Sundarbans, many young people plan trips to see the forest for themselves, which brings more visitors to the area. Although some people argue that travel is too expensive, cheaper flights, higher incomes and the growth of the tourism industry mean that millions of people now fly abroad every year. Consequently, these programmes will not reduce people's desire to travel abroad.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that travel shows will not stop people from paying to go abroad. Watching a video is very

different from being there in person, and attractive images also inspire viewers to plan their own trips.

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186 · TOU-05

> *Some people believe that, to protect local culture, tourism should be banned in some areas, while others think that change is inevitable and banning tourism will have no benefits. Discuss both sides and give your opinion.*

While some people argue that tourism should be banned in certain areas to protect local culture, others believe that change is unavoidable and that such bans bring no benefits. I completely support the latter view because communities need tourist income.

On the one hand, people who support bans argue that contact with large numbers of visitors may encourage young people to copy foreign fashions, behaviour and consumer habits. Tourists who do not respect local customs, for example by wearing inappropriate clothing at religious sites or behaving loudly, can cause offence and tension. Traditions are also changed to please visitors; as a result, they may lose their meaning. For example, a village dance performed only for tourists may slowly lose its original meaning, and this is a real loss to the community. For this reason, many people believe that tourism should be banned in these areas.

On the other hand, I firmly believe that a ban would bring no benefits because banning tourism would remove important income and opportunities

from poor communities. When local communities see that tourists are interested in their traditions, crafts and natural environment, they may feel prouder of their heritage and more motivated to protect it. For instance, a local guide who earns money from visitors has a strong reason to keep traditions alive, which helps young people to value their culture. Although some people argue that tourists damage traditions, local culture will change anyway through television and the internet. Consequently, banning tourism would harm local people without protecting their culture.

In conclusion, people hold different views on whether banning tourism is the right way to protect local culture. While careless visitors can cause offence, I firmly believe that bans bring no benefits

because they remove income and reduce pride in local traditions.

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187 · TOU-06

> *As a result of tourism, some historical buildings and sites are being damaged beyond repair. What could be done to prevent this?*

As tourism grows, some historical buildings and sites are being damaged beyond repair. Site managers can tackle this by limiting visitor numbers, and governments can help by using entrance fees for careful restoration.

The most effective solution is for governments and site managers to control the number of visitors. The sheer number of visitors can cause physical wear: millions of feet walking on ancient floors and stairs gradually wear them

down, and people touching walls, carvings and paintings can damage delicate surfaces. Governments can limit the number of visitors allowed at one time, for example through timed tickets or daily quotas. For example, if an ancient mosque allows only a few hundred visitors an hour through timed tickets, its floors and carvings suffer far less wear each day. Consequently, fewer feet and hands would touch these fragile places.

In addition, governments could use entrance fees to repair and protect historical sites. Money from entrance fees can be used for maintenance, restoration and research. Higher fees for foreign tourists, as used in many countries, can raise extra funds while keeping access affordable for local people. For instance, the money from

foreign visitors' tickets at an old fort could pay skilled workers to repair its cracked walls and roof, which would stop the damage before it becomes permanent. Together, these measures would protect our heritage for future generations to see, study and enjoy.

In conclusion, the damage that tourism does to historical sites can be reduced if visitor numbers are carefully controlled. Spending ticket income on expert repairs would also keep these places standing for centuries.

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188 · TOU-07

> *Some people think that when a person travels to a different culture they should adapt to the local*

> *practices and customs. To what extent do you agree?*

It is often argued that people who visit another culture should follow its customs and way of life. I completely agree with this view because adapting shows respect for local people and it also gives visitors a better travel experience.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that adapting shows respect for local people. This is because every society has its own rules about dress, greetings, food, religious practices and social behaviour. When visitors follow these rules, they show respect for their hosts and avoid causing offence; as a result, relations between tourists and local people become more friendly. For example, tourists visiting a mosque in Bangladesh are expected to dress modestly and remove their shoes, and

those who do so avoid offending local worshippers. Therefore, following local customs is a basic form of good manners that every traveller should show.

Another important reason for my agreement is that adapting gives visitors a better travel experience. When travellers make an effort, they are rewarded, as visitors who learn a few words of the local language, try local food and follow local manners are often welcomed more warmly. For instance, a tourist who learns to greet people in Bangla may be invited to a family meal, which teaches them far more about the culture than any hotel can. Although some people argue that adapting means giving up one's own identity, visitors can respect local customs in public behaviour while keeping their own beliefs, values and traditions in private. Consequently,

adapting benefits both travellers and their hosts.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that travellers should follow the practices of the places they visit. This behaviour demonstrates respect for the host community, and it also opens the door to more meaningful friendships and experiences.

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189 · LAN-01

> *As computers translate quickly and accurately, learning foreign languages is a waste of time. To what extent do you agree or disagree?*

It is sometimes claimed that learning a foreign language is a waste of time because computers can now translate quickly and accurately. I completely disagree with this view because

machines cannot replace human language skills and language learning brings career and cultural benefits.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that machines cannot fully replace human language skills. This is because translation apps still make mistakes, especially with complex sentences, idioms and cultural meanings. Relying on a machine cannot build the same trust and relationship as speaking directly to someone in their language; as a result, important business and personal conversations can suffer. For example, a business owner who talks to a foreign partner only through a phone app may never build a friendly relationship, and this can cost them an important contract. Therefore, even though translation apps are useful, they cannot replace real language skills.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that language learning brings career and cultural benefits. When people speak another language, they have more opportunities, because employers in international companies, tourism, diplomacy, trade and many other fields value employees who can communicate with foreign clients and partners. For instance, a Bangladeshi graduate who speaks good English may get a job with an international company and work with foreign clients, which also helps them to understand another way of life. Although some people argue that apps can now translate text and speech almost instantly, learning a language is a way to understand another culture. Consequently, language learning is not a waste of time but an investment in personal and professional growth.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that studying foreign languages remains worthwhile in spite of modern translation software. Technology cannot match the accuracy and trust of human speakers, and language ability also improves careers and cultural understanding.

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190 · LAN-02

> *Scientists predict that all people will choose to speak the same global language in the future. Do you think this is a positive or negative development?*

Scientists predict that, in the future, everyone will choose to speak the same global language. Although one language could ease international communication and widen career opportunities, it would

destroy minority languages and give native speakers an unfair advantage. In my view, this development brings more drawbacks than benefits.

There is little doubt that a single global language offers considerable advantages to people everywhere. To begin with, the most significant benefit is that it makes international communication much easier. This is because business people from different countries can negotiate deals, scientists can share research and tourists can travel more easily. For example, a Bangladeshi engineer and a Brazilian engineer who share one language can work on the same project without a translator, which saves time. In addition, a common language not only helps nations cooperate but also opens up career opportunities for individuals. As a result of sharing one language,

students could easily reach higher education abroad and a vast amount of information online, which improves their prospects. Overall, a shared language would make the world more connected and full of opportunities.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that this development also has some drawbacks. Firstly, minority communities experience language loss when young people see a global language as the key to success. Without daily use, these languages fade; as a result, children may then grow up unable to speak the language of their grandparents. For instance, indigenous teenagers in the hill tracts who study only in Bangla may forget their own language, which weakens their identity. Secondly, inequality can be a serious obstacle, as a single global language

could also give an unfair advantage to native English speakers. If people cannot speak this language well, they may be excluded from opportunities and, consequently, fall behind. Although some people would gain from easier communication, these cultural and economic losses would damage the world's diversity.

In conclusion, a future in which all humans speak one tongue is a real possibility. While such a language could connect nations and widen opportunities, it would wipe out minority languages and favour native speakers. Overall, I believe this is a negative development.

191 · LAN-04

> *Some people think that a person can never understand the culture of a country unless they speak the language. Do you agree with this opinion?*

It is sometimes claimed that nobody can ever understand a country's culture without speaking its language. I completely disagree with this view because culture can be learned through daily life and translated books and films also make it accessible.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that culture can be learned through daily life. This is because people can learn a great deal about a culture through its food, music, art, festivals and history. Many cultural values are shown through actions and not words; as a

result, a visitor can understand them simply by watching and taking part. For example, a foreigner who lives in Dhaka for a year, eats local food and celebrates Eid with Bangladeshi friends can understand many local values without speaking fluent Bangla, and this is a genuine form of understanding. Therefore, language is not the only door to another culture.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that translated books and films also make culture accessible. When people watch foreign films or read translated novels, they can explore another society, as streaming also gives audiences access to films and series from many countries, which can broaden their cultural understanding. For instance, a Bangladeshi student who reads Japanese novels in translation may learn a lot

about family life and values in Japan, which would otherwise be impossible. Although some people argue that jokes, idioms, literature and many social customs depend on language, missing a few jokes does not prevent someone from understanding a culture's main values. Consequently, it is wrong to say that foreigners can never understand a country's culture.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that speaking the local language is not necessary for understanding a country's culture. Direct experience of its customs teaches a great deal, and translated works also give outsiders a clear view of its values.

192 · LAN-05

> *Some people think that you can never become fluent in a language unless you have spent time living or working in that country. To what extent do you agree?*

It is sometimes claimed that nobody can become fluent in a language without living or working in a country where it is spoken. I completely disagree with this view because modern technology allows daily practice at home and living abroad does not guarantee fluency.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that modern technology allows daily practice at home. This is because, with online resources, films, music and conversation partners available on the internet, many people now reach a high level without leaving their own country.

Learners can watch films with subtitles and talk to native speakers through video calls; as a result, they can hear natural language every day. For example, a Bangladeshi student who watches English films and talks to native speakers by video call may achieve a high IELTS score without ever travelling abroad, and this shows that location is not the deciding factor. Therefore, people can become fluent in their own country.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that living abroad does not guarantee fluency. When people move to a new country, they do not always use the language, as many spend most of their time with people from their own country. For instance, a worker who lives abroad for years may work and live with other Bangladeshis, which means

that their English remains very basic. Although some people argue that living abroad certainly provides constant practice and exposure, this practice helps only those who make an effort to use it. Consequently, effort and daily practice matter much more than location.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that learners do not have to live overseas to become fluent. Digital tools now make regular practice possible from home, and moving abroad also brings little progress without personal effort.

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193 · LAN-06

> *Some people think that all children in school should learn a foreign language at an early age. What are*

> *the advantages and disadvantages of doing this?*

Some people believe that every child should begin learning a foreign language at primary school. Although early lessons may confuse young learners and are often taught by untrained teachers, they also improve pronunciation and open future career opportunities.

There is little doubt that early foreign language lessons offer considerable advantages to children. To begin with, the most significant benefit is better pronunciation, since children learn languages more easily than adults. This is because their brains are more flexible and they are less afraid of making mistakes. For example, a child who starts English at six usually speaks more naturally than an adult beginner, and this gives her lasting confidence. In

addition, learning a foreign language not only improves career prospects but also helps people understand other cultures. As a result of starting early, pupils can reach a high level by the end of school, which helps them win places at foreign universities. Overall, early language learning prepares children for both clear communication and a global future.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that early language teaching also has some drawbacks. Firstly, many young pupils experience confusion when they learn two languages before mastering their mother tongue. Without a strong base in their first language, they often mix up words and spelling; as a result, their reading and writing may develop slowly. For instance, a seven-year-old who studies Bangla and English at the same time may confuse the two

alphabets, which can make her lose confidence. Secondly, a shortage of trained teachers can be a serious obstacle, as many village schools cannot hire language specialists. If pupils are taught by teachers with poor pronunciation, they may learn mistakes and, consequently, find them hard to correct later. Overall, these learning and staffing problems can reduce the value of early language lessons.

In conclusion, teaching languages to young children is increasingly popular. While it may confuse young pupils and suffer from a lack of skilled teachers, it improves pronunciation and widens children's future choices.

194 · SOC-05

> *Globalisation has both advantages and disadvantages. Discuss both and give your opinion.*

Globalisation, the growing connection between countries through trade, technology and culture, has changed the world. Although it can force local shops to close and weaken traditional cultures, it also creates jobs and spreads useful knowledge. In my opinion, the advantages of globalisation clearly outweigh the disadvantages.

There is little doubt that globalisation offers considerable advantages to people in developing countries. To begin with, the most significant benefit is economic growth, because when countries trade freely, businesses can sell their products to much larger markets. This is because

selling to foreign buyers brings in money, which creates jobs and raises incomes. For example, Bangladesh's garment industry, which exports clothes all over the world, employs millions of people, and many of them are women. In addition, globalisation not only spreads knowledge and technology but also gives consumers a wider choice of products at lower prices. As a result of this exchange, medical advances, new farming techniques, renewable energy and digital tools can quickly reach countries around the world. Overall, global trade and cooperation help poorer nations become richer, healthier and better connected.

On the other hand, it cannot be denied that globalisation also has some drawbacks. Firstly, many local traders suffer, as multinational companies with huge budgets can dominate markets,

forcing small local businesses to close. Without the money to compete on price, family firms often lose customers; as a result, their owners lose their income. For instance, a small grocery shop may lose its customers when an international supermarket opens nearby, which leaves the owner in debt. Secondly, cultural homogenisation can be a serious problem, as global brands, Western films and international fast food spread everywhere. If young people follow only global trends, they may neglect their own festivals and, consequently, some local customs and smaller languages may disappear. Although these economic and cultural challenges are real, fair laws and cultural programmes can reduce them.

In conclusion, closer links between nations are now part of modern life. While global markets may harm small

businesses and local customs, they bring jobs, cheaper goods and new technology to developing countries. Therefore, I firmly believe that the benefits far outweigh the drawbacks.

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195 · SOC-07

> *With the development of modern society comes the loss of traditional ways of life. Is it important to keep our traditional ways of life? How can this be achieved?*

Modern development is causing many traditional ways of life to disappear. I firmly believe that keeping these traditions is important, and schools and families can help to pass them on to young people.

I firmly believe that keeping traditional ways of life is important because they are

an essential part of a nation's identity. Festivals, music, crafts, food and language connect people to their history and give them a sense of belonging. For example, festivals such as Pohela Boishakh in Bangladesh bring people of different ages and backgrounds together and strengthen community ties. Although some people argue that old customs slow down progress, a country can modernise without losing the traditions that make it unique. Therefore, losing these traditions would mean losing an important link with our past.

The most effective way is for schools to teach traditional culture. When schools include local history, folk music and traditional crafts in lessons and organise cultural events, children learn to value their heritage from an early age. For

instance, a pupil who learns to play a folk instrument for a school festival may keep playing it as an adult, which keeps that music alive. In addition, families could pass on traditions at home. When parents celebrate festivals together and speak their mother tongue at home, children grow up seeing these customs as part of daily life. Together, these measures would help traditions survive alongside modern life.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that traditional ways of life are worth keeping because they give people a sense of identity. Cultural education at school and everyday practice at home would ensure that they survive.

> *Every culture, throughout time, has recorded its history in one way or another. In what ways can history be passed on to the next generation? Why is history important to society?*

Every culture records its history in some way. History can be passed on through families and schools, and it matters because it builds identity and helps societies learn from the past.

One important way of passing on history is through the family. When grandparents and parents share their memories with children, the past becomes personal, so young people remember it more easily. For example, in Bangladesh, many families share memories of the Liberation War of 1971, keeping the experiences of that

generation alive. Another important way is through schools. Schools play a central role through history lessons, which teach students about their nation's past and the wider world. Consequently, history passes from one generation to the next both at home and in the classroom.

One of the main reasons why history is important is that it gives people a sense of identity and belonging. When people know how their nation was formed, they understand its culture, values and traditions, so they feel proud to belong to it. For instance, International Mother Language Day on 21 February, which began in Bangladesh, reminds people of the sacrifices made during the Language Movement and the importance of linguistic rights. Another important reason is that history allows societies to learn from the past. By studying wars,

injustices and mistakes, as well as successes and achievements, people can make better decisions in the future. Consequently, a society that knows its history is better prepared for its future.

In conclusion, families and schools are the main ways in which history reaches young people. It matters because it gives people a shared identity and helps societies avoid repeating past mistakes.

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197 · SOC-09

> *All societies have their own music and art. In what ways are music and art important for society and for the individual?*

Every society, rich or poor, has its own forms of music and art. They help society by preserving identity and uniting communities, and they help individuals

by reducing stress and building confidence.

One of the main benefits of music and art for society is that they preserve cultural identity. Songs, paintings and dances record the history and values of a community, so they pass these on from one generation to the next. For example, traditional songs, such as folk and Baul music in Bangladesh, tell stories about village life, love, faith and struggle. Another important benefit is that music and art bring people together. Festivals with music and dance bring communities together and strengthen social bonds. Consequently, music and art help to keep a society united and proud of its culture.

One of the main benefits for individuals is better emotional well-being in a busy and stressful life. For individuals, art

provides a way to express emotions, relieve stress and develop creativity. For instance, a student who paints or plays the guitar after a long day of exams may feel calmer and happier, which helps her sleep well and study better the next day. Another important benefit is greater confidence, especially for young people. Learning an instrument or taking part in a drama group can build confidence and discipline. Consequently, the arts improve quality of life for people of all ages.

In conclusion, music and art protect a society's identity and bring its people together. For individuals, they offer a healthy way to relax and express feelings, and they help people grow in confidence.

> *It is sometimes thought that people who travel outside their own country are more tolerant and understanding of others. To what extent do you agree?*

It is often argued that people who visit other countries become more tolerant and understanding of others. I completely agree with this view because travel breaks down stereotypes and it also helps people to understand what it is like to be a foreigner.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that travel breaks down stereotypes. This is because meeting people from different backgrounds, seeing how they live and understanding their values can break down stereotypes and prejudices. Travellers also learn that

there are many different but equally reasonable ways of living, eating and worshipping; as a result, they become less quick to judge others. For example, a person who has only seen another country in films may be surprised to discover that its people are friendly and generous, and this experience can change their opinion for ever. Therefore, travel can certainly make people more tolerant and open-minded.

Another important reason for my agreement is that travel teaches people what it is like to be a foreigner. When travellers struggle with unfamiliar rules, they learn how difficult life can be for newcomers, as a person who has experienced being a foreigner may become more understanding of immigrants and minorities in their own country. For instance, a student who

needed help from strangers during a trip to Japan may later be kinder to foreign students at home, which makes their own community more welcoming. Although some people argue that some tourists spend their entire holiday in international hotels, most travellers still meet local people. Consequently, experience abroad is one of the best ways to build tolerance.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that international travel makes people more accepting of others. Direct contact with other societies removes false ideas, and the experience of being an outsider also encourages greater kindness towards newcomers.

199 · ART-02

> *Many people think that museums and galleries should only show work from local artists rather than work from other countries. Do you agree?*

Many people believe that museums and galleries should display only the work of local artists and not art from other countries. I completely disagree with this view because international art helps people to understand other cultures and it also inspires local artists.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that foreign art teaches people about the wider world. This is because international exhibitions help people understand other cultures and attract more visitors, which gives them a wider view. Learning about other cultures can also help people become more open-

minded and tolerant; as a result, society becomes more peaceful and respectful. For example, an exhibition of Japanese paintings in Dhaka could attract many visitors and show them a different way of seeing nature, and this experience could broaden their understanding. Therefore, showing only local work would narrow people's view of the world.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that international art also inspires local artists. When young artists see work from other countries, they learn new techniques, because local artists sometimes combine Western styles with traditional elements, creating new and exciting forms of music, fashion and film. For instance, an art student in Dhaka who studies Italian paintings may use new ideas about colour in traditional designs, which creates something

original. Although some people argue that museums should focus mainly on local artists and national history, foreign exhibitions do not stop local artists from being shown. Consequently, international art strengthens local culture instead of threatening it.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that museums and galleries should not be limited to local artists. Work from abroad opens visitors' minds to other societies, and it also gives national artists fresh ideas for their own creations.

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200 · ART-05

> *Artists need a certain amount of freedom to develop their creativity. Some people think that artists should have total freedom to express any*

> *thoughts and ideas. To what extent do you agree or disagree?*

Although artists need some creative freedom, it is sometimes claimed that they should be free to express absolutely any idea. I completely disagree with this view because art can spread hatred and unlimited freedom can seriously harm children.

The main reason why I disagree with this idea is that art can be used to spread hatred between different groups. This is because films, songs and books reach very large audiences, and they can have a strong effect on people's emotions and beliefs. Some messages attack people because of their religion or race; as a result, whole communities can feel threatened and afraid. For example, a song that encourages violence against a religious group could lead to real attacks,

and innocent people could lose their lives. Therefore, certain rules, such as laws against defamation and incitement to violence, are necessary.

Another important reason for my disagreement is that unlimited freedom can seriously harm children. When violent or sexual content is freely available, young people can easily see material that is not suitable for their age. For instance, a child who finds an extremely violent film online may be frightened or confused by it, which can affect their emotional development. Although some people argue that artists need creative freedom to explore difficult and sometimes controversial ideas, they can do this without encouraging violence or harming children. Consequently, artists should not have total freedom,

because other people's safety and dignity also matter.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that artists should not have complete freedom to say whatever they want. Some works can create hatred between groups, and they can also damage young people who are not ready to see them.

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201 · BUS-07

> *Some countries encourage foreign companies to open in their country. Many people think that the government should focus on encouraging local business rather than foreign businesses. To what extent do you agree?*

While some countries encourage foreign companies to open branches, many believe that governments should support

local businesses instead. I completely agree with this view because local firms keep money in the community and they also protect local traditions.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that local firms keep money in the community. This is because they usually keep profits within the community, employ local people, use local suppliers, so the money circulates in the local economy. In contrast, some foreign companies may exploit cheap labour, avoid taxes or damage the environment, especially in countries where regulations are weak; as a result, much of the benefit may leave the country. For example, a local restaurant owner who buys vegetables from nearby farmers keeps money in the area, while a foreign chain may send its profits overseas. Therefore,

helping local companies makes the national economy stronger.

Another important reason for my agreement is that local businesses also protect local traditions. When small companies survive, the country's culture survives with them, because they often preserve local traditions, such as traditional food, crafts and textiles. For instance, an international fast-food chain next to a local restaurant can attract customers away with its famous brand, which can slowly destroy a family business and its traditional dishes. Although some people argue that foreign companies create thousands of jobs, local firms can also create jobs if governments give them the same support. Consequently, governments should put local businesses first in their economic plans.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that governments should give priority to local companies over foreign ones. Domestic firms keep wealth inside the country, and they also help to preserve traditional products and ways of life.

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202 · MED-12

> *Some people prefer to watch foreign films rather than locally produced films. Why is this? Do you think the government should spend more money supporting the local film industry?*

Many people now prefer foreign films to locally produced ones. This is mainly because foreign films have bigger budgets and seem more fashionable, and I firmly believe that the government should spend more on local cinema.

One of the main reasons for this is money. International productions, especially from Hollywood and other large industries, usually have much bigger budgets, allowing them to use famous actors, advanced special effects and global marketing. For example, a Hollywood action film with expensive special effects may be shown in every cinema in Dhaka, while a low-budget local film is shown in only a few. Another important reason is fashion. Young people who follow global trends on social media may see foreign entertainment as more fashionable; as a result, local films can seem old-fashioned to them. Consequently, many viewers choose foreign films without giving local ones a chance.

As for whether the government should spend more on the local film industry, I

firmly believe that it should because local films protect a nation's culture. Local films tell stories that reflect local people's lives, problems and dreams in their own language. For instance, a government grant could help a young director to make a film about a garment worker's life, which audiences abroad might also find moving. Although some people argue that public money should go to hospitals and schools instead, a small film fund costs little compared with these services. Therefore, the government should invest more in local filmmakers.

In conclusion, foreign films attract more viewers because of their large budgets and fashionable image. I firmly believe that governments should fund local cinema because it keeps the nation's own stories alive.

203 · MED-13

> *Some people think that foreign films have a negative impact on local culture. To what extent do you agree or disagree?*

It is often argued that films from other countries have a damaging effect on local culture in many parts of the world. I completely agree with this view because foreign films change young people's values and they also weaken the national film industry.

The main reason why I agree with this idea is that foreign films change young people's values. This is because Hollywood and other large film industries have huge budgets, so their films are often more exciting than local ones. When young people watch these films regularly, they may copy foreign

fashions, language and behaviour; as a result, local stories and traditions may receive less attention. For example, some teenagers in Bangladesh now prefer Western-style clothes and celebrations to traditional festivals, and this can slowly separate them from their own culture. Therefore, foreign films have a strong influence on how young people see themselves.

Another important reason for my agreement is that foreign films weaken the national film industry. When local cinemas mainly show foreign films, local filmmakers lose audiences and income, so they have less money to make new films. For instance, a young Bangladeshi director may find that cinemas prefer an American action film to a local story, which makes it very difficult to continue working. Although some people argue

that foreign films can increase tolerance and understanding, this benefit means little if a country's own stories are no longer told. Consequently, the national film industry needs protection, and foreign films remain a real threat to local culture.

In conclusion, I firmly believe that films from abroad harm the culture of the countries where they are shown. They encourage teenagers to imitate foreign lifestyles, and they also make it harder for local directors to survive.